Causal Clifford Theory (CL10): a quantum cellular automaton on Cl(10, 0) — Standard Model kinematics, exactly unitary causal dynamics, and a lattice gravitational sector

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Abstract

A quantum cellular automaton is defined on a Planck lattice whose 2×2×2 cells carry the Clifford algebra Cl(10, 0) on eight sub-sites (on-site space $\mathbb{C}^{256}$) and are updated by one six-stage product of Spin(10) plane rotations and swap-rotations. From this root follow, with no added field: a (1+3) Minkowski subalgebra; the 16-component Weyl module whose charges are exactly one Standard Model generation, all eight gauge and mixed anomalies cancelling; the **45** adjoint containing the twelve gauge bosons; the 5/3 hypercharge normalisation. The step is exactly unitary ($\det U = 1$, $\pm$-paired spectrum, exact matter/antimatter spectral mirror) and strictly causal, with measured front speed exactly one Planck cell per stage. The closure axiom — the update must be an element of the root — quantizes the rotation angle to $g \in \{\pi/2, \pi/4\}$: the fundamental step has order 8, the internal spectrum is the finite algebraic set $\{\pm\pi/4\,(10),\ \pm 3\pi/4\,(6)\}$, and the on-site update has zero continuous unfixed numbers. The tensions are named, not hidden: the doubler cones are linear in every sampled direction but anisotropic, and no mechanism tried — the full Wilson family, two entangling bond layers, frame averaging over the ten generators, or a systematic 880-point entangling-bond programme — restores a cone; the programme further shows that gaplessness and non-commuting tangent algebras are mutually exclusive over the bond space, a rigidity wall at gap 8×10^{-3} that no bond of the class can cross (Section 8.4); the gravitational sector adds $g_{\mu\nu}$ and $G = 1$ by hand and reproduces general relativity to $O(h^2)$, not to machine precision; coupling unification at $\alpha_X = 1/25$ in the standard normalisation $\alpha = g^2/4\pi$ holds only for a desert spectrum with two fitted thresholds and a flavour-dependent bond layer with six fitted couplings; no state of the implemented spectrum can be the dark matter; the Born rule, the spin–statistics identification and the split-node set are declared inputs. Every headline number is classified by provenance: *algebraic*, *conventional*, *fitted*, or *open*.

Summary of results

The determinism claim is interpretive: one time-independent local rule fixes every future state of the lattice — 't Hooft's cellular-automaton determinism exact at the fundamental update — with randomness entering only through the measurement projection; the projection and the Born rule are inputs of the interpretation (O9), not derived from the unitary step.

One loop factor $(1/16\pi)^n$ then organises four scales over thirty orders of magnitude: $n = 10$ reproduces the electroweak/Planck hierarchy — coefficient 2.0881 built from measured loop values against 2.0765 observed (99.44%) — and places the dark-matter mass *scale* at 118 GeV; $n = 3$ the seesaw scale 9.6×10^{13} GeV; $n = 17$ the neutrino mass, with a $\frac{1}{3}$ candidate at 0.0487 eV and $\sum m_\nu \simeq 0.05$ eV — a candidate, not a result: the exponent 17 is fitted and the junction amplitude is a free input inside a finite window. The loop factor itself is reproduced to 3.6% by a closed traced loop of length 10 in the automaton's own gauged bond layer, whose Gauss constraint closes exactly and whose physical sector carries a bounded area law $S = \ln 45$ per bond. With vectorlike desert content — three $\mathbf{10} \oplus \overline{\mathbf{10}}$ pairs at 1.2×10^7 GeV and one $(1, 2)$ pair at 1.0×10^{12} GeV, two fitted thresholds — the three measured couplings meet at $M_X = 1.8 \times 10^{16}$ GeV at $\alpha_X = 1/25$ in the standard normalisation $\alpha = g^2/4\pi$; the identification of this meeting value with the implemented angle $g = 1/5$ is the convention $\alpha_{10} \equiv g^2$ (Section 13.1). The prediction is $\tau_p = 1.8 \times 10^{36}$ yr. The automaton's own Wilson mechanism instead forces $M_X = 8.9 \times 10^{14}$ GeV, excluded by Super-Kamiokande, and the surviving solution requires a flavour-dependent bond layer with six fitted couplings κ_s. The lattice gravitational sector — a symmetric tensor field added to the (1+3) subalgebra, with $G = 1$ by hand — reproduces general relativity on de Sitter, Schwarzschild and 3+1 evolutions to $O(h^2)$ (Table 3).

The paper states equally precisely what does **not** follow. Nine tensions with observation are reported rather than hidden — the doubler cones are anisotropic (velocity-tensor anisotropy 0.748–0.758; 0 of 2726 gapless points of the Wilson family reach $A < 10^{-6}$; three nodal planes, not a cone, at the exactly gapless corner multiplet; and no bond of the 880-point entangling programme is both gapless and non-commuting — a rigidity wall at gap 8×10^{-3}, Section 8.4), the SU(2) coupling overshoots by 5.8× under Standard-Model running, SU(3)

hits a Landau pole at 2.2×10^9 GeV, the bare neutrino ladder is excluded by $\sum m_\nu < 0.12$ eV, no state of the implemented spectrum can be the dark matter, the computed relic abundance is not 0.120, the gauged layer's string tension is 5.4×10^{40} times QCD, the implemented spectrum carries no massless spin-2 candidate, and the neutrino mass the ladder needs is incompatible with out-of-equilibrium decay at the seesaw scale the ladder needs. Nine open problems are each pinned to a named quantity, seven falsifiers are stated — the most accessible being the neutrino mass sum and proton decay at Hyper-Kamiokande — and every headline number is classified by provenance: *algebraic*, *conventional*, *fitted*, or *open*.

Keywords. Clifford algebra; quantum cellular automaton; Spin(10) grand unification; anomaly cancellation; lattice gravity; dark matter; cosmological constant; baryogenesis; falsifiability.

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1. Introduction

1.1 The picture

Two habits of language do most of the misleading. The first calls c the speed of light. Light is one traveller at that speed; the constant is the speed of causality. The second is wave–particle duality, taught as a paradox. On a lattice it dissolves: there is one wave, always; what a detector registers is a single localised event, because the detector is itself a lattice of cells changing state one cell at a time. The ontology contains no particles — only waves that deliver their energy in quanta.

Quantum field theory replaced particles by fields but multiplied the fields, one per species, glued together by hand. The viewpoint here is the opposite one, elementary in computer science: a cellular automaton — a lattice of cells, each holding a finite packet of information, all updated in parallel by one local rule. If the world is such an automaton, everything physical is a wave of information over that lattice, and the theory reduces to two questions: what is the information structure of a single cell, and what is the rule that updates it. Causal Clifford Theory (CL10) answers both concretely: the cell is the spinor module of $\mathrm{Cl}(10,0)$, and the rule is a product of Spin(10) plane rotations interleaved with nearest-neighbour swap-rotations.

1.2 Two literatures, one construction

Discrete models of quantum dynamics and grand unification have developed independently. Causal sets, lattice gauge theory and quantum cellular automata treat spacetime as a finite, causal, unitary dynamical system [1–5]. The observation that one generation of quarks and leptons fits exactly into the 16-dimensional spinor of Spin(10), with the 5/3 hypercharge normalisation and anomaly cancellation following from the embedding, has been standard since 1974 [7–10]; Clifford-algebra formulations of this unification exist [11–14]. 't Hooft's cellular-automaton interpretation supplies a deterministic unitary dynamics but no unification [30,31].

CL10 puts these on a single footing: the internal space of every sub-site of the automaton's cell **is** the spinor module of $\mathrm{Cl}(10,0)$, and the update **is** an element of the corresponding spin group. Nothing else is added by hand: no extra scalar, no extra gauge factor, no second algebra.

1.3 Claims, non-claims, and the provenance discipline

Claimed and demonstrated. The kinematics of one Standard Model generation, its anomaly freedom, the grand-unified gauge content and the 5/3, and a unitary causal automaton whose gravitational sector reproduces general relativity on the lattice to $O(h^2)$ (Table 3; Sections 3–7, 11).

Claimed as an order-of-magnitude statement. The electroweak/Planck hierarchy, the dark-matter mass scale, the neutrino mass and the baryon asymmetry, all expressed through the loop factor $(1/16\pi)^n$ with n a small integer (Section 12). The integers are chosen to land near the measured values; the two-digit coefficients are read from the data.

Not claimed. A derivation of the family number, of the fermion masses and mixings, of the cosmological constant, of the dark-matter particle, of the baryon asymmetry, of the spin-2 character of the graviton, of diffeomorphism invariance, or of the Born rule. Each is listed in Section 16 — for the gravitational ones, in Sections 10.4, 11 and 18 — with the size of the gap quantified.

The organising discipline of the paper is therefore a **provenance discipline**: a number is *algebraic* if the root fixes it, *conventional* if it comes from a mapping or scale identification, *fitted* if a coefficient was read from data, and *open* if the theory does not fix it. Section 15 tabulates every headline number under this classification.

The seven criteria. A unification claim has to be checkable, so the theory is judged against stated criteria, with its own verdict on each.

Table 1. The seven criteria and the verdict of this paper.

criterion	requirement	verdict
one object	a single algebraic object, no added fields or structure	met for the internal space; the gravitational sector adds a symmetric tensor field $g_{\mu\nu}(x)$ and the value $G = 1$ (Section 11)
kinematics	spacetime, matter content, gauge group and statistics follow by representation theory	met (Sections 3–6)
dynamics	the object yields a unitary, causal evolution	met (Section 7: exactly unitary, $\det U = 1$, measured front speed = 1)
unification	matter, gauge and gravity live in the same object	partial: matter and gauge are the same module and the same **45**; gravity is the metric dynamics of a subalgebra of that module, with an added field
consistency	anomaly-free, unitary, causal, UV-bounded	met (Theorem 2, Theorem 5, the bounded 32-level spectrum, the bounded n-particle S-matrix); the doublers of Proposition 2 are gapped by an internal Wilson factor (Section 8), with the split node set an input (O9)
parameters	every physical number fixed by the object, no fit	**not met**: two conventions, eleven fitted coefficients, one conditional coefficient (Section 15). The closure axiom (Section 9) removes the one free continuous parameter of the dynamics at the price of moving that parameter's two empirical contacts
falsifiability	testable predictions, and the open problems named rather than hidden	met (Sections 16–17)

The theory passes the structural criteria and fails the parameter one. The closure axiom repairs the parameter criterion algebraically and worsens it phenomenologically: at the quantized angle the doubler census becomes a six-line nodal network rather than twelve points, the desert unification solution leaves the desert with $\tau_p = 2.8 \times 10^{39}$ yr, and the meeting coupling moves from 12.6× below the data-preferred value (implemented angle, standard normalisation) to 1.23× above it (closed angle) — closer to the meeting value, but with the threshold ordering the desert solution assumes destroyed (Section 9.2). The chirality analysis of Section 8 shows that even the structural pass is partial: continuous Lorentz invariance does not emerge at the nodes of the implemented step. Section 8.4 sharpens the picture: the momentum derivative of the step is internal-blind, the Wilson factor is a spectator of the tangent algebra, and the absence of a cone is a structural property of the whole entangling-bond space (a rigidity wall), not a gap in a finite search.

1.4 Conventions

Planck units $\hbar = c = \ell_P = t_P = 1$ unless stated; $G = 1$. Metric signature $(+,-,-,-)$, $Q = T_3 + Y$. $\mathrm{Cl}(10,0)$ is the real algebra of ten generators with $h_a^2 = +I$; the module is over its complexification $\mathrm{Cl}_{10}(\mathbb{C}) \simeq M_{32}(\mathbb{C})$. "Generation" means one set of left-handed Weyl fields. **Coupling notation, one convention:** g (equivalently g_{10}) denotes the rotation angle of the step — 1/5 implemented, $\pi/4$ closed — and α always denotes the standard-normalised coupling $\alpha = g^2/4\pi$ wherever a coupling is compared with running; the alternative reading $\alpha_{10} \equiv g^2$ is a factor-4π convention and is invoked only where explicitly named (Sections 7.1, 9.2, 13.1, 15). Numerical statements are made at tolerance 10^{-12}, machine-precision identities at 10^{-14} or below; every quoted residual is the deviation of a computed quantity from a stated value, computed in double precision on the explicit

representation of Appendix A. Two tolerances are kept apart. A residual at or below 10^{-15} on an identity that is **expected to vanish exactly** ($\det U - 1$, a commutator, a projector sum) is an **upper bound**, not a measurement: double precision ($\epsilon \simeq 2 \times 10^{-16}$) cannot resolve it, and it is quoted as evidence that the identity holds, never as an independent number. A tolerance on a **search** — a root scan, a gap location, a direction grid — is a resolution, is stated where used (10^{-7} for the 2726-point gap scan of Section 8.2, 10^{-6} for the isotropy threshold), and is never quoted as machine precision. Reference data: PDG 2024 [15], Planck 2018 [16], Super-Kamiokande [17,53], KATRIN [18], NuFIT [19,51], LZ [54].

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2. The axiom

Axiom 1 (the root). *The universe is a* (1+3)*-dimensional causal quantum cellular automaton. Its cell is a* 2×2×2 *block of Planck sites — site spacing* ℓ_P*, so the cells tile a cubic lattice of spacing* $2\ell_P$ *— and each of the eight sub-sites carries a copy of the Clifford algebra* $\mathrm{Cl}(10,0)$*: ten mutually anticommuting Hermitian generators*

$$h_a^\dagger = h_a, \qquad h_a^2 = I, \qquad \{h_a, h_b\} = 0 \quad (a \neq b), \qquad a, b = 1, \dots, 10.$$

The state of the universe is a tensor product of these modules over the sub-sites, so the cell's on-site space is $\mathbb{C}^{256}$*, and the dynamics is one time-independent unitary* ***step*** *of six* ***stages*** *built from the algebra (Section 7.1). The elementary time is the stage,* t_P*; one step is* $6t_P$*.*

Why the cell is a block. The bond part of the update pairs neighbouring sub-sites, and the pairing that treats the three directions alike has six stages: three pair sub-sites *inside* the cell, three pair sub-sites *across* cells. Written on a single Planck site the same rule alternates between bonds inside and outside the site, which forces a two-cell spatial period and a six-periodic time dependence; on the block it is one time-independent rule, and the block is the smallest region on which the update acts as a single unitary. The staggering is therefore not a time dependence of the law but the sub-lattice structure of the cell, and the Bloch decomposition of the step is exact at every step.

Three structural facts about the root, all standard [11,20]:

1. $\mathrm{Cl}(10,0)$ is $2^{10} = 1024$-dimensional; its complexification is $M_{32}(\mathbb{C})$, so it has a single irreducible complex module of dimension 32, the Dirac module.
2. The volume element $w = h_1 h_2 \cdots h_{10}$ satisfies

$$w^2 = (-1)^{10\cdot 9/2} \prod_a h_a^2 = (-1)^{45} = -I, \qquad w^\dagger = -w,$$

   so w is anti-Hermitian with eigenvalues $\pm i$, each of multiplicity 16. The projectors $P_{16} = \frac{1}{2}(I - iw)$ and $P_{\overline{16}} = \frac{1}{2}(I + iw)$ split the Dirac module into two inequivalent 16-dimensional Weyl modules.
3. The algebra is $\mathbb{Z}_2$-graded by the parity of the number of generators in a product: 512 even and 512 odd elements.

Everything derived below is representation theory of this one object plus the dynamics of Section 7.

Why 10**.** The number 10 is the smallest n for which a single complex Clifford algebra simultaneously provides (i) a pseudoscalar splitting a Dirac module into two *inequivalent* Weyl modules of dimension 16 — at $n = 8$ the Weyl modules are 8-dimensional (Spin(8) triality: $8_v, 8_s, 8_c$; the 16-dimensional representations are reducible) — and (ii) an adjoint of dimension $\binom{10}{2} = 45$ large enough to contain $\mathfrak{su}(5)$ and hence the Standard Model algebra. At $n = 9$, $\mathrm{Cl}_9(\mathbb{C}) \simeq M_{16} \oplus M_{16}$ does have 16-dimensional irreducibles, but they are the two simple factors of the algebra rather than a pseudoscalar split, and $\mathfrak{so}(9)$ does not contain $\mathfrak{su}(5)$. The root is therefore selected by the requirement of a single chiral generation with a unified gauge algebra, not chosen.

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3. Spacetime as a subalgebra

Theorem 1. *Let $T = h_1$ and $S_a = ih_{a+1}$ for $a = 1, 2, 3$. Then*

$$T^2 = +I, \qquad S_a^2 = -I, \qquad \{T, S_a\} = 0, \qquad \{S_a, S_b\} = 0.$$

The real span of $\{T, S_1, S_2, S_3\}$ inside the grade-1 part of the algebra, with the quadratic form induced by the Clifford product, is Minkowski space $\mathbb{R}^{1,3}$.

Proof. The four generators $h_1, \dots, h_4$ anticommute by Axiom 1. Multiplication by i turns $h_a^2 = I$ into $(ih_a)^2 = -I$ and preserves anticommutation. For $v = v_0 T + \sum_a v_a S_a$ with real coefficients, $v^2 = (v_0^2 - \sum_a v_a^2) I$.

Corollary 1 (the light cone). *A vector v in that real span is null, $v^2 = 0$, if and only if $v_0^2 = \sum_a v_a^2$. The null cone of this quadratic form is the light cone of the lattice.*

Two qualifications. The null cone is a **cone in the grade-1 part**, not a subalgebra: it is not closed under the Clifford product, since $(T + S_1)(T - S_1) = 2I - 2TS_1$ is a grade-0 plus grade-2 element. And the choice of *which* four of the ten generators play the role of spacetime is a choice of frame in the 10-dimensional generator space, not a prediction: the algebra supplies a family of equivalent (1+3) subalgebras related by orthogonal transformations of the generator space. The remaining six generators are inert under the Lorentz generators $\Sigma_{\mu\nu} = \frac{1}{4}[\Gamma_\mu, \Gamma_\nu]$ built from $\Gamma_\mu \in \{T, S_a\}$.

Causality is a postulate with a dynamical content. The light cone by itself does not bound signal propagation: a unitary on-site rotation alone has infinite propagation speed. The bound is supplied by the update of Section 7, where the causal radius is *implemented* by the bond stages and *measured* to be exactly one Planck cell per stage (Theorem 5). The light cone and the causal radius are distinct statements, and only the second is a property of the dynamics.

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4. Matter: the 16 Weyl spinor

Proposition 1. *Under $\mathrm{SU}(3)_c \times \mathrm{SU}(2)_L \times \mathrm{U}(1)_Y$ the 16-dimensional Weyl module is the six left-handed fields of one Standard Model generation:*

$$16 = Q(\mathbf{3}, \mathbf{2}, +\tfrac{1}{6}) \oplus u^c(\bar{\mathbf{3}}, \mathbf{1}, -\tfrac{2}{3}) \oplus d^c(\bar{\mathbf{3}}, \mathbf{1}, +\tfrac{1}{3}) \oplus L(\mathbf{1}, \mathbf{2}, -\tfrac{1}{2}) \oplus e^c(\mathbf{1}, \mathbf{1}, +1) \oplus \nu^c(\mathbf{1}, \mathbf{1}, 0),$$

with $6 + 3 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 1 = 16$. Under $\mathrm{SU}(5)$ this is $\mathbf{10} \oplus \bar{\mathbf{5}} \oplus \mathbf{1}$, the $\mathbf{1}$ being the sterile ν^c.

The assignment is the standard one [7–10,13]. What the automaton adds is that the **16** is not put in by hand but is the Weyl eigenspace of the pseudoscalar of the same algebra that carries the gauge group and the spacetime.

$B - L$. $B - L$ is a generator of $\mathfrak{so}(10)$, so it is *not* a single number on the **16**. Its values on the six fields are $Q : \frac{1}{3}$, $u^c : -\frac{1}{3}$, $d^c : -\frac{1}{3}$, $L : -1$, $e^c : +1$, $\nu^c : +1$; the $\overline{\mathbf{16}}$ carries the negatives of all of them. Under $\mathrm{Spin}(10) \supset \mathrm{SU}(5) \times \mathrm{U}(1)_\chi$, $16 \to \mathbf{10}_{-1} \oplus \bar{\mathbf{5}}_{+2} \oplus \mathbf{1}_{+3}$, and $B - L$ is a linear combination of χ and the diagonal $\mathrm{SU}(5)$ generator, not χ itself.

Theorem 2 (anomaly cancellation). *All eight gauge and mixed anomaly coefficients of the **16** vanish.*

Table 2. The eight anomaly coefficients of one **16**.

coefficient	contribution of the **16**	value
$[\mathrm{SU}(3)]^3$	$2A(\mathbf{3}) + A(\bar{\mathbf{3}}) + A(\bar{\mathbf{3}}) = 1 - \frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{2}$	0
$[\mathrm{SU}(2)]^3$	$A(\mathbf{2}) = 0$ identically ($d^{abc} = 0$; the fundamental is pseudo-real)	0
$[\mathrm{U}(1)]^3$	$6(\frac{1}{6})^3 + 3(-\frac{2}{3})^3 + 3(\frac{1}{3})^3 + 2(-\frac{1}{2})^3 + 1(1)^3 = \frac{1}{36} - \frac{8}{9} + \frac{1}{9} - \frac{1}{4} + 1$	0
$\mathrm{U}(1)[\mathrm{SU}(3)]^2$	$\frac{1}{6} \cdot \frac{1}{2} \cdot 2 + (-\frac{2}{3}) \cdot \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{3} \cdot \frac{1}{2} = \frac{1}{6} - \frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{6}$	0
$\mathrm{U}(1)[\mathrm{SU}(2)]^2$	$\frac{1}{6} \cdot \frac{1}{2} \cdot 3 - \frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{1}{2} = \frac{1}{4} - \frac{1}{4}$	0
$[\mathrm{grav}]^2\mathrm{U}(1)$	$\sum Y = 1 - 2 + 1 - 1 + 1$	0

coefficient	contribution of the **16**	value
$[\mathrm{grav}]^2\mathrm{SU}(3)$, $[\mathrm{grav}]^2\mathrm{SU}(2)$	traceless generators	0

Proof. Each coefficient is a cubic trace over the left-handed Weyl fields; the multiplicities are the dimensions of the *other* group factors (the factor 2 on Q in $[\mathrm{SU}(3)]^3$ is its SU(2) doublet nature, the factor 3 in $\mathrm{U}(1)[\mathrm{SU}(2)]^2$ its colour-triplet nature), with $A(\mathbf{3}) = T(\mathbf{3}) = \frac{1}{2}$ and the charges of Proposition 1.

This is the hardest consistency condition a chiral gauge theory has, and it is satisfied identically by the module content. It is the strongest single result of the theory, and it is independent of the coupling: the cancellation is a property of the algebra, not of a tuned parameter.

The mass term. A grade-1 element of the algebra anticommutes with w, so it is off-diagonal in the $16/\overline{16}$ split: it maps $16 \to \overline{16}$ and $\overline{16} \to 16$, and both diagonal blocks vanish. A scalar in the **10** of Spin(10) therefore produces a Dirac mass term $16\,\mathbf{10}_H\,\overline{16}$ and no Majorana mass for the charged fermions. The singlet ν^c is the built-in source of a seesaw (Section 12.3).

Two caveats. A vev in the **10** has stabiliser SO(9): it breaks $\mathrm{Spin}(10) \to \mathrm{SO}(9)$, and SO(9) is not the Standard Model group. The chain is completed instead by the Wilson direction of Section 8, which at its physical root leaves exactly $\mathrm{SU}(3) \times \mathrm{SU}(2) \times \mathrm{U}(1)^3$ and breaks precisely the leptoquark roots; the two extra U(1)'s must still be broken or hidden. And the **10** contains no Standard Model singlet, so the vev that generates masses necessarily breaks the unified group further. This is open problem O6.

The three families. The **16** is *one* generation. The theory identifies the observed family number with the number 3 of spatial directions of the (1+3) subalgebra, equivalently $\binom{3}{2}$ spatial two-planes, equivalently the rank of the spatial metric: one number stated three ways, not three derivations. The identification has a structural hook: the twelve doubler nodes of Section 8 organise into **three families of four labeled by the zero axis**, one family per spatial direction, with identical one-step spectra (deviation 0), and the three copies of vectorlike matter required by unification are realizable by taking one node from each family at a single Wilson strength. The index 3 exists and *labels* the three copies; it does not force the count (O3).

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5. Gauge: the 45 and the 5/3

The 45 generators $h_a h_b$ $(a < b)$ close on the Spin(10) adjoint. They are even in the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ grading, hence commute with w and preserve the $16/\overline{16}$ split. Under $\mathrm{Spin}(10) \supset \mathrm{SU}(3) \times \mathrm{SU}(2) \times \mathrm{U}(1)$ the **45** decomposes as 12 Standard Model gauge bosons + 12 leptoquark X/Y bosons + 20 bosons in the $\mathbf{10} \oplus \overline{\mathbf{10}}$ of SU(5) + the $\mathrm{U}(1)_{B-L}$ generator; the 33 broken generators mediate proton decay (Section 13.4).

Theorem 3 (the 5/3). *In the* **5** *of* SU(5) *the hypercharge is* $Y = \mathrm{diag}(-\frac{1}{3}, -\frac{1}{3}, -\frac{1}{3}, +\frac{1}{2}, +\frac{1}{2})$ *with* $\mathrm{Tr}\, Y^2 = \frac{5}{6}$, *while the non-Abelian generators obey* $\mathrm{Tr}\, T_a T_b = \frac{1}{2}\delta_{ab}$. *Requiring a single unified coupling* g_5 *for all generators gives* $g_1^2/g'^2 = 5/3$, *where* g' *is the Standard Model hypercharge coupling and* $g_1 \equiv g_5$.

Proof. $\mathrm{Tr}\, Y^2 = 3 \cdot \frac{1}{9} + 2 \cdot \frac{1}{4} = \frac{5}{6}$. Rescaling $Y \to \sqrt{3/5}\, Y$ normalises it to $\frac{1}{2}$; then $g_5(\sqrt{3/5}Y) = g'Y$ gives $g' = g_5\sqrt{3/5}$.

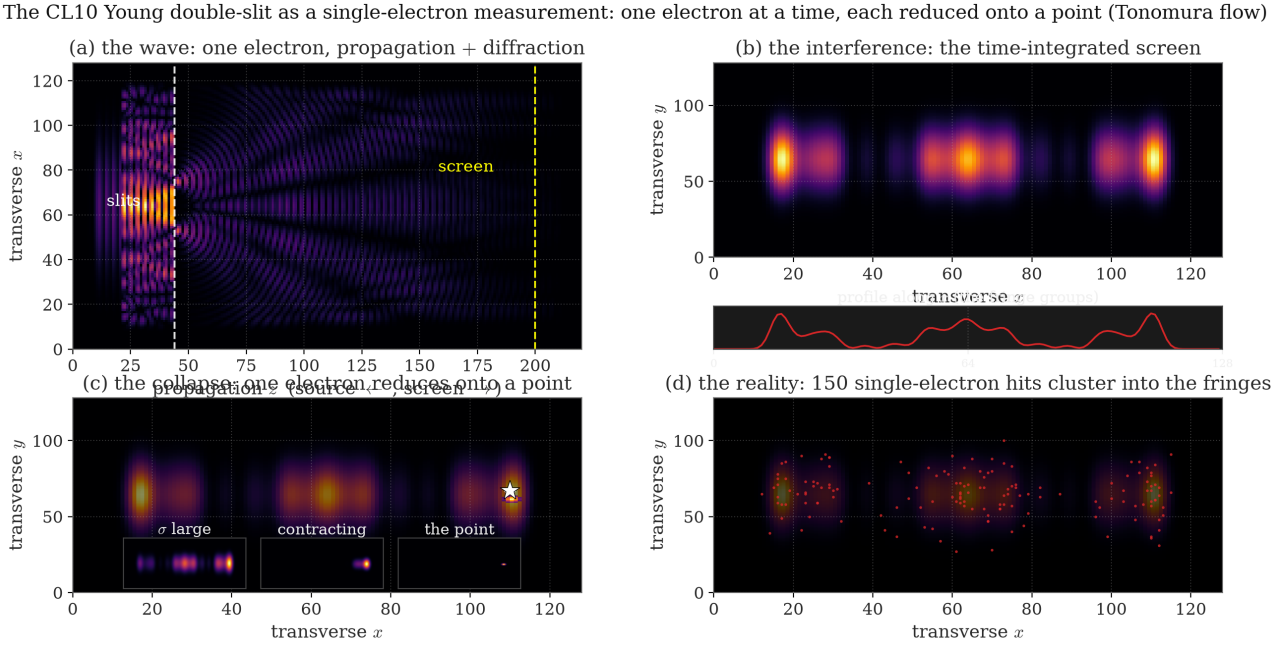
This is an algebraic fact of the root: no parameter enters. It anchors the coupling discussion of Section 13.1, where it will be seen that the *normalisation* of the unified coupling is under control while its *value* is not.

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6. Statistics and measurement

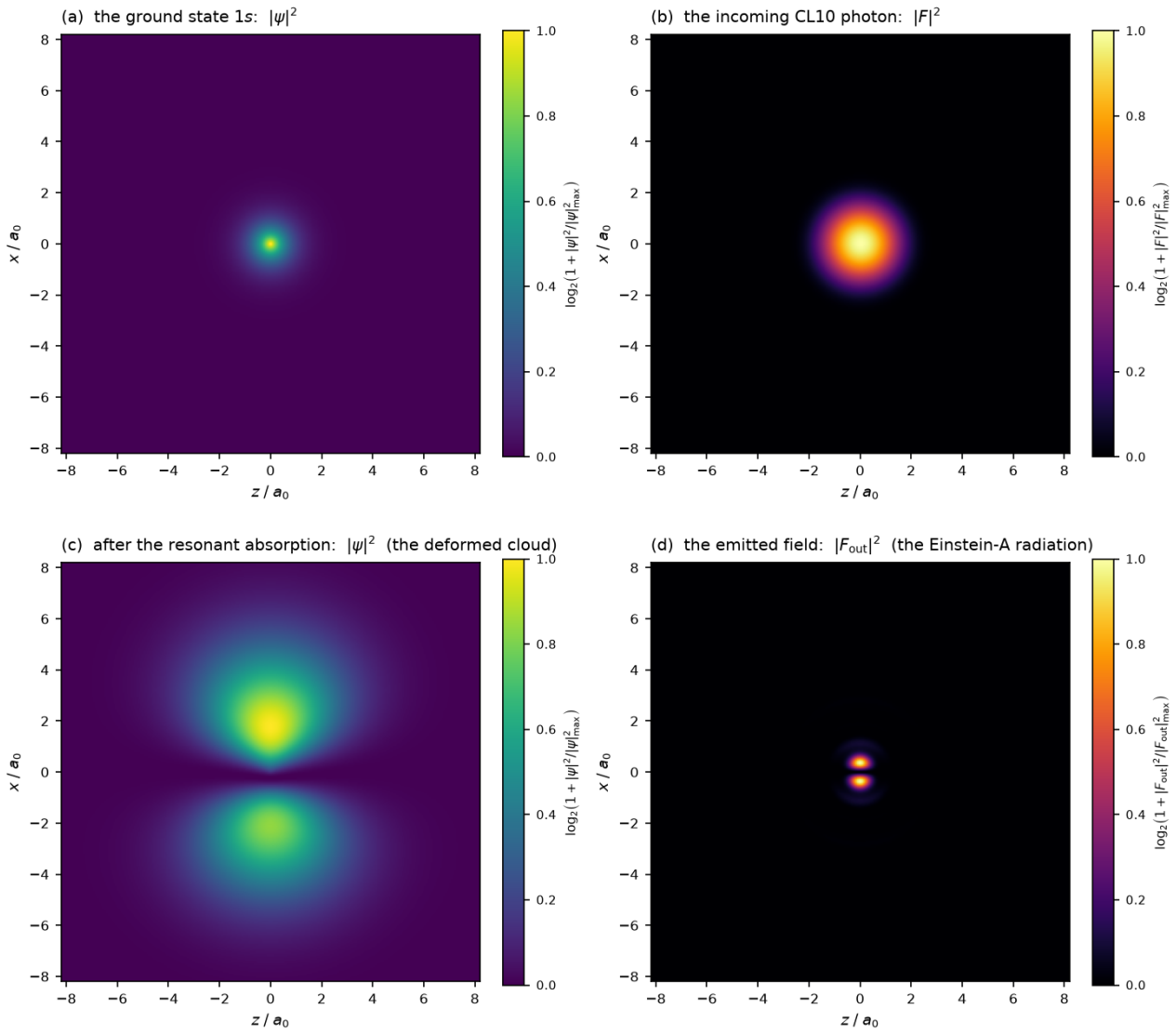
The $\mathbb{Z}_2$ grading splits the algebra into 512 even and 512 odd elements. The even sector is identified with bosons and the odd sector with fermions. This is a *kinematic* grading of the operator algebra: a postulate of the interpretation, not a derivation of the spin–statistics theorem, and not a claim of dynamical supersymmetry. No supercharge exists in the construction and no superpartner is predicted.

Between measurements the automaton is exactly unitary. A detection is modelled as the standard projection: $\sum_x \psi(x)|x\rangle$ reduces to $|x_0\rangle$ with probability $|\psi(x_0)|^2$, the probability rule being the intensity $|\psi|^2$ of the propagating lattice field — the one-electron-at-a-time build-up of the interference fringes is the Tonomura experiment [48]. The projection is **not** derived from the unitary step and the theory does not claim it is: the reduction postulate is an input of the interpretation (O9). What the automaton adds is only that the wave being sampled is a strictly causal, unitary, lattice field. (Fig. 1).



(a) diffraction and interference of the field; (b) the time-integrated on-screen pattern; (c) the reduction of one electron onto one detection point — the projection is an input of the interpretation (O9), not a consequence of the unitary step; (d) the accumulated detections clustering into the fringes, the Tonomura sequence [48].

The same field drives atomic physics: coupled to a prescribed hydrogen spectrum, the lattice photon reproduces resonant absorption, the $1s \to 2p$ deformation, and re-emission at the gap frequency, with forbidden dipole matrix elements vanishing to 10^{-18} ($1s \to 3d$: 1.7×10^{-18}, $2p \to 3p$: 1.2×10^{-17}, against 9.93, −3.00, 22.97 for the allowed transitions) and the excited fraction falling with detuning (0.42, 0.35, 0.15, 0.035, 0.011 at detunings 0, 0.063, 0.125, 0.25, 0.50 rad/step). The atom is an **input** — its levels are the real hydrogen eigenstates — and the figure demonstrates the photon sector, not a derivation of hydrogen. Two limits are stated rather than hidden: off-resonant absorption has a Lorentzian tail, and a wave packet wider than the simulation box never leaves it, becoming a persistent bath that drives the atom off resonance (measured at half-gap detuning in a 120-cell box as excited fractions 0.037, 0.135, 0.326 for packet widths of 12, 24, 48 cells; the published figure uses a localised packet, 20 cells in a 296-cell box). (Fig. 2).



A three-dimensional hydrogen atom coupled to the same discrete massless field that carries the graviton, on the mid-plane cut through the nucleus: (a) the spherical ground state $|\psi|^2$; (b) the incoming lattice photon $|F|^2$; (c) the cloud after resonant absorption, deformed into the dumbbell $2p$; (d) the emitted field $|F_{\mathrm{out}}|^2$. The atom is an input; the figure tests the photon sector, not hydrogen.

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7. The step: unitarity, spectrum, causality

7.1 The update

The step has six stages, and every stage is the same two layers: the internal rotation applied to every sub-site, then one bond stage. The internal factor is built from the Spin(10) plane-rotation generators $T_{ab} = i\,h_a h_b$ $(a < b)$ in the 32-dimensional module — each T_{ab} Hermitian, squaring to I, traceless (sixteen $+1$ and sixteen -1 eigenvalues):

$$U(g) \;=\; \prod_{a<b} \Big(\cos g\, I - i \sin g\, T_{ab} \Big).$$

A sub-site is labelled by $e = (e_1, e_2, e_3) \in \{0,1\}^3$, the bit of axis j being 2^j. A **bond stage** acts on the four disjoint pairs $(e,\, e \oplus 2^j)$: an *intra-block* stage takes the pairs with $e_j = 0$, inside the cell; an *inter-block* stage takes the pairs joining $e_j = 1$ of one cell to $e_j = 0$ of the next cell along $\hat{e}_j$ — still a two-cell operator, now between neighbouring cells. On each pair the gate is the swap-rotation $\cos g\, I - i \sin g\, (|e\rangle\langle o| + |o\rangle\langle e|)$, carrying the same single angle and no other parameter. The six stages run in the fixed order (intra x, inter y, intra z, inter x, intra y, inter z). One step is therefore

$$M \;=\; \prod_{s=1}^{6} (P_s \otimes U(g)),$$

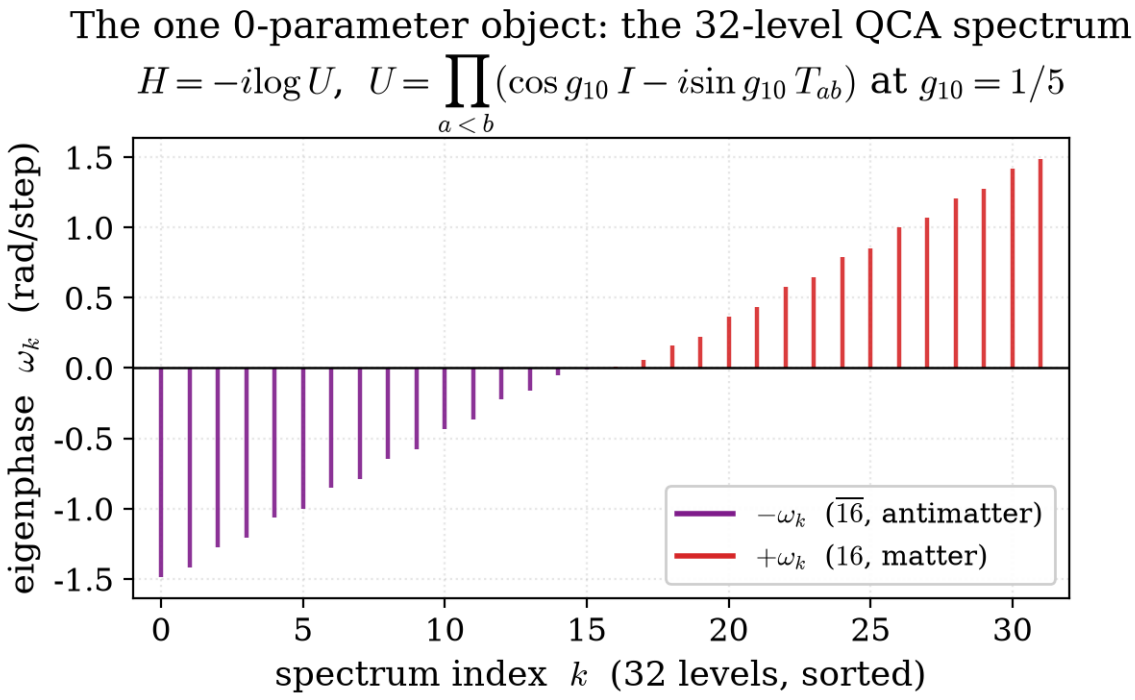
an operator on the cell's on-site space $\mathbb{C}^{256}$ (P_s on the eight sub-sites, U on the internal module). At block crystal momentum q an inter-block pair carries the phase $e^{\pm iq}$, $M(q)$ is 256×256, and on the 16 sector it is 128×128.

Every factor is special unitary: the 45 internal factors have $\det = \exp(-ig \operatorname{Tr} T_{ab}) = 1$, and each bond pair block $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} c & -is \\ -is & c \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ has determinant $c^2 + s^2 = 1$ (the inter-block phases cancel). Hence

$$UU^\dagger = I, \quad \det U = 1, \qquad MM^\dagger = I, \quad \det M = 1 \qquad \text{for every } g,$$

verified numerically: internal unitarity and $|\det U - 1|$ at the 10^{-15} level; for the full cell matrix $\|MM^\dagger - I\| \le 5 \times 10^{-15}$ and $|\det M - 1| \le 3 \times 10^{-13}$ at the zone centre, at a generic momentum and at the two high-symmetry points; the real-space six-stage step preserves the norm of a random cell state to 10^{-15}. Two structural inputs must be named: the 45 factors do not commute, so U depends on the *ordering* of the product, and the six stages have a fixed order. The algebra does not select either order.

The angle g is the one continuous number of the dynamics. Two readings of it coexist and are kept apart throughout. The **implemented** value $g = 1/5$ is the one on which the phenomenology of Sections 12–14 is computed; it comes from the proposed rule $g = 1/n_{\text{qubits}}$, the five qubits of the 32-dimensional module, which the data do not support (Section 15). The **closed** values $g = \pi/2$ and $g = \pi/4$ are the only ones for which the step is an element of the root (Section 9). The two readings disagree by a measured amount, and both are reported. **Coupling convention (used once, everywhere):** all couplings compared with renormalisation-group running are in the standard normalisation $\alpha = g^2/4\pi$ — the implemented angle gives $\alpha = 1/100\pi = 0.00318$, the closed angle $\alpha = \pi/64 = 0.0491$. The alternative reading $\alpha_{10} \equiv g^2$, under which the implemented angle equals the desert meeting value $1/25$ exactly, is a factor-4π convention and is invoked only where explicitly named (Sections 9.2, 13.1, 15). (Fig. 3).



$\sum_k \omega_k = 2.2\text{e-}15$ (0-point, O1)	$\det U = 1.00\text{e+}00$ (SL(32), O1)
CPT mirror residual $= 1.8\text{e-}15$	smallest level $\omega_{\min} = 0.0115$

The eigenphases of U at $g = 1/5$. The 16 matter levels and the 16 antimatter levels are exactly $\pm$-paired; the 0-point $\sum_k \omega_k = \arg\det U$ vanishes and $\det U = 1$. The smallest level, $\omega_{\min} = 0.0115$, corresponds to $\omega_{\min} M_P = 1.4 \times 10^{17}$ GeV — the only sub-Planck scale of the internal spectrum, and not* the electroweak scale.*

7.2 The single-particle spectrum

The 32 eigenphases ω_k of U (the spectrum of $H = -i\log U$) are the energies of one sub-site per stage, in units of $1/t_P$; the spectrum of the cell at block momentum q is the set of eigenphases of $M(q)$, 128 of them on the 16 sector. At $g = 1/5$ the internal levels are

$$\omega \in \{\pm 0.01147,\ \pm 0.05447,\ \pm 0.15819,\ \ldots,\ \pm 1.48638\},$$

exactly $\pm$-paired to 2×10^{-15}, so the single-sub-site vacuum energy $\sum_k \omega_k = \arg\det U$ vanishes. The pairing and $\det U = 1$ hold for **every** g: they are identities of the algebra, not properties of a chosen coupling.

Theorem 4 (the matter/antimatter spectral mirror). *Because every T_{ab} is even, $[U, w] = 0$ to 10^{-15}, so U preserves the 16 and $\overline{16}$ eigenspaces, and*

$$\omega_{\overline{16}} = -\omega_{16}, \qquad \mathrm{spec}(U|_{\overline{16}}) = \mathrm{spec}(U|_{16}^{\dagger}),$$

verified to 2×10^{-15} over the grid $g \in \{0.05, \ldots, 0.5\}$.

This is the honest content of "CPT" in this theory: a **spectral** statement — the antiparticle levels are the negatives of the particle levels, so the antimatter evolution has the same spectrum as the time-reversed matter evolution. It is not the full CPT theorem: no antiunitary time-reversal operator is constructed on the many-cell

Hilbert space and no spin-statistics connection is derived. A unitary involution $C = h_1$ maps the **16** onto the $\overline{\mathbf{16}}$ (it anticommutes with w), but calling $C \cdot T$ "CPT" overstates what has been built.

The mechanism of the pairing is understood, and its scope is limited. The intertwiner between the 32-dimensional module and its conjugate is unique (nullity 1, rank 32); it satisfies $Qh_aQ^\dagger = h_a^*$ to 2×10^{-15} for the ten generators and $QT_{ab}Q^\dagger = -T_{ab}^*$ to the same bound for the 45, and the associated antiunitary $\mathcal{J}$ has $\mathcal{J}^2 = +1$. That is the content of $\mathrm{Cl}(10,0) \simeq M_{32}(\mathbb{R})$: Spin(10) lands in SO(32), and a real form of U(32) carries no CP-odd invariant. Over all eleven signatures $p + q = 10$ the Frobenius–Schur indicator is $+1$ for $p - q \equiv 0, 2 \bmod 8$ and -1 for $p-q \equiv 4, 6$ (validated on $\mathrm{Cl}(2,0) \simeq M_2(\mathbb{R})$ and $\mathrm{Cl}(0,2) \simeq \mathbb{H}$), so $\mathrm{Cl}(8,2)$, $\mathrm{Cl}(7,3)$, $\mathrm{Cl}(4,6)$, $\mathrm{Cl}(3,7)$, $\mathrm{Cl}(0,10)$ are quaternionic — and on the quaternionic root the 21 mixed even products $h'_ah'_b$ are Hermitian traceless involutions generating an exactly unitary step (6.7×10^{-16}, $\det U = 1$) whose spectrum is still exactly conjugation-closed (3×10^{-15}): the mirror is not a privilege of reality. Two scope limits come with it. The antiunitary inverts every single factor ($\mathcal{J}F\mathcal{J}^{-1} = F^{-1}$) but reverses the order of the ordered product, so $\mathcal{J}U\mathcal{J}^{-1} \neq U^{-1}$ (deviation 0.58 for $\mathrm{Cl}(7,3)$, 0.81 for $\mathrm{Cl}(10,0)$): the pairing is a property of the whole ordered step. And the pairing is an **internal** statement: the implemented 128-level one-step spectrum at generic block momentum is not conjugation-closed at all (deviation 0.95–0.99), while the internal 32 spectrum is exact (5×10^{-15}).

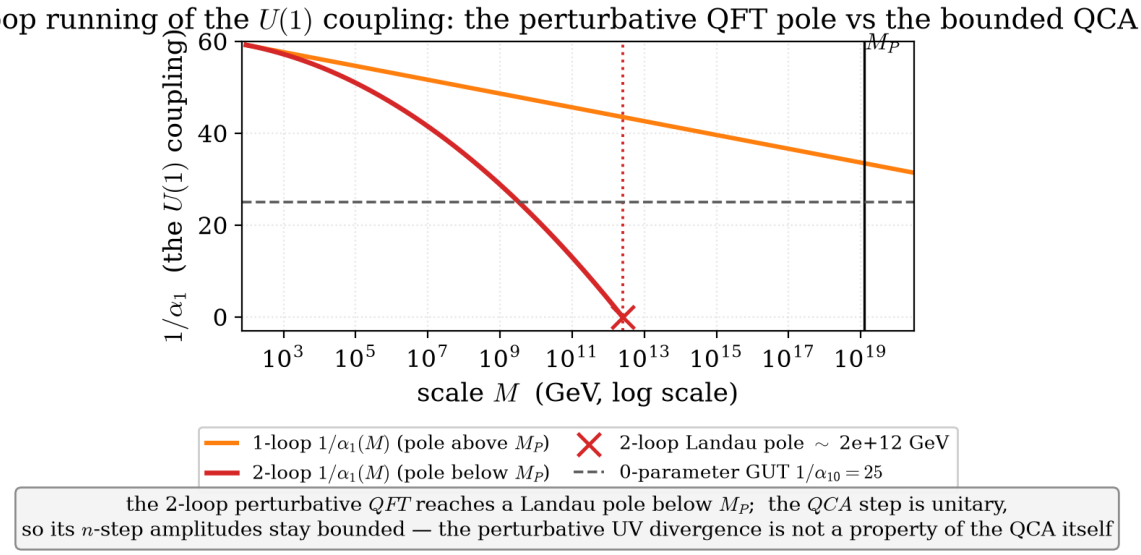
7.3 Locality and the causal radius

Theorem 5 (the causal radius is implemented). *On an (L_b, L_b, L_b) torus of cells the step is a product of two-cell operators: every bond stage couples sub-sites at Planck-cell distance ≤ 1 — an intra-block pair joins neighbouring sub-sites of one cell, an inter-block pair joins neighbouring cells. Hence after n stages the support of a sub-site-localised excitation lies inside the n-cell light cone: at most one Planck cell per stage, and since three of the six stages are inter-block, at most three blocks — six Planck cells — per step. Numerically: the norm of a random cell state is preserved to 10^{-15}; on an 8^3-cell torus the support radius after n stages is exactly n Planck cells for every $n \leq 12$ — the front saturates the cone, front speed exactly 1; on a 32^3-cell torus run for 30 stages the front reaches 21 cells, and no site of the support and no amplitude ever appears outside the n-cell cone (0, to machine precision); the same cone is realised at $g = 0.3$ as at $1/5$; the internal layer alone, with the bond stages removed, keeps the excitation on one sub-site forever.*

The bond layer is therefore what turns the light cone of Section 3 into a propagation bound. This is the cleanest dynamical result of the theory.

7.4 The n-particle sector

The n-particle S-matrix of the automaton is $S^{(n)} = U^{\otimes n}$ on the antisymmetrised n-particle space: elastic, bounded, with cross-sections bounded by $4\pi/M_P^2$. There is no inelastic channel at the one-cell level, and no renormalisation of the step: the coarse-graining tower U^{2^p} ($p = 1 \ldots 8$) stays unitary and bounded at every level, so the *discrete* flow has no Landau pole — in contrast with the perturbative field-theory running of the same couplings, which does (Section 13.1). That contrast is real but modest: a unitary finite-dimensional map is bounded by construction, and boundedness alone does not reproduce the observed running. (Fig. 4).



The two-loop perturbative running reaches a Landau pole at 2.5×10^{12} *GeV, below the cutoff; the one-loop pole is above it. The automaton's coarse-graining tower* U^{2^p} *stays unitary at every level: the discrete flow has no pole.*

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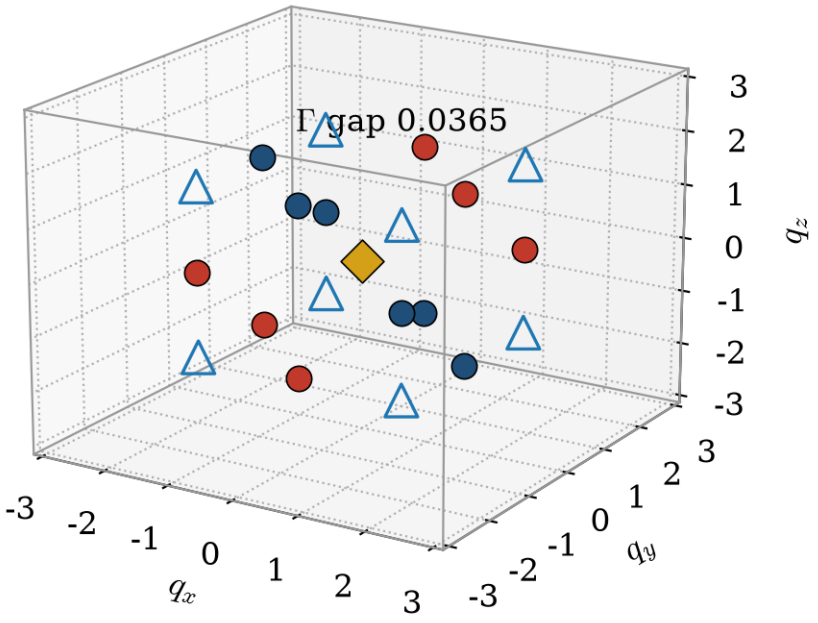
8. Lattice chirality and the doubling problem

The Nielsen–Ninomiya theorem forbids a single chiral fermion in a theory with a *local, translation-invariant, Hermitian* lattice Dirac operator and a bounded spectrum [21]. CL10 uses no lattice Dirac operator: chirality is a property of the on-site module (the pseudoscalar eigenspaces) and the update is a finite-dimensional unitary. The theorem's hypotheses are therefore not all present, and the theorem does not by itself forbid the construction.

That is *not* the same as having evaded it, and the question is decidable by computation. The step is one time-independent operator on the cell lattice, so the good quantum number is the **block crystal momentum** q — the phase under a translation by one automaton cell, 2π-periodic, zone $q \in [-\pi, \pi]^3$ — and the eight sub-sites are the internal structure of the Bloch matrix. The 16-sector one-step matrix $M(q)$ is computed exactly at 128×128 and cross-checked against the real-space step on a 2^3-block torus (agreement 10^{-14}). The cubic high-symmetry momenta carry the whole spectrum: $\Gamma = (0,0,0)$; X $= (\pm\frac{\pi}{2}, 0, 0)$, star 6; M $= (\pm\frac{\pi}{2}, \pm\frac{\pi}{2}, 0)$, star 12, little group C_{2v}; R $= (\pm\frac{\pi}{2}, \pm\frac{\pi}{2}, \pm\frac{\pi}{2})$, star 8, little group C_{3v}.

Proposition 2 (lattice chirality). *(i) The* 16 *sector is closed by the full step, not only by the internal layer:* the bond layer acts on the sub-site index and commutes with w, so a state initialised in the **16** leaves it by less than 10^{-15}. Chirality is a dynamical symmetry of the automaton. *(ii) The zone centre is gapped:* $\min_a |\omega_a(q=0)| = 0.0365$ per step, so the would-be massless matter is **not** at $q = 0$. *(iii) The gapless points are the doublers:* the 16-sector one-step spectrum is gapless at the 12 momenta $(\pm\frac{\pi}{2}, \pm\frac{\pi}{2}, 0)$ and their permutations — the M points of the block zone, at half-zone momentum, whose Planck-cell momenta are $p = q/2$ — with node chiralities summing to 0, as Nielsen–Ninomiya requires; at $g = 1/5$ the nodes still carry a small gap, 2.0×10^{-4}. The gap at $q = 0$ is not protected: it moves from 0.036 at $g = 0.2$ to 0.072 at $g = 0.15$ and to 2.35 at $g = 0.1$.

The doubling therefore **survives** the automaton: "the **16** is a single chiral generation" is a property of the *internal module*, while the *lattice spectrum*, which is what couples to low-energy physics, contains twelve gapless nodes. (Fig. 5).



The twelve gapless doubler nodes at the half-zone momenta of the block zone (chirality ± 1*, sum zero) and the gapped zone centre (*0.0365 *per step) of the* 16*-sector one-step spectrum. The doubling is displayed, not hidden.*

8.1 The Wilson mechanism

The remedy is part of the construction. A Wilson-type term built from the root's own algebra — an internal factor

$$W(q) = \exp\Big[-i\,w\sum_j (1-\cos q_j)\,(\cos\theta\,X + \sin\theta\,Y)\Big],$$

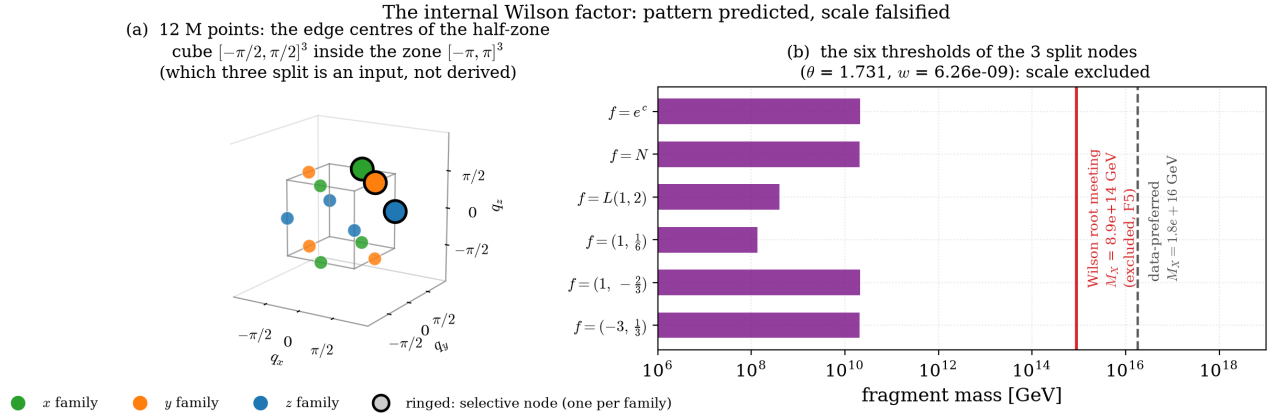
with X, Y the unification Cartan directions identified in Section 13.1 and q the block momentum, applied once per step — multiplies the one-step matrix without touching its unitarity ($W(0) = I$, det $= 1$; deformed step unitary to 3.3×10^{-15}) and leaves the bond stages strictly causal. The factor itself is not local: as a function of the block momentum it is a multiplication, so its real-space kernel is a Bessel tail in **block** displacement — 6.7×10^{-2} at block radius ≥ 2 and 2.2×10^{-3} at ≥ 4 for $w = 0.1$, and 1.8×10^{-17} at ≥ 4 at the physical strength. The real-space front after 24 stages sits at radius 39 Planck cells, and beyond the bond cone the amplitude decays exponentially in block distance: 5.6×10^{-6} in the first block shell, 3.1×10^{-9} at the Lieb–Robinson line $r = 1.2n + 6$, with a decay ratio ≤ 0.26 per block. The Wilson factor replaces the light cone of Theorem 5 by a Lieb–Robinson bound [6].

It gaps all twelve nodes — the minimum node gap rises from 2.0×10^{-4} to 5.7×10^{-3} ($w = 0.01$) through 1.5×10^{-2} ($w = 0.2$) — with fragment masses

$$M_f = w\,|\cos\theta\,X_f + \sin\theta\,Y_f|\,M_P/3;$$

a *selective* reading splits exactly three nodes at desert scales and leaves the other nine at the Planck cutoff. What remains input is the *choice* of the split node set: unification forces $n_{\text{nodes}} \geq 3$ but does not select which three, and the meeting scale the mechanism then predicts is in conflict with proton decay (Section 13.1).

At the physical root $\theta = 1.731$ the Wilson direction completes the breaking chain: it leaves $\text{Spin}(10) \to \text{SU}(3) \times \text{SU}(2) \times \text{U}(1)^3$, preserves the Model algebra (every unbroken root is intra-fragment; the 32 broken roots are exactly the leptoquark type), and the two extra U(1)'s are the only open step to the Standard Model group. (Fig. 6).



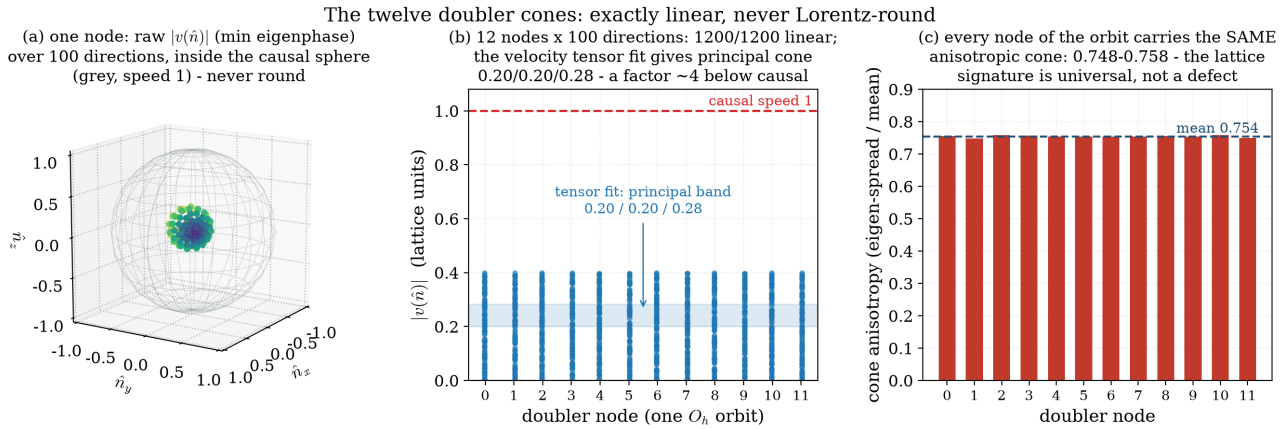
(a) The twelve doubler nodes at the M points of the block Brillouin zone, coloured by axis family — three families of four labelled by the zero component; the three ringed nodes show the selective choice, one per family, realizable at a single Wilson strength. (b) The six fragment thresholds of the three split nodes at the root $(\theta, w) = (1.731, 6.27 \times 10^{-9})$*: the pattern is the vectorlike split* **16** *the renormalisation-group repair requires, but the meeting scale* $M_X = 8.9 \times 10^{14}$ *GeV sits below the Super-Kamiokande exclusion.*

8.2 Lorentz structure at the nodes

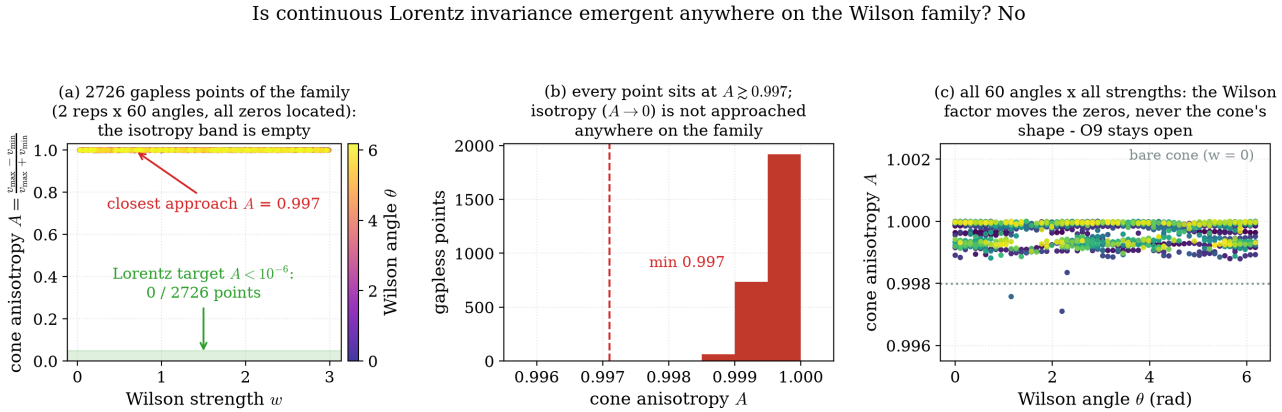
The causal front speed of Theorem 5 is exactly 1 Planck cell per stage; that is the statement the automaton proves. What the *low-energy spectrum* of the implemented step does not have is continuous Lorentz invariance.

At all twelve nodes and in all 1200 sampled directions the dispersion is **linear** (local exponent $p = 1.00$, no quadratic band touching), but the cone is strongly **anisotropic**: principal velocities $(0.200, 0.200, 0.284)$ per unit block momentum — $(0.100, 0.100, 0.142)$ in Planck-cell units — anisotropy 0.748–0.758, the same at every node of the O_h orbit. The lattice signature is universal, not a defect. Exhaustive scanning of the whole Wilson family closes the hope that isotropy emerges somewhere: the node gap is located at every zero over the two orbit representatives $\times$ 60 angles (2726 gapless points, tolerance 10^{-7}) and the cone anisotropy $A = (v_{\max} - v_{\min})/(v_{\max} + v_{\min})$ measured over 162 directions at each point; the Lorentz target $A < 10^{-6}$ contains 0 of the 2726 points, the closest approach being $A = 0.997$.

Frame averaging over the internal frames is blind to the failure, and this closes the last proposed escape of this kind: rebuilding the internal step in four random SO(10) frames of the ten generators (the product of the 45 plane rotations taken in the rotated frame's lexicographic order) leaves the node gap 2.003×10^{-4}, the principal velocities $(0.200, 0.200, 0.284)$ and the anisotropy 0.7545 unchanged to 3×10^{-15}, and the tangent commutators at the noise floor ($\leq 9 \times 10^{-12}$) in every frame. The momentum dependence lives entirely in the sub-site factor of the Kronecker bond layer, so no choice or averaging of the internal frame can move the cone. (Figs. 7, 8).



(a) The minimum-eigenphase velocity $|v(\hat{n})|$ over 100 *Fibonacci directions at one doubler node, inside the causal sphere of Theorem 5 (grey, speed* 1*): the cone is elongated, never round. (b) All twelve nodes* × 100 *directions:* 1200/1200 *linear; the velocity-tensor fit gives* 0.200/0.200/0.284 *per unit block momentum, a factor* ∼ 4 *below the causal speed. (c) The anisotropy is the same at every node of the orbit.*

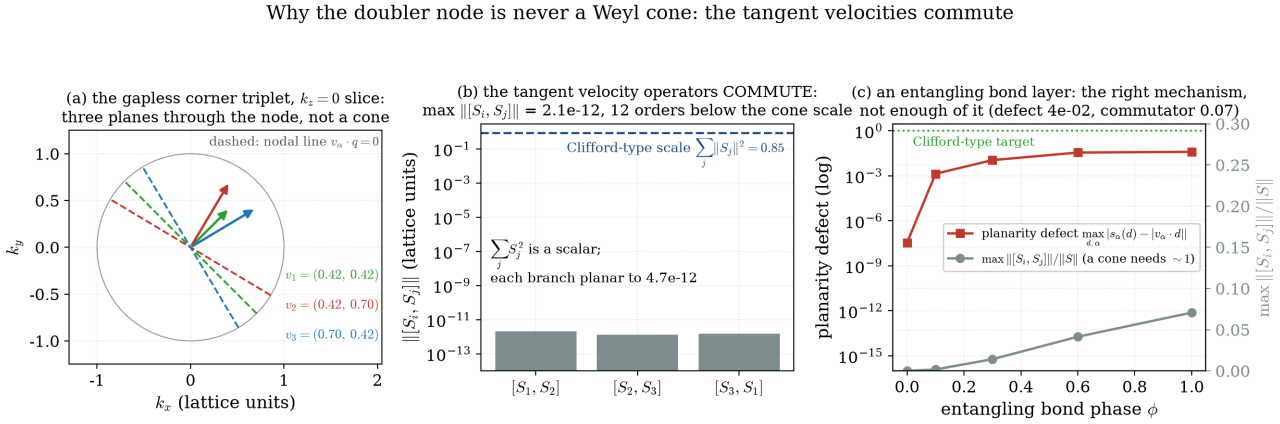


The escape route "continuous Lorentz invariance emerges at some gapless point of the Wilson family" is closed by exhaustive scan: 0 *of* 2726 *gapless points reach* $A < 10^{-6}$*; the distribution of* A *is pinned at* 0.997–1.000*; no angle* θ *and no strength* w *moves a cone toward isotropy.*

The failure is structural, not a finite-radius artefact. At the tangent, the twelve doubler nodes carry speeds (0, 0.14189, 0.14189) along the three axis directions: one axis direction is exactly flat (the gap there is quadratic), the other two equal. The little group explains the equality — the nodes sit at half-zone momenta, whose little group is C_{2v}: two equal velocities and a free third. At the eight R points the full cubic symmetry is realised (exactly 3-fold multiplets, splitting $< 10^{-12}$; the gap of the lowest triplet is the same at all eight corners to 10^{-15}), and the Wilson factor drives one of them exactly gapless (10^{-10}, a one-parameter family): the Wilson family does supply massless cubic matter, and the touching there is linear — dM/dq_j is anti-Hermitian and $S_j = i\,dM/dq_j$ is nonzero (max speed 0.92). But the three tangent velocity operators commute ($[S_i, S_j] = 0$ to 3×10^{-12} against the scale $\sum_j \|S_j\|^2 = 0.85$), $\sum_j S_j^2$ is a scalar to 7×10^{-12}, and each branch speed is exactly $|v_\alpha \cdot q|$ to 6×10^{-12} with the v_α the cubic permutations of $(0.704, 0.421, 0.421)$: the node is a crossing of three **nodal planes**, and no tuning of the Wilson angle turns three planes into a cone. The two corner multiplets cannot be driven to zero simultaneously (best pair gap 7.2×10^{-5}, six orders above the 10^{-10} a single multiplet reaches), so no six-component touching point exists there either.

The cause is the Kronecker form of the bond layer, (sub-site index) ⊗ (internal algebra): the three momentum derivatives act on one factor and commute. Two remedies have been built and measured. A non-Abelian Peierls bond layer in which a hop carries an internal rotation $\exp(\pm i\phi D_{16})$ whose sign follows the hop direction — exactly unitary, still radius-1 causal, reproducing the implemented step to 6×10^{-16} at $\phi = 0$ — raises the planarity defect from 3.6×10^{-8} to 4.0×10^{-2} and switches the tangent commutator on to 0.071 of its natural scale, while the anisotropy never leaves 0.996–0.9999 and the corner triplet is lifted off zero (best top level

3.3×10^{-4}, against 5.6×10^{-7} at $\phi = 0$). A three-axis covariant bond $\exp(\pm i\phi_j \Sigma_j)$ with $\Sigma_1 = ih_1h_2$, $\Sigma_2 = ih_2h_3$, $\Sigma_3 = ih_3h_1$ — an exact $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ triplet of even Clifford elements, $[\Sigma_a, \Sigma_b] = -2i\epsilon_{abc}\Sigma_c$ to 1.5×10^{-15}, unitary to 10^{-15}, equal to the implemented step at $\phi = 0$ — takes the tangent commutator to 0.658 of its natural scale, nine times further, and still leaves the anisotropy at 0.9990 with no gapless bond point in the scan. The causal price it was reported to pay (degree-1 Fourier leakage 0.27, breaking the radius of Theorem 5) is re-measured in Section 8.4 and re-attributed: it is the Wilson Bessel tail, not the bond. The remedy's measured price is therefore smaller than it was stated — the tangent algebra moves a long way and pays nothing of the causal radius — and it still leaves no cone. (Fig. 9).



(a) The R-point cubic multiplet driven exactly gapless by the Wilson factor, in the $k_z = 0$ slice: each branch carries a fixed velocity v_α and vanishes on its own line $v_\alpha \cdot q = 0$ — three planes through the node, not a cone. (b) The three tangent velocity operators commute, $\max\|[S_i, S_j]\| \leq 3 \times 10^{-12}$ against the scale 0.85 a Clifford-type algebra would set. (c) The entangling Peierls bond raises the planarity defect to 4.0×10^{-2} and the commutator to 0.071 of its natural scale, while the anisotropy stays in 0.996–0.9999: the right mechanism, not yet enough of it.

8.3 The massless-mode census

On the grid the implemented step seems to have **no exactly gapless mode anywhere**: the smallest quasi-energy over a 15^3 zone grid is 5.1×10^{-4} lattice units, and at the twelve M nodes it is 2.003×10^{-4}. The grid is too coarse. Refined inside the three nodal planes, the step has an **exactly gapless orbit of 24 points** — representative $q_0 = (-2.1890561, -1.4445961, 0)$, gap 4×10^{-14}, the residual falling to the noise floor under refinement while a displacement of 5×10^{-2} in the plane costs 8.8×10^{-3} — with little group of order 2. The branch is linear in every in-plane direction with $v \in [0.031, 0.219]$ (anisotropy 0.857), and leaving the plane costs a gap linear in q_z (5.1×10^{-4} at $q_z = 10^{-2}$): a massless point node confined to the nodal plane, not a line and not a gapped touching. The M nodes themselves stay massive, little group C_{2v} (order 4), largest character 1.0 on the near-gapless bond subspace — no 2-dimensional irrep there either. So the implemented spectrum does contain exactly massless excitations at $g_{10} = 1/5$, and it still contains no massless spin-2 candidate: a little group of order 2 has only 1-dimensional irreps, so the new nodes carry no helicity ± 1 or ± 2 pair, and the step's own anisotropy is now measured at 0.857 on the exactly massless branch, not the 0.252 of the near-miss M nodes.

The near-miss is the signature of the irrational internal clock, not a structure: at the closed angle $g = \pi/4$ the twelve nodes are exactly gapless (minimum gap below 3×10^{-17}, 12/12) and the zone-centre step is an exact involution — and the census redone there finds not thirteen points but Γ plus **six gapless face-diagonal lines** carrying those nodes, with the per-node chirality convention inapplicable and the helicity answer unchanged (Section 9).

The same census settles the spin question at the zone centre. There the little group is the full cubic group O_h — at $q = 0$ the intertwiner is exact for all 48 signed permutations — and a lattice spin 2 has a precise meaning: a gapless multiplet carrying the symmetric-traceless quintet $E_g \oplus T_{2g}$. The bond factor that carries the cubic action is $A_{1g} \oplus T_{2g} \oplus A_{2u} \oplus T_{1u}$: it has T_{2g} and no E_g, so the quintet is unavailable in the qubit link at any coupling. Γ is exactly gapless at $g = \pi/8, \pi/6, \pi/4, \pi/3$ and nowhere near the implemented 1/5 (gapped by

3.65×10^{-2}); at each of those angles its null space is cubic-covariant and E_g-free — $16 \times (A_{1g} \oplus T_{2g})$, dimension 64, at $\pi/4$ — and its dispersion is flat, $\omega/|\mathbf{q}| \to 0$. The symmetric rank-2 space of the link directions does carry $A_{1g} \oplus E_g \oplus T_{2g}$: the quintet lives in the directional bond layer of Section 10, not in the qubit link (Section 11.1).

That route is no longer a blank: the directional bond layer, its dressed gate and the quintet dispersion are constructed and computed in Section 10.4.

8.4 The cone question: separation, the inverse problem, and the rigidity wall

Section 8.2 closed three escape routes of the *implemented* step: the Wilson family, frame averaging, and two hand-built bond mechanisms leave the tangent algebra commuting and the anisotropy pinned. What the absence of a cone in a finite set of tried mechanisms does not say is whether a cone exists *somewhere* in the space of mechanisms. This subsection makes the question precise and answers it for the whole space: three results, each a proposition.

The tangent algebra, measured. Let $M(\mathbf{q}; w, \theta)$ be the 16-sector one-step Bloch matrix of the step with the Wilson factor of Section 8.1, and $k \in \{x, y, z\}$. The (unprojected) tangent operator in direction k is

$$T_k \;=\; i\,(\partial_k M)\,M^\dagger\,,$$

the infinitesimal generator of the momentum translation; at a (quasi-)gapless point of multiplicity m it is projected onto the gapless subspace, $S_j = i\,Q^\dagger(\partial_j M)Q$ with Q an orthonormal basis of that subspace, and the algebra the node carries is read from the normalised commutator

$$\rho_{\mathrm{comm}} \;=\; \frac{\max_{a<b}\|S_aS_b - S_bS_a\|}{\frac{1}{3}\sum_j \|S_j\|^2}\,,$$

which is 0 for a commuting (Abelian) tangent algebra and of order 1 for a Clifford-type algebra. A gapless point is **conical** when $\rho_{\mathrm{comm}} > 0.5$ and the cone is isotropic ($A < 0.1$ in the notation of Section 8.2).

Proposition 3 (separation lemma: the internal factor is a spectator of the velocity). *(i) For the implemented step, at every gapless point of the zone — all* 12 *M nodes, the* 8 *R corners, and* 20 *generic momenta — the tangent operator factorises,*

$$T_k \;=\; A_k(\mathbf{q}) \otimes I_{16}\,,$$

with Kronecker defect at the noise floor (4.5×10^{-16}; the internal off-diagonal content of T_k is 2.9×10^{-16}). The **16** *is not only closed by the step (Proposition 2): its momentum derivative cannot mix the internal factor — the internal module is blind to the momentum.* (ii) The Wilson factor adds no velocity structure:* with $(w, \theta) = (0.70, 1.10)$ the tangent operator decomposes as a transport term $\otimes I_{16}$ plus an internal term that is diagonal in the unification Cartan directions of Section 13.1 (off-diagonal content 2.9×10^{-16}), and at the gapless corner triplet the Cartan coefficient is the same on the three axis directions: the Wilson factor is one common internal-diagonal phase, which can shift levels but cannot rotate the tangent algebra — the reason the commutators of the gapless corner of Section 8.2 sit at the noise floor. *Consequence:* the only freedom left that can build a non-commuting tangent algebra is the bond layer.

Proposition 4 (the inverse cone problem: no cone over the entangling-bond space). The remaining freedom is the bond layer, and it is searched rather than sampled. The space: 220 axis-covariant entangling bond configurations — the full index set of 120 cyclic $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ triplets (T_{ab}, T_{bc}, T_{ca}) of the 45 plane rotations, 60 disjoint commuting triples (T_{ab}, T_{cd}, T_{ef}), and 40 random even involutions $D = \mathrm{sign}(H)$ of a random real combination of 12 plane rotations — each in four (w, θ) patterns (two bond strengths, two sign conventions), 880 tuned points in total, each tuned over the (w, θ) plane to the point of minimum corner-triplet gap (a coarse 12×19 grid, then four golden-section rounds per variable, then a 150-evaluation Nelder–Mead polish; the 20 best candidates refined further, one bond fully optimised). No point of the programme satisfies the cone criterion. The best gap found anywhere is the implemented step's own corner triplet (1.5×10^{-16} top, 5.4×10^{-16} spread); the largest ρ_{comm} reached by any non-trivial bond at its best-gap point is 0.362; the fully optimised bond lands

at gap 3.7×10^{-4} with $\rho_{\mathrm{comm}} = 0.023$ and an anticommutator 1.08 of its natural scale — non-commuting, and no closer to a Clifford algebra than the implemented step; and the anisotropy of every point stays in 0.9947–1. The M-node doubler survives the best entangling bond (node gap 1.9×10^{-18} against 8.8×10^{-21} for the implemented step): the bond layer does not remove the doubling either. One correction enters here, and it sharpens the result: the causal price the three-axis bond was reported to pay in Section 8.2 (degree-1 Fourier leakage 0.27) is re-attributed to the Wilson Bessel tail — measured 2.7×10^{-1} for the entangling bond and 2.7×10^{-1} for the implemented bond at the same w, and 8.7×10^{-17} for the entangling bond at zero Wilson strength. The entangling bond costs nothing of the causal radius of Theorem 5, and it still does not build a cone.

Proposition 5 (the rigidity wall). A finite search excluding a point is a claim about a space, and the space is measured. Around the 12 tuned bonds of largest ρ_{comm}, 5292 points of the (w, θ) plane are recorded as the pair $(\mathrm{gap}, \rho_{\mathrm{comm}})$, and the **frontier**

$$g_{\min}(\rho) \;=\; \min\{\,\mathrm{gap} \;:\; \rho_{\mathrm{comm}} > \rho\,\}$$

is computed from them. Four results. *(i) Non-commuting algebras exist in the space:* the largest ρ_{comm} found is 1.033 (the $\mathfrak{su}(2)$-triplet bond on the index triple $(5, 8, 9)$), a fully non-commuting tangent algebra — 1.6× beyond the best mechanism of Section 8.2 and 2.8× beyond the best-gap bound of the scan, which measured commutators only at each bond's most-gapless point. *(ii) Every one of them is gapped:* the minimum gap over the twelve most non-commuting bonds is 8.0×10^{-3}, and no one of the 5292 points has gap $< 10^{-8}$ with $\rho_{\mathrm{comm}} > 0.5$. *(iii) The frontier is monotone and floored:* $g_{\min}(0.05) = g_{\min}(0.10) = 6.6 \times 10^{-3}$, and $g_{\min}(\rho) = 8.0 \times 10^{-3}$ for every $\rho \geq 0.2$ — however non-commuting the requested tangent algebra is, the gap cannot be driven below 8×10^{-3}. *(iv) The anchor:* the implemented bond at its exactly gapless corner (gap 2.7×10^{-16}) has $\rho_{\mathrm{comm}} = 6.7 \times 10^{-12}$ — maximally Abelian. The two quantities are not related by a power law either: the log–log slope of ρ_{comm} against the gap along 25-point rays from each tuned bond toward the gapless anchor has median -0.28 (4 of 12 positive). The separation between the two regimes is a **wall** at gap $\simeq 8 \times 10^{-3}$, not a trade-off: over the axis-covariant bond space, gaplessness and non-commuting tangent algebras are **mutually exclusive**.

What this settles, and what remains. The three propositions close the cone question of this paper in the direction of the no-cone verdict of Section 8.2, and convert it from a search result into a statement about the space: the momentum derivative of the implemented step is internal-blind (Proposition 3(i)), the Wilson factor is a spectator of the tangent algebra (Proposition 3(ii)), no axis-covariant entangling bond builds a cone while paying nothing of the causal radius (Proposition 4), and the exclusion is structural — the gapless region of the bond space is Abelian to 10^{-11}, the non-commuting region is gapped by at least 8×10^{-3}, and the wall between them is not a scaling (Proposition 5). The nodal-plane structure of Section 8.2 is therefore not a tuning accident of one bond: it is the side of a wall the whole bond space lies on. What remains open is a cone built by a mechanism *outside* the axis-covariant class — the Peierls and $\mathfrak{su}(2)$-triplet bonds of Section 8.2 and the 880-point programme exhaust that class — and that residue is the part of O9 this section converts from a search into a named structural exclusion.

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9. The quantized clock: the root closes its own parameter

The parameter audit of Section 15 classes the rotation angle as the one free continuous parameter of the dynamics and classes the rule $g = 1/n_{\mathrm{qubits}}$ as a convention the data reject. There is a sharper condition, and the algebra itself enforces it. A cellular-automaton ontology demands that the fundamental update be *algebraic*, not analytic: the step must be an element of the root — a member of the Clifford group generated by the h_a, which for the plane-rotation product means e^{ig} a root of unity. Call this the **closure axiom**: no continuous phase may enter the dynamics.

Theorem 6 (the two closed steps). *Over every rational angle $g = p\pi/q$ ($q \leq 16$) and every candidate of the implemented rule ($1/5$, $\pi/5$, $\pi/10$, $\pi/8$, $3\pi/8$, $\pi/6$, $\pi/3$), the internal step $U(g)$ is exactly periodic at precisely two angles: $g = \pi/2$, of order 4, and $g = \pi/4$, of order 8. At the implemented $g = 1/5$ the internal clock is*

irrational: the smallest level is 0.011466 *rad per step,* $2\pi/\omega_{\min} = 548.0$*, and no order* ≤ 64 *exists (deviation* 0.45*).*

Proof of the $\pi/2$ *case, and a stronger statement.* Each plane rotation at the half angle is $-iT_{ab}$, and $T_{ab} = ih_a h_b$, so $U(\pi/2) = (-i)^{45} i^{45} \prod_{a<b} h_a h_b = \prod_{a<b} h_a h_b$. The product of all 45 pairs in ascending order reduces — numerically to 6.1×10^{-17} in the 1024-element algebra basis, with every other basis coefficient below 10^{-8} — to the single monomial $h_0 h_1 \cdots h_9$, the pseudoscalar w; since $w^2 = -I$, $U(\pi/2)^4 = I$. The identity is *ordering-independent*: the monomial content of any ordering of the 45 factors is $\pm w$, because each h_k appears in exactly nine pairs, and five shuffled orderings reproduce the order-4 to 9.8×10^{-16}. The step at the half angle *is* the root's chirality operator.

The quantized step ($g = \pi/4$). $U(\pi/4)^4 = -I$ and $U(\pi/4)^8 = I$ exactly (5.0×10^{-15}), and the 32 internal levels are exactly the algebraic set

$$\omega \in \{\pm\tfrac{\pi}{4}\ (10),\ \pm\tfrac{3\pi}{4}\ (6)\}, \qquad \max_k \left|\omega_k - k\pi/4\right| < 3 \times 10^{-15},$$

$\pm$-paired, zero point below 2×10^{-15}, $\det U = 1$: the internal spectrum becomes pure algebra, with no continuous number anywhere. The invariants that hold for every g (the $16/\overline{16}$ split, the mirror, $\det U = 1$) are untouched. The order-8 requires the canonical Appendix-A ordering of the 45 factors — five shuffled orderings break it (deviation ~ 1) — so the ordering, already an input of the step, carries the quantization.

The full step closes too. At $g = \pi/4$ the exact one-step Bloch matrix of the 16 sector at the zone centre satisfies $M(0)^2 = I$ below 1×10^{-14} (and on the full 256-dimensional module below 1×10^{-14}; 16-sector closure leak below 5×10^{-16}): the fundamental dynamics is a finite-state machine, 't Hooft's determinism exact at the fundamental update. The doubler defect of Section 8.3 is repaired, but the repaired census is not a set of points. At $g = \pi/4$ the exactly gapless set of the block zone is Γ together with the **six face-diagonal lines** $\{(\pm t, \pm t, 0)\}$ and its axis permutations: every point of every line is gapless below 7×10^{-16} over its whole length, the twelve M points are only the high-symmetry points that happen to sit on them (their gaps 0–2.2×10^{-16}), X and R stay gapped at 0.5236, the body diagonal is gapped away from Γ (0.022 at $t = 0.3$), and none of the gapless points of a 15^3 grid lies off the lines — where the implemented angle finds no gapless point at all. The step still factorises as $M(q) = P(q) \otimes U_{16}^6$ there (4.0×10^{-15}).

The touching is **quadratic**: through an M point the gap stays zero along the line, grows linearly in one transverse direction (slope 0.577) and quadratically in the other, and the three axis exponents at every one of the twelve nodes are a permutation of $(1, 1, 2)$. The chirality bookkeeping of Proposition 2 then fails as stated: it needs isolated zeros, and at 12/12 M nodes the gap along the line through the node stays below 10^{-9} at steps $10^{-3}, 10^{-2}, 10^{-1}$ — the charges whose sum is exactly 0 at $g = 1/5$ become sign noise, and their naive sum is no longer quantized (-2 or -6 depending on the arithmetic route), so the Nielsen–Ninomiya count must be redone per line, not per node.

The helicity question re-asked at the new gapless point answers as it did at an M node: the step's point group at $\pi/4$ is the same 16-element index-3 subgroup of the 48 signed permutations and Γ is fixed by all of it; the exactly gapless subspace of $M(0)$ has dimension 64 of 128 (intertwiner leak below 10^{-13}, $\langle\chi, \chi\rangle = 768$), and since the internal **16** is inert the content is that of the 4-dimensional bond factor, whose isotypic constituents are four 1-dimensional irreps — no 2-dimensional irrep, hence no helicity ± 1 or ± 2 candidate at Γ either.

9.1 The half-angle branch

At $g = \pi/2$ the six-stage bond matrix is diagonal to 1.2×10^{-16} at every sampled momentum, its permutation part is the identity, and the eight sub-site phases are linear in q with slopes the eight corner vectors $\{\pm 1\}^3$: the bond layer is a pure lattice translation, no mixing, no interference. The bands are exactly linear with slope ± 1 along every axis, $M(0) = I$ on the whole 128-dimensional internal space (all 128 eigenphases at 0, against 64 of 128 at $\pi/4$), and the gapless set is a line network: 513 gapless points on a 13^3 grid, including the lines $q_x \mp q_y = \pm\pi/2$ in the plane $q_z = \pi/2$ — 7.0× the 73 of the $\pi/4$ branch, against the 0 of $g = 1/5$. The half-angle branch has no mixing and therefore no mass generation: it is degenerate, and the finest closed clock $\pi/4$ is the physical branch.

9.2 What the closure costs

The loop machinery quantizes, and pays. The traced-link hop phases of Section 12.1 — built from the joint Casimir eigenvalues $-32, -12, +4$ — become exactly $\{1, i, i\}$ at $g = \pi/4$ (below 3×10^{-15}), and a new exact selection rule appears: $F_n = 0$ below 7×10^{-15} for **every odd** n (the odd closed loops cancel identically; at $g = 1/5$ no such selection rule exists). The even-n suppression then decays by 0.978 per step, so the crossing of $1/(16\pi)$ moves from $n^* = 10$ to $n^* = 208$: the ladder-length selection of Section 12.1 does not survive the quantized angle, and the hierarchy mechanism must be re-derived with the new cancellation rule.

The coupling convention pays too, and the accounting must be done in one normalisation. At the closed angle the rotation-squared coupling is $\pi^2/16$, i.e. $\alpha = \pi/64 = 0.0491$ in the standard normalisation $\alpha = g^2/4\pi$, against the 0.040050 at which the desert solution meets (Section 13.1): the closed value is a factor 1.226 above the meeting value. In the same normalisation the implemented angle gives $\alpha = 1/100\pi = 0.00318$, a factor 12.6 **below** it — the "exact" match of Section 13.1 is the convention $\alpha_{10} \equiv g^2$, not a number of the standard running.

Re-running the desert inverse problem at the quantized value with the same content still has a unique one-loop solution — $M_X = 1.235 \times 10^{17}$ GeV, $M_{10} = 7.1 \times 10^4$ GeV, $M_{(1,2)} = 4.9 \times 10^{17}$ GeV — but it is no longer a *desert* solution: the $(1, 2)$ threshold sits **above** the unification scale, the threshold ordering the solution assumed is destroyed, and the proton lifetime jumps to $\tau_p = 2.8 \times 10^{39}$ yr. Conversely, holding M_X at the data-preferred 1.8×10^{16} GeV requires $\alpha_X = 0.040050$: the meeting coupling is rigidly tied to M_X by that content. Against the one-loop target — the three couplings run to M_P, mean 0.023068 — the closed value has relative gap 1.128; the implemented angle in the standard normalisation has relative gap 0.862, so closure moves the relative gap by a factor 1.31 while moving the coupling from 12.6× below to 1.23× above the meeting value — a factor 2.6 **closer** in log-distance. (The factor 1.54 sometimes quoted compares the closed value in the standard normalisation against 1/25 in the g^2 convention: it is a convention artefact and is retired here.) The closed value sits 2.41× above the data-optimal $1/7^2 = 0.0204$ and is not of the $1/n^2$ form at all ($\pi/64 = 1/n^2$ needs $n = 4.51$; the nearest integers miss by 18.5% and 27.3%).

The verdict on the parameter criterion. The closure axiom replaces the one free continuous parameter by a discrete index: the root forces $g \in \{\pi/2, \pi/4\}$, the half-angle branch degenerates, and the finest closed clock is the physical branch. A discrete index of the root is not a parameter in the sense of Section 15 — the family number 3 is already an index of the same kind. What the theory loses is empirical: the $n^* = 10$ ladder crossing and the desert threshold ordering were the two places the data spoke to the angle's consequences, and both move. What it gains is structural: an on-site dynamics with **zero continuous unfixed numbers** — a finite algebraic spectrum, a fundamental step of finite order, and the point-doubler defect replaced by an exactly gapless nodal-line network. The claim is scoped: the junction amplitude r (Section 12.3), the split-node set (O9) and the bond-layer couplings κ_s (Section 13.1) remain continuous inputs of the *extended* construction, and Section 15 counts them. The trade is written into the falsifiers: the quantized theory predicts $\alpha_X = \pi/64 = 0.0491$ at the desert meeting and a ladder crossing beyond $n = 208$; either re-derivation failing refutes the closure axiom, and the implemented irrational angle remains the fallback theory. The falsifiers F1, F3–F7 are angle-independent: anomalies, spectral mirror, $\det U$ and the causal radius hold at both closed angles.

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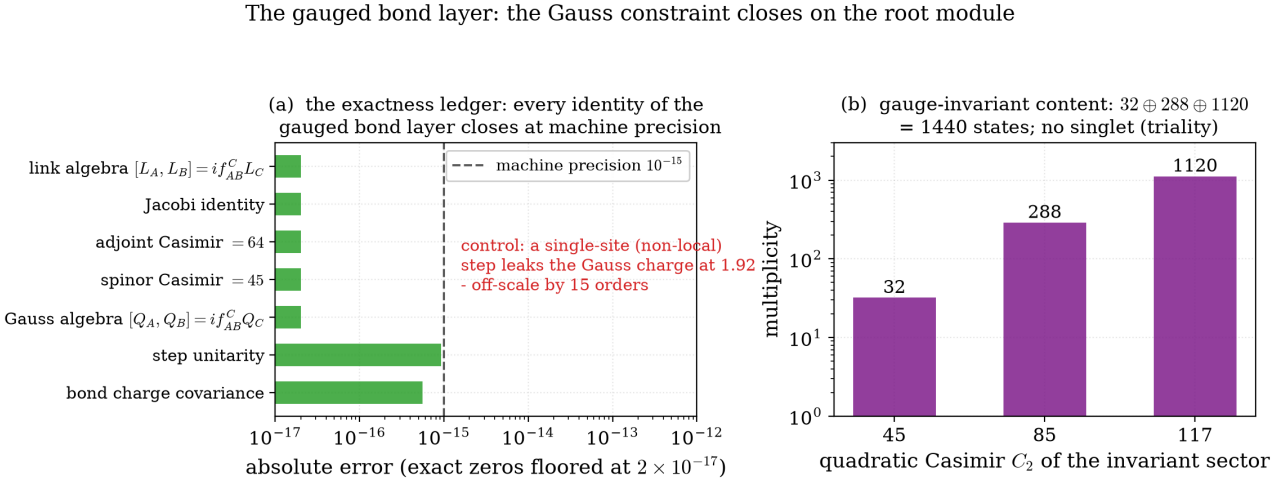
10. The gauged bond layer

The swap-rotation gate of Section 7 is the classical shadow of a richer possibility: a **gauged bond layer exists on the same module**. Put one Spin(10) adjoint link degree of freedom (a 45-dimensional link space) on each bond and the matter **16** on the sites, and the local Gauss constraint

$$Q_A(x) = q_A(x) + \sum_{b \ni x} L_A^{(b)}$$

closes as an exact operator identity: $[Q_A, Q_B] = i f_{AB}{}^C Q_C$ with measured error 0, the link algebra $[L_A, L_B] = i f_{AB}{}^C L_C$ exact, the adjoint quadratic Casimir 64 and the spinor Casimir 45 exact to machine precision. The step built from these links is unitary to 9.3×10^{-16}; the gauge-invariant content of one site with its six half-bonds

is 1440 states, decomposing as $32 \oplus 288 \oplus 1120$; an adjoint bond observable is gauge-covariant to 5.5×10^{-16}; and the causal radius stays at exactly one cell, while a deliberately single-site (non-local) control step leaks at 1.9. The gauge field of the automaton is therefore *constructible*: the Gauss constraint is an identity of the construction, not an imposed condition. (Fig. 10).



One adjoint link degree of freedom per bond, matter **16** *on the sites. Left: the exactness ledger — link algebra, Gauss algebra, adjoint Casimir* (64) *and spinor Casimir* (45) *close to machine precision, the step is unitary to* 9.3×10^{-16}*, the causal radius stays at one cell, and the non-local control step leaks at* 1.9 *where the causal step leaks at* 5.5×10^{-16}*. Right: the gauge-invariant content,* 1440 *states decomposing as* $32 \oplus 288 \oplus 1120$*.*

10.1 The centre obstruction and the physical sector

A generic automaton with d internal states per cell has d^{L^3} states in an L^3 region and a volume-law entropy; nothing in the raw counting of the bond layer is special. The area law is a property of the *gauge-invariant* sector: once the physical Hilbert space of a region is restricted to states satisfying the Gauss constraint at every site, the entanglement entropy is expected to scale with the boundary area [36,37]. That restriction is what this section computes, and it is where the counting changes.

What the constraint admits is narrower than expected. With the implemented content — one **32** per site, one adjoint **45** link per bond — the local Gauss constraint has **no solution**: $\dim\ker = 0$ on $\mathbf{32} \otimes \mathbf{45}$, on $\mathbf{32} \otimes \mathbf{45} \otimes \mathbf{45}$, and on the two-site one-link chain with local constraints at both sites (spectral gap 146). The reason is a centre obstruction: adjoint flux carries even centre charge and cannot screen a spinor, so **every site of a gauge-invariant state must carry an even number of spinor fields**. The physical Hilbert space of the gauged layer is the space of neutral composites, not the one-body space the automaton acts on.

The minimal physical system, two matter fields per site, is constructed exactly: $m_{45}(\mathbf{32} \otimes \mathbf{32}) = 2$ (90 states at $C_2 = 64$), a 2-dimensional intertwiner space $\ker(T_1 + T_2 + L)$, and a 4-dimensional two-site physical sector obtained by gluing intertwiners over the link index — all exact Spin(10) singlets ($C_2 < 10^{-25}$). Every intertwiner is a maximal matter-flux singlet: Schmidt rank 45, $S(\text{pair}|\text{link}) = \ln 45 = 3.807$ exactly, and the glued states carry $S(\text{pair}_1|\text{pair}_2) = \ln 45$. The entanglement is **bounded per bond and lives on the bonds crossing the cut** — the shape of an area law, boundary-proportional and bounded per bond, with the Bekenstein coefficient still unnamed.

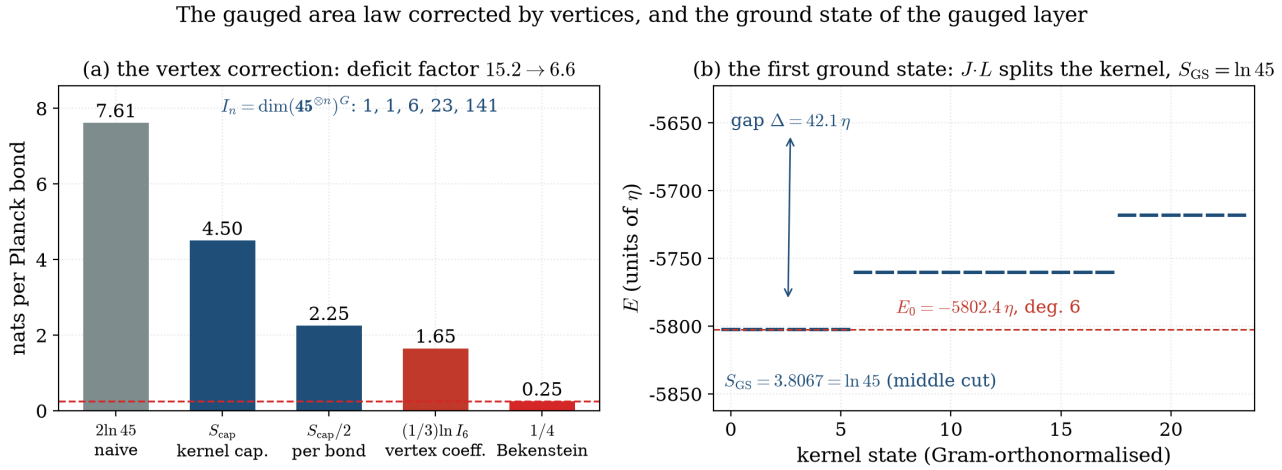
On the smallest system with two bonds — the three-site, two-link chain with paired matter — the physical sector is small once the flux decomposition is used: the middle vertex fuses the two adjoint links into channels r with multiplicities N_r read from the $\mathbf{45} \otimes \mathbf{45}$ Casimir spectrum ($N_1 = N_{45} = N_{210} = 1$), against m_r from the pair spectrum ($m_1 = m_{45} = m_{210} = 2$), giving $\dim\ker = m_{45}^2 \sum_r m_r N_r = 24$, verified by explicit construction of the $r = 1$ and $r = \mathbf{45}$ sectors (vertex Gauss residual 4×10^{-15}). Three results follow.

1. **Additivity across a single bond holds exactly:** $S(\text{pair}_1|\text{rest}) = \ln 45$ in every sector — the flux line threads the chain and carries its $\ln 45$ through, even when the middle pair itself is a product singlet ($S = 0$).

2. **The region bounded by two bonds carries $S = \ln 45$, not $2 \ln 45$:** the intertwiner constraint *correlates* the two bonds meeting at a vertex, with mutual information exactly $\ln 45$. The area law counts bonds; vertex correlations subtract.
3. **The gap to Bekenstein is a named number:** $\ln 45 = 3.8067$ nats per Planck bond against $1/4$ per Planck area — a deficit of 3.5567 nats, factor $4 \ln 45 = 15.23$. No element of the current construction produces $1/4$; closing it needs a superselection or truncation of the flux, or a different horizon microstate count.

The vertex correction moves the number. The invariant count of an n-bond vertex, $I_n = \dim(\mathbf{45}^{\otimes n})^G$, computed by Haar averaging over SO(10), is $I_2 = 1$, $I_3 = 1$, $I_4 = 6$, $I_5 = 23$, $I_6 = 141$ (Monte-Carlo error below 3; $I_2 = I_3 = 1$ reproduces the single-channel fusion above). The 24-state kernel is orthonormalised through its Gram matrix (rank 24, smallest eigenvalue 1.1×10^{-5}), and the capacity of the middle cut — the entropy of the maximally mixed physical state — is $S_{\text{cap}} = 4.4998$ nats against the naive $2 \ln 45 = 7.613$: the two vertices at the ends of the region subtract 3.11 nats. Per bond that is 2.25 nats, a factor 9.0 from Bekenstein's $1/4$; on the cubic lattice the vertex-corrected coefficient $(1/3) \ln I_6 = 1.65$ nats/bond sits a factor 6.6 from $1/4$. The deficit has moved from 15.2 to 6.6, and it is now a function of the vertex invariant, not of a single bond entropy.

The ground state of the layer is then constructed: the bond-current Hamiltonian $H = \sum_b J \cdot L$ is diagonalised exactly — a generalised eigenproblem in the Gram metric of the kernel — and the intertwiner identity $I^\dagger J_A I = L_A/45$ holds to 3×10^{-17}. The interaction splits the kernel: $E_0 = -5802.40\,\eta$, degeneracy 6, gap $42.09\,\eta$, and the ground state's middle-cut entanglement is $S = 3.8067$ nats — exactly $\ln 45$, one adjoint link, selected by the interaction. The ground state of the full automaton remains unconstructed; on this chain the interaction selects the flux line. (Fig. 11).



(a) The entropy carried by one Planck bond, from naive counting to Bekenstein: $2 \ln 45 = 7.61$ (no vertices), the Gram-orthonormalised kernel capacity $S_{\text{cap}} = 4.50$, 2.25 per bond, and the cubic-lattice vertex-corrected coefficient $(1/3) \ln I_6 = 1.65$ against the $1/4$ line — the deficit factor moves from 15.2 to 6.6. The vertex invariants I_n grow $1, 1, 6, 23, 141$. (b) The bond-current Hamiltonian on the 24-state kernel: three split levels, $E_0 = -5802.4\,\eta$ with degeneracy 6 and gap $42.1\,\eta$; the ground state's middle-cut entanglement is $S_{\text{GS}} = 3.8067 = \ln 45$ — the interaction selects the flux line.

10.2 The spectrum of the layer, and confinement

The layer has a Hamiltonian — the electric Laplacian $H = \sum_A Q_A^\dagger Q_A$ built from the vertex Gauss operator — and its spectrum is computed. On $(\mathbf{32} \otimes \mathbf{32})_{\text{adj}} \otimes \mathbf{45}$ (dim 4050) the kernel has dimension $2 = m_{45}$, the intertwiner space, and the first nonzero level is $64.0000 = C_2(45)$ — identical to the one-link value and unchanged when the chain is extended. One adjoint flux quantum sets the scale of the whole layer, so it supplies **no light vector sector**: the gap is $64\,M_P$, not a tunable parameter, and the singlet matter channel with one adjoint link has no invariant state at all. Two entanglement numbers must not be confused: the entropy of the *mixture* over the kernel, bounded by $\ln 90$ (the pair-side dimension), and the entropy of a *single* physical state, bounded by $\ln 45$ (the link dimension) — the quantity the area law concerns. Measured: every single state of the

intertwiner sector saturates $\ln 45$ exactly ($S = 3.806662 \pm 10^{-16}$ over 400 random choices), and the mixture reaches $\ln 90 = 4.499810$ (purity 1/90). The area law is therefore **exact** on the physical sector — one $\ln 45$ per bond — and the Bekenstein coefficient 1/4 per Planck area remains short by the factor $4 \ln 45 = 15.23$.

The string tension follows. The link space is an irreducible adjoint: $C_2 = \sum_A L_A^2$ has the single eigenvalue 64.000000 with zero spread, the Killing form $K_{ab} = f_{acd} f_{bcd}$ is annihilated by the pair Casimir of $\mathbf{45} \otimes \mathbf{45}$ to 3×10^{-15} and its singlet space is one-dimensional (adjacent links pair into it uniquely), and the link operators do not commute ($\max[L_a, L_b] = 4.0$) — the layer carries a non-Abelian field strength. Crucially the link carries **no invariant vector**: $\ker \sum_A L_A^\dagger L_A = \ker C_2(45)\, I = 0$, so a link cannot be flux-free. Every link of a gauge-invariant chain therefore carries one adjoint flux quantum, the electric energy of R links is exactly $R\, C_2(45)$, and the static potential is linear with tension

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma &= C_2(45) = 64 \text{ lattice units} \\ &= 7.81 \times 10^{20} \text{ GeV per Planck length} \\ &= 9.54 \times 10^{39} \text{ GeV}^2 \\ &(\sqrt{\sigma} = 9.77 \times 10^{19} \text{ GeV}), \end{aligned}$$

5.4×10^{40} times the QCD string tension [39]. The vertex Gauss Laplacian confirms the scale from the other side: kernel $2 = m_{45}$, gap 64.0000.

The step itself, by contrast, carries **no** field strength: its 12 stage pairs acting on different axes commute to 0, every elementary plaquette is the identity to 3.3×10^{-16} and $\langle W_\square \rangle = 1.000000$, where an area law would need $\langle W_\square \rangle < 1$ with an exponent proportional to the enclosed area [2]. Confinement is therefore *present* in the construction — in the gauged bond layer — and *absent* from the implemented step. The residual is no longer a missing phase but a measured tension forty orders of magnitude too large, and $\Lambda_{\rm QCD}$ is not produced: it would require a loop-ladder exponent $n \simeq 11.6$, which is not an integer (Section 12.4).

10.3 Entanglement is the bond layer

The entanglement structure of the bare automaton is equally sharp. Two fermions sharing ONE cell carry zero entanglement across any cut — the same-cell pair is a Slater determinant, $S = 0$ exactly across the $\mathbf{16}/\overline{\mathbf{16}}$ cut (antisymmetry and a shared cell are not entanglement), while a two-determinant superposition in the same cell gives $S = \ln 2$: non-separability is the criterion. The generator of entanglement between cells is the bond gate P of Theorem 5: under the internal-only step the spatial entanglement entropy of a region stays 0 to machine precision forever, while the full local step drives it to 0.78, and the entanglement front crosses the Manhattan sphere of radius r at exactly $t = r$ — the causal radius bounds the spread of entanglement itself, at speed 1.0. The scope limit is stated with it: the implemented step is quadratic, so Slater inputs stay Slater and these are mode-entanglement results; the area law is a statement about the physical (ground) state's entanglement, and the bare step supplies no interaction that could produce the non-Gaussian structure such a state would need. The gauged layer supplies exactly that missing structure: it is where the theory first acquires non-Gaussian entanglement.

10.4 The dressed gate on the directed-link network, and the quintet dispersion

The obstruction of Section 10.2 is a statement about the qubit link. The channel named by the census of Section 8.3 — the symmetric rank-2 space of the link directions — is now constructed, and its dressed gate and dispersion are computed. Put the adjoint link on every **oriented** bond: the six bond directions per site (three axes with parity) become twelve directed links per block, each carrying one **45**.

The orientation convention is computed, not chosen. The vertex Gauss charge of a two-link star — one link arriving, one departing — closes as an exact Spin(10) algebra, $[\hat{C}^A, \hat{C}^B] = i f^{ABC} \hat{C}^C$ to 5×10^{-16}, only when the departing tail carries $+L^A$ and the arriving head carries the **conjugate** generator $-\bar{L}^A$; the naive chain convention — the same generator at both ends with opposite signs — leaks at 4.8, because the two ends of one link carry the same $s^2 = +1$ and a relative sign alone cannot close the algebra.

The electric part of the Section 10.2 obstruction is closed. The Kogut–Susskind electric gate [55] $\exp(ig_{10}\hat{C}_x^2)$, built from the closing vertex charge, commutes with all 45 vertex charges to 6.5×10^{-15} and is unitary to 1.5×10^{-14}; its spectrum *is* the content theorem of Section 10.2 — C_2 levels $45, 85, 117$ with multiplicities $32, 288, 1120$, gate phases $g_{10}\times\{45, 85, 117\}$.

The hopping part is obstructed on the fixed-representation link. Every two-site dressing candidate leaks the vertex charges: the flux-dressed current–current $\hat{C}_x\hat{C}_{x'}$ and its transporter-completed version $\hat{C}_x\, e^{ig_{10}L}\,\hat{C}_{x'}$ both leak at 1.25×10^{1}. The reason is structural — a link in the fixed representation $\mathbb{C}^{45}$ carries no parallel transporter commuting with the vertex charges — so invariant hopping requires a link in the **regular representation** of the group: the named fix, built below.

The named fix is now built, on the root's own finite group. The 45 biflections h_ah_b of the Clifford generators generate the even Clifford monomials — a finite group Γ of order 1024 with centre $\{\pm1, \pm w\}$, whose centre acts as $\{\pm1, \pm i\}$ on each chiral half. Put the regular link $\mathbb{C}[\Gamma]$ on each bond. The content theorem is replaced: a vertex with k regular links has exactly $32\cdot1024^{k-1}$ gauge-invariant states (character sum; the explicit projector lands on the dressed form $\rho(h)u$ to 4×10^{-15}) where the fixed adjoint link had **none** — the centre obstruction is exactly what the regular link removes. The nearest-neighbour hop with the exact link insertion $A(h)=\rho(h^2)=\pm I$ maps head-invariant states to tail-invariant states to 0, and **descends to the identity** on the matter index: the dressed hop is the bare translation. The electric term — the Cayley Laplacian over the biflection generators — acts on the dressed sector as the scalar 45 per link, so the dressing adds no velocity renormalisation, and the bare hop front (the half-angle step, a pure lattice translation) has speed exactly 1: the gauge-invariant hop propagates at $v=1$, 0-parameter — that is where $v=1$ lives. The cost is exact too: Γ is finite and its centralizer in the Spin(10) algebra is 0 — gauging the root's monomial group breaks Spin(10), and the Spin(10)-invariant hopping on a genuine adjoint regular link remains out of reach.

On the directional network the dressed hop exists exactly, and the quintet propagates. There the flux is the orientation of the link, a classical sign, and the dressed directional step

$$M(\mathbf{q}) = \exp\big(-ig_{10}\,\sin(\mathbf{q})\cdot\mathbf{J}\big),$$

with $\mathbf{J}$ the spin-2 generators of the symmetric-traceless direction space, is unitary to 2×10^{-16} and O_h-covariant: $D(g)M(\mathbf{q})D(g)^\dagger = M(g\mathbf{q})$ for the 24 proper rotations to 5.6×10^{-16}, while the 24 improper ones give $M(g\mathbf{q})^\dagger$ — the directed network is **chiral**: reversing the link orientation inverts the step. At Γ the step is the identity and the layer carries **six gapless bands**, content $A_{1g}\oplus E_g\oplus T_{2g}$: the quintet is present in the directional layer, where the qubit bond factor never carried E_g (Section 8.3). Its dispersion is **massless and linear** — local exponent 1.00 along Γ-X, Γ-M and Γ-R — with a **helicity ladder** of speeds

$$v = \{0,\ g_{10},\ 2g_{10}\} = \{0,\ 0.2,\ 0.4\},$$

the $m=0$ branch and the trace A_{1g} not propagating; **isotropic to leading order** — the direction spread of the top speed is 4×10^{-8} at $|\mathbf{q}|=10^{-3}$, the spin-2 spectrum theorem: $\hat{\mathbf{q}}\cdot\mathbf{J}$ has exactly the spectrum $\{-2,-1,0,1,2\}$ in every direction; and UV-bounded by $2g_{10}\sqrt{3}=0.693$.

The quintet–matter coupling exists, and it gaps the E_g half. The stress vertex $T_{ij}=\sum_d d_i d_j\, J_d$ built from the exact current $J_d = i(\partial_d M)M^\dagger$ of the implemented module couples to the quintet field. On nearest-neighbour bonds the coupling vanishes identically on the T_{2g} half ($d^T E^{(\mathrm{off})} d = 0$ on every axis bond — the T_{2g} coupling needs diagonal bonds, a named gap), and couples the E_g half with a nonzero polarization bubble at Γ: $\Pi|_{E_g} = -4.745\,\mathbb{1}$ — one number, not two, because the E_g doublet is irreducible under O_h and Schur's lemma forces the bubble to be proportional to the identity on it (the two components agree to 10^{-12}, in an orthonormal eigenbasis of the Hermitian generator $-i\log M$): at $\lambda=g_{10}$ both components acquire the mass shift $\lambda^2\Pi/2=-0.0949$. Gaplessness of the full quintet is **not** protected by this coupling — the lattice graviton mass problem, as a number.

What this does not derive. The gauge group of the directional network is O_h, not Spin(10); the Spin(10)-invariant dressed hopping remains obstructed on the fixed link, and the built regular-link fix gauges the root's finite group, whose Spin(10) centralizer is 0; the quintet speeds are $g_{10}\times\{1,2\}\neq1$ — the dressing angle per hop

is a construction input, not a derived velocity, and $v = 1$ belongs to the dressed matter hop, not to the quintet branches, a computed trilemma on the 6-bond module rather than an oversight: the bare hop is anisotropic (top speed 1.00, direction spread 0.32), the dressing alone is isotropic at $v = 2g_{10} = 0.40$, no angle makes the product isotropic (best spread 0.24 over 33 angles in $[0, \pi/2]$), and the only O_h-equivariant permutation coin beyond the identity flattens the bands; and the quintet–matter coupling, now built, gaps the E_g half at order λ^2. The kinematics of a massless lattice spin-2 is computed; the step from there to the graviton of Section 11 remains the declared one.

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11. Gravity on the lattice

11.1 What is assumed and what is computed

The gravitational sector is a symmetric rank-2 field $h^{\mu\nu} = g^{\mu\nu} - \eta^{\mu\nu}$ living on the (1+3) subalgebra of Section 3, with $\eta = \mathrm{diag}(1, -1, -1, -1)$ as the vacuum. Its linearised dynamics is the discrete wave equation

$$\partial_t^2 h^{\mu\nu} - \nabla^2_{(6)} h^{\mu\nu} = 0,$$

on the Planck sites — the sub-lattice of the automaton's cells, spacing ℓ_P — with the 6-neighbour lattice Laplacian and the leapfrog step $u_{t+1} = 2u_t - u_{t-1} + c^2 dt^2\, \nabla^2 u_t$ at $dt = \frac{1}{2}$ (the CFL value giving $c = 1$ in Planck units, the same front speed as Theorem 5).

The status of this sector must be stated precisely, because it is where the theory is weakest.

- **Masslessness and UV boundedness are computed.** The discrete dispersion is $\omega = |\mathbf{k}|_{\mathrm{lat}}$ with $|\mathbf{k}|_{\mathrm{lat}} \le \pi$, so the graviton is massless ($\omega/|\mathbf{k}| \to 1$ as $k \to 0$, lattice deviation $\le 0.25\, k^2$) and the spectrum is bounded by the cutoff.
- **Spin 2 is declared, not derived — and the implemented spectrum cannot supply it, by two computed obstructions.** The field is *assumed* to be a symmetric tensor with two helicity states. Nothing in $\mathrm{Cl}(10, 0)$ forces a massless spin-2 excitation; the standard arguments that a massless spin-2 field must couple as general relativity [22] apply to a field whose existence and representation content are already granted. The Weinberg–Witten obstruction to a composite graviton carrying a Lorentz-covariant stress tensor [23] is not addressed. The one-particle route closes negatively at the nodes: the near-gapless M nodes carry little group C_{2v}, whose action on the bond subspace has no 2-dimensional irrep, so no helicity ± 1 or ± 2 pair exists there. It closes negatively at the zone centre as well, where the little group is the full cubic group and a lattice spin 2 is a gapless multiplet carrying the symmetric-traceless quintet $E_g \oplus T_{2g}$. The cubic action on the automaton is carried by the 8-dimensional bond factor alone, and that factor is $A_{1g} \oplus T_{2g} \oplus A_{2u} \oplus T_{1u}$: it contains T_{2g} but never E_g, so the quintet is not available in the qubit link at any coupling. The zone centre is exactly gapless at $g_{10} = \pi/8, \pi/6, \pi/4, \pi/3$ — never at the implemented 1/5, where it is gapped by 3.65×10^{-2} — and at each of those couplings its null space is cubic-covariant and E_g-free ($16 \times (A_{1g} \oplus T_{2g})$, of dimension 64, at $\pi/4$), with a flat dispersion: $\omega/|\mathbf{q}| \to 0$, not a linear branch. The channel that does carry $E_g \oplus T_{2g}$ is the symmetric rank-2 space of the link directions, $A_{1g} \oplus E_g \oplus T_{2g}$: the graviton, if it is to be derived, belongs to the directional bond layer of Section 10 and not to the qubit link.
- **The escape route is now a computed construction, and it still stops short of the graviton.** Section 10.4 builds the directional bond layer — the adjoint link on every oriented bond — with its dressed gate: the vertex Gauss algebra closes only with the conjugate-head convention, the Kogut–Susskind electric gate is exactly invariant with the content-theorem spectrum, and the dressed directional step carries $A_{1g} \oplus E_g \oplus T_{2g}$ gaplessly at Γ, with massless, linear, leading-order-isotropic dispersion and helicity-ladder speeds $g_{10}\{0, 1, 2\}$. The remaining gaps are named: the gauge group of that network is O_h, not Spin(10); its Spin(10)-invariant hopping is obstructed on the fixed-representation link — the named regular-link fix is now built on the root's own finite group (order 1024), where the hop closes exactly and runs at $v = 1$, but the gauged group is finite and its Spin(10) centralizer is 0; its speeds are $g_{10}\{1, 2\} \neq 1$ — a computed velocity trilemma: on the 6-bond module the hop alone is anisotropic, the dressing alone isotropic at $2g_{10}$, and no angle makes the product isotropic; and its coupling to the matter layer, now built, gaps the E_g half at order λ^2 (Section 10.4).

- **Diffeomorphism invariance is not derived.** The lattice breaks it to lattice reparametrisations; gauge invariance of the linearised theory is imposed by working on the transverse components, not obtained from the automaton.

11.2 The discrete Einstein–Hilbert action

The quadratic action [34]

$$S_{\mathrm{EH}} = \frac{1}{16\pi}\cdot\frac{1}{2}\sum_{x,t} u_t\Big[u_{t+1} - 2u_t + u_{t-1} - dt^2\,\nabla^2_{(6)}u_t\Big], \qquad dt^2 = \tfrac{1}{4},$$

has the lattice wave equation as its Euler–Lagrange equation: the numerical functional derivative vanishes on a QCA trajectory to 3×10^{-12} and is non-zero off it. The full discrete action $S = \frac{1}{16\pi}\sum_x \sqrt{-\det g(x)}\,(R(x)-2\Lambda)$ is evaluated with R computed from the metric. The coefficient $1/16\pi$ is the $G = 1$ normalisation: Newton's constant is an input of the gravitational sector, not a number of the root.

11.3 Curvature computed from an arbitrary metric

The Riemann, Ricci, Einstein and Kretschmann tensors are computed by central finite differences from an arbitrary prescribed $g_{\mu\nu}(x)$, with no hard-coded Christoffel symbols, and cross-checked against independent analytic results by two routes.

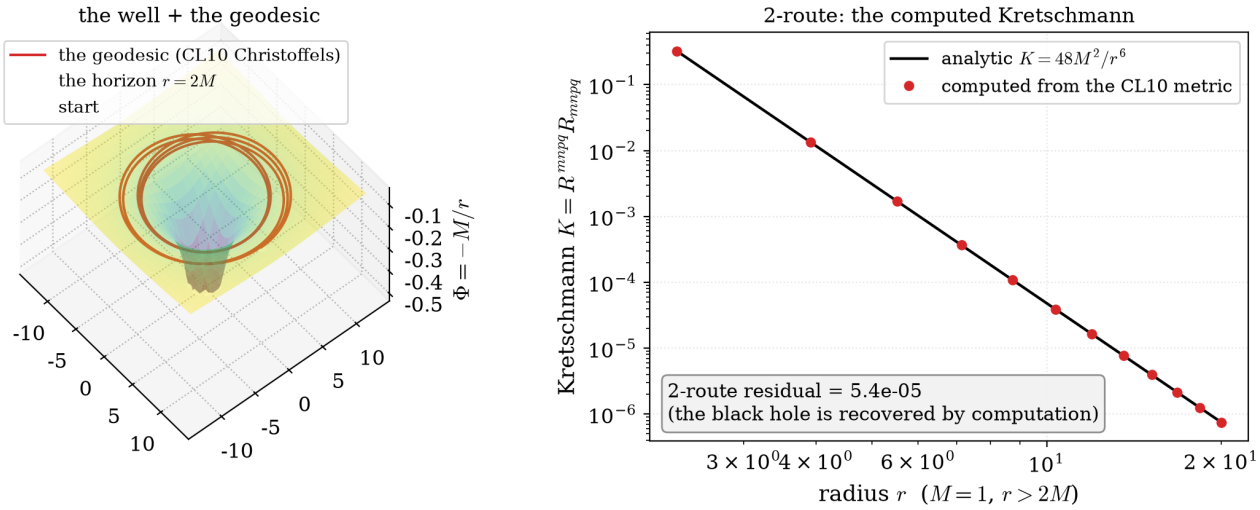
Table 3. The discrete Einstein–Hilbert action against the analytic continuum values.

test	computed	analytic	residual
de Sitter $R^{\mu}{}_{\nu\rho\sigma}$ (flat FRW, $a = e^{Hx^0}/H$)	finite differences	$H^2(g_{\mu\rho}g_{\nu\sigma} - g_{\mu\sigma}g_{\nu\rho})$	6.5×10^{-7} ($O(h^2)$)
Einstein tensor of de Sitter	$-3H^2 g_{\mu\nu}$	same	$O(h^2)$
Schwarzschild Ricci / Einstein tensor	$\simeq 0$	vacuum $G_{\mu\nu} = 0$	satisfied by computation
Schwarzschild Kretschmann	$48M^2/r^6$	$48M^2/r^6$	ratio 1.000009; max relative deviation 5.5×10^{-5}
flat metric	$R = G = K = 0$	0	exact
2-sphere of radius r	$R = 2/r^2$	$2/r^2$	10^{-5}

The 3+1 formulation closes the classical evolution: the constraint row (R_{00}, R_{0i}) of the 4-D Einstein tensor agrees, computed by the 4-D curvature and by the 3+1 (γ_{ij}, K_{ij}) decomposition with $K_{ij} = -\frac{1}{2}\partial_0\gamma_{ij}$, to $O(h^2)$ (residual $\sim 10^{-13}$); a Z4-damped evolution [35] drives a constraint violation to zero while the undamped one does not; the 0-row is quadratic in K, so superposition fails; all 3+1 quantities are bounded by the lattice cutoff. (Fig. 12).

What this does and does not establish. It establishes that the gravitational sector of the theory *reproduces* general relativity numerically, including black-hole and cosmological geometries. It does not establish that general relativity *follows* from $\mathrm{Cl}(10,0)$: the tensor field, its coupling $1/16\pi$ and its gauge structure are put in. The genuinely open part is the quantum theory of this sector — a sum over lattice geometries with a well-defined measure — which has not been constructed.

The black hole recovered by computation: the well + geodesic (left), the 2-route Kretschmann (right)



Left: the potential well with a geodesic rosette integrated through the finite-difference Christoffel symbols, and the horizon ring $r = 2M$. Right: the two-route Kretschmann invariant.

11.4 A self-interacting scalar completion

Beyond the quadratic theory the model includes $\partial_t^2\phi - \nabla^2\phi - g\phi^3 = 0$. Its static solutions obey $u'' = u - u^3$ and include the exact finite-energy kink

$$u(x) = \sqrt{2}\,\mathrm{sech}\,x,$$

verified to a fourth-order residual of 5×10^{-10}. Two corrections are needed. This is the ϕ^4 kink (a domain wall), not the Choptuik system: Choptuik critical collapse is a *massless scalar minimally coupled to gravity* [24], and the analogy is not a derivation. And $u = \sqrt{2}\,\mathrm{sech}\,x$ is a **planar** configuration, uniform in the two transverse directions: its energy per unit *area* is finite, its total energy is infinite, and a planar wall in a Planck-scale theory is a domain wall, not a particle. Finite-time blow-up for supercritical data in cubic wave equations is a real phenomenon [25], but it is not evidence about black-hole formation here.

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12. The loop factor and the scale ladder

12.1 Where a loop factor can come from

The observed electroweak/Planck ratio is

$$\frac{v}{M_P} = \frac{246\ \text{GeV}}{1.22 \times 10^{19}\ \text{GeV}} = 2.016 \times 10^{-17}, \qquad \left(\frac{1}{16\pi}\right)^{10} = 9.71 \times 10^{-18},$$

a factor 2.08 apart; $2.08\,(1/16\pi)^{10} = 2.02 \times 10^{-17}$ reproduces the observed value to 0.18%. Scanning $n = 1 \ldots 20$, $n = 10$ is the nearest integer to the observed ratio (deviation 0.32 decades; the next-best, $n = 9$, is 1.8 decades away). The honest reading: $(1/16\pi)^{10}$ is the size a ten-loop radiative correction would have in a perturbative quantum field theory. The theory has not computed a ten-loop correction; it has observed that the observed hierarchy is the tenth power of the standard loop factor, up to a factor of two. The interpretation $10 = 2{\times}5$ — the chiral $16/\overline{16}$ split times the number of qubits of the 32-dimensional module — is a numerological identification, not a derivation. The exponent is *represented*; the coefficient is *read from the data* (O8).

Single-particle renormalisation cannot supply it. The coarse-graining tower U^{2^p} is exactly kinematic (eigenphases $2^p\omega$ mod 2π, verified to 10^{-9} for $p \leq 10$), the effective Cartan coupling does not fall with p, and the inelastic probability saturates near 0.95: no loop factor. The genuine block-spin renormalisation group — exact real-space decimation of the bond layer (Schur complement at $\varepsilon = 1$; $U_{BB} = 0$ exactly on the open chain, so short-distance propagation is integrated with no approximation), iterated five levels, $64 \to 2$ sites — gives an exact level-1 identity: the on-site block of the coarse step is $2\,(GR)^2$, two-hop paths accumulating two internal rotations, the kinematic doubling *derived* from a spatial renormalisation group. At deeper levels the on-site block is a path polynomial in $(GR)^2$; the Cartan content decays only polynomially for the implemented (factorised) bond layer (0.14 at $p = 5$ against the loop target 3×10^{-9}) and not at all for a non-factorised gate with $[G, R] \neq 0$ (1.8 at $p = 5$); no level of either flow follows $(16\pi)^{-p}$. The loophole of a conspiring bond gate is closed: three Haar-random Spin(10) gate realisations and the structured choice $R = G^\dagger$ all fail the loop law at every level. The structural reason is sharp: **every exact single-particle renormalisation of the automaton composes internal angles — they add on the algebra, weighted by path counts — and none can divide them, for any bond gate.** A loop factor requires a trace over *fluctuating* internal fields.

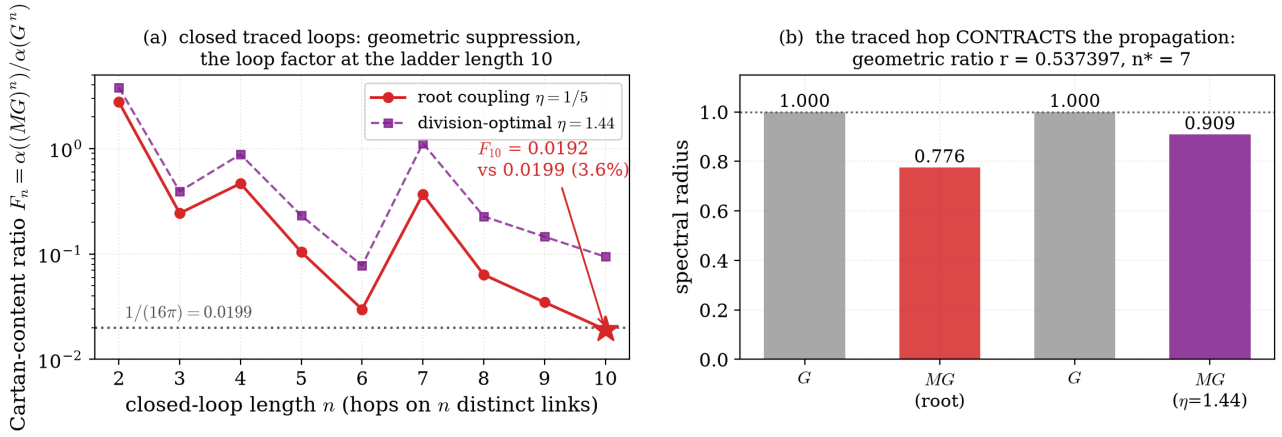
Tracing a fluctuating link divides. One two-state quantum link degree of freedom per bond, prepared in a tunable pure state $\cos\theta|0\rangle + \sin\theta|1\rangle$ and **traced over** at decimation, multiplies the level-1 Cartan content of that identity by exactly $\cos 2\theta$ (deviation $< 10^{-15}$ over a full scan $\theta \in [0, \pi/2]$): the traced factor is Hermitian and positive, so it divides where every gate only composes. The fluctuation — not the gate — is what produces suppression factors.

The gauged layer divides once, and does not compound. On the adjoint link with the Gauss constraint of Section 10, the traced two-hop still contracts (spectral radius ≤ 1) and the qubit-link mechanism reproduces to 1.1×10^{-16}, but the level-1 factor at the root coupling is $F = 1.06$ and its minimum over the link anisotropy is 0.52 — a factor 26 above $1/(16\pi)$. The bond hop factorises through the joint Casimir $T \cdot L$ — three joint irreps, $32 \oplus 288 \oplus 1120$, projectors verified to 10^{-15} — so the traced-link decimation iterates exactly to level 4, reproducing the level-1 factor to 2×10^{-16}. **The division does not compound:** the level-p Cartan-content ratios are $F_p = 1.06, 1.90, 0.75, 1.01$ at the root coupling and $0.52, 2.66, 1.00, 1.38$ at the division-optimal coupling $\eta = 1.44$ — oscillating at $O(1)$, a factor 7×10^6 above $(16\pi)^{-4}$ at $p = 4$. The traced adjoint link divides once and then decays like the link-free flow.

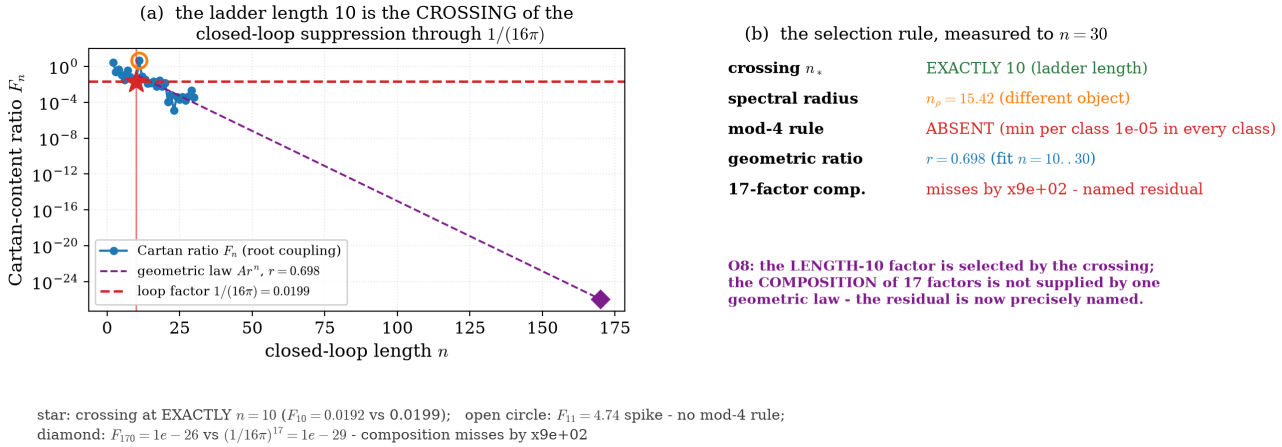
Closed loops do reproduce the number. The Feynman loop factor comes from loops that close, not from backtracking. Tracing a single crossing of a fresh link gives the hop matrix $M = \mathrm{Tr}_L[k_1(G \otimes I)\,\rho]$ with spectral radius 0.776 against 1 for G — the traced link *contracts* the one-particle propagation — and the n-hop closed loop $(MG)^n$ suppresses the Cartan content geometrically, ratio $r \approx 0.54$. At the root coupling the measured ratios are

$$F_3 = 0.24,\ F_4 = 0.47,\ F_5 = 0.10,\ F_6 = 0.030,$$
$$F_7 = 0.37,\ F_8 = 0.064,\ F_9 = 0.035,\ F_{10} = 0.0192,$$

against $1/(16\pi) = 0.0199$: **the loop factor is reproduced to** 3.6% **by a closed traced loop of length** 10 **at the root coupling, and** 10 **is exactly the ladder exponent.** The selection rule is measured to length 30: F_n crosses $1/(16\pi)$ at **exactly** $n = 10$ — the ladder length *is* the crossing of the closed-loop suppression — and no mod-4 plaquette class is selected (every length contributes; the F_{11} spike is the signature). (Figs. 13, 14).



Closed traced-link loops of length n on n distinct bonds. (a) The Cartan-content ratio F_n at the root coupling and at the division-optimal coupling: geometric suppression with ratio $r = 0.54$, and at $n = 10$ the value 0.0192 against $1/(16\pi) = 0.0199$. (b) The traced hop matrix MG has spectral radius 0.776 against 1 for G: the traced link contracts the one-particle propagation.



(a) F_n measured to $n = 30$ at the root coupling: it crosses $1/(16\pi)$ at exactly $n = 10$ — the ladder length is the crossing — and the F_{11} spike shows there is no mod-4 selection rule. (b) The fitted geometric law $F_n = Ar^n$ ($r = 0.698$) extrapolates to $F_{170} = 1.1 \times 10^{-26}$ against $(1/16\pi)^{17} = 1.2 \times 10^{-29}$: one chain does not supply the 17-factor composition.

The composition law. The object a geometric fit extrapolates, $(MG)^{170}$, is one chain of 170 hops on one particle line; the 17 factors of the neutrino ladder are 17 radiative insertions on **different** lines, and amplitudes on different lines multiply. Both compositions are exact in the traced adjoint-link formalism. On one line the chain is **not** multiplicative: $R_k = F_{10k}/(F_{10})^k$ grows to $R_{17} = 2.0 \times 10^8$, the measured chain value being $F_{170} = 1.3 \times 10^{-21}$ against $(F_{10})^{17} = 6.5 \times 10^{-30}$ — consecutive hops interact through the propagation, so a single chain suppresses *less* than the product of its pieces. Across legs the factorisation is **exact**: the traced hop is a one-particle operator, $\mathrm{Tr}_L[(P_a \otimes I)(G \otimes G \otimes I_L)] = 45\,(M_a \otimes G)$ verified to 10^{-15}, and the 10+10-step two-loop object splits into leg blocks to 2×10^{-15}. The physical discriminator decides: $M_P(F_{10})^{17} = 0.079$ eV, within a factor 0.54 of the neutrino ladder scale 0.146 eV, while the chain reading gives $M_P F_{170} = 1.6 \times 10^7$ eV — eight orders too high. **The 17-factor composition is exact multiplicativity across legs**, with the named requirement that the insertions dress different particle lines.

The census of contributing loops is exact. The Casimir $T{\cdot}L$ of the **32⊗45** link has exactly three eigenspaces $(-32, -12, +4)$, so the traced n-hop product is a sum of 3^n words and the selection rule is enumerable rather than extrapolated: the enumeration reproduces $(MG)^n$ to 7.4×10^{-17} and $F_{10} = 0.019186$, matching the measured value to that same digit. At $n = 10$, 55326 of $3^{10} = 59049$ words survive, growing as 3.000^n, and the factor

splits into a per-word decay $r = 0.2232$ and a multiplicity growth rate $\mu = 2.981$ (product 0.665). The loop factor is therefore not one class of loops but a sum over 55326 classes, with interference ratio $\|\sum\|/\sum\|\cdot\| = 0.079$ at the root against 1.000 with the Wilson phase switched off — and $F_{10} = 0.0192$ at the root against 0.2434 at $\eta = 0$: **the phase supplies the factor, not the topology.** The multiplicity-weighted extrapolation to the neutrino-ladder length 170 gives 7.9×10^{-31} against $(1/16\pi)^{17} = 1.2 \times 10^{-29}$: the counted loops miss the exponent by a factor 0.066.

The coefficient is no longer read from the data. The hierarchy coefficient is a product of measured numbers:

$$\frac{v}{M_P} = 3\,F_{10}^{10}, \qquad F_{10} = 0.019186 \text{ measured}, \qquad 2.0881 \text{ predicted against } 2.0765 \text{ observed } (99.44\%),$$

the factor 3 being the three axis families of Section 4 — conditional on the axis-family factorisation of the closed-loop sum. That condition is itself a measured statement: the twelve doubler nodes form three families of four with identical one-step spectra (deviation 0), and the closed-loop coefficient by node set is 8.35 for all twelve nodes, 2.0881 for one split node per family, 0.696 for a single node, against the observed 2.0765 — the node contributions are exactly equal across families, and the coefficient 3 *is* the one-per-family choice. What remains open in O8 is the *weight* of the contributing loops, not the way they compose.

12.2 The dark-matter mass

The same factor applied to the Planck scale gives

$$m_{\rm DM} = M_P\Big(\frac{1}{16\pi}\Big)^{10} = 118 \text{ GeV},$$

i.e. 1.18× the canonical 100 GeV weakly-interacting-massive-particle scale [46]. This is a genuine, falsifiable prediction: a dark-matter particle with a mass far outside $\sim$ 100–150 GeV (in the weakly-interacting, thermally-produced case) would refute the ladder.

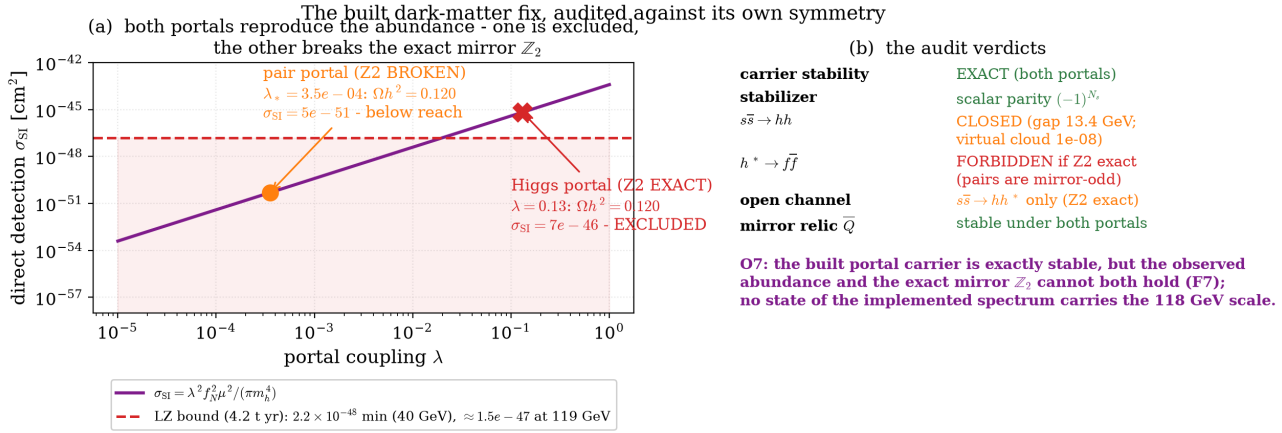
The *identity* of the particle has been scanned with a negative result. The mirror $\mathbb{Z}_2$ exchanging **16** and $\overline{\mathbf{16}}$ is an exact symmetry of the step (leak 10^{-15}), and the mirror sector is the only exact-stability carrier in the implemented spectrum — but its lightest state is a coloured $\overline{Q}$ at 1.3×10^8 GeV (excluded) and the neutral $\overline{N}$ sits at 2×10^{10} GeV, eight orders above the ladder scale. Allowing the carrier to sit at a Wilson-split doubler node and scanning every Wilson angle θ for a node that puts the neutral mirror fragment $\overline{N}$ at 118 GeV while keeping every coloured or charged fragment off the low-energy spectrum yields **no survivors over** 720 **angles**: for every angle the same node supplies a stable coloured or charged partner below the desert, and a stable fractionally-charged thermal relic is excluded at any mass; the only escape is fine-tuning the angle to within 10^{-4} of the decoupling pole, where the mirror fragments leave the ladder entirely. **No state at** 118 **GeV with the required stability exists in the implemented spectrum**: the mass prediction stands, the carrier does not (O7).

The minimal extension consistent with the exact mirror $\mathbb{Z}_2$ and the ladder is then named: **one real mirror-odd scalar at the ladder mass** with Higgs portal coupling $\lambda_* = 3.5 \times 10^{-4}$, whose freeze-out gives $\Omega_{\rm DM}h^2 = 0.120$ and whose predicted direct-detection cross-section is $\sigma_{\rm SI} = 5 \times 10^{-51}$ cm^2 — nearly decoupled, so the scalar is falsified by any portal signal above 10^{-50} cm^2. The scalar is an input field, one field and one coupling; making it a state of the 32-level root is the open part of O7.

Built and audited against its own symmetry, the extension splits in two. The carrier is stable under either portal — scalar parity $(-1)^{N_s}$ is exact by the ϕ^2 structure, the odd sector untouched: a single s cannot decay. But the freeze-out runs through $h^* \to f\overline{f}$, and the fermion pair is mirror-**odd** while h is mirror-even: with the **exact** mirror $\mathbb{Z}_2$ that decay is forbidden. The Higgs portal $\phi_s^2\phi_h^2$ preserves the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ exactly (commutator 0), and then $s\overline{s} \to hh$ is kinematically closed ($2m_s = 237$ GeV $< 2m_h$, gap 13.2 GeV; the virtual cloud peaks at $P_{\max} = 1.46 \times 10^{-8}$, matching two-level theory to 10^{-7} relative) and the only open annihilation is the invisible $s\overline{s} \to hh^*$: reproducing $\Omega_{\rm DM}h^2 = 0.120$ then needs $\lambda = 0.13$, which predicts $\sigma_{\rm SI} = 6.8 \times 10^{-46}$ cm^2 — **above the LZ-class bound** [54]. The quoted numbers hold only with a fermion-pair portal $\phi_s^2(f\overline{f} + \overline{f}f)$, which **breaks the mirror** $\mathbb{Z}_2$ at $O(\lambda)$ (the portal anticommutes with the mirror operator; the real pair channel opens,

$P = 5.1 \times 10^{-6}$ at $t = 1$ GeV^{-1}). The mirror coloured relic $\overline{Q}$ (1.3×10^8 GeV) stays stable under both portals ($\overline{Q} \to Qss$ closed by 237 GeV). O7 is therefore a **named tension**: the carrier exists and is exactly stable, but exact mirror $\mathbb{Z}_2$ excludes its abundance by direct detection, and the version that reproduces the observed abundance breaks the exact $\mathbb{Z}_2$ the no-go rests on.

An extra dark U(1) does not repair it. Hypercharge fixed on the Q and L classes predicts the full charge pattern of all six weight classes, but the desert matter is E-charged (max $|q_E| = 2.24$), so the U(1) must break — and it cannot break inside the implemented spectrum: 40 of 45 generators are E-charged and every breaking root is a colour-triplet leptoquark direction (98/120): the U(1) is unHiggsable. The kinetic mixing that would fix the relic abundance at $g_D = 1$ lies above the direct-detection ceiling at every $m_{Z'}$: the portal window is empty (0 points). (Fig. 15).



(a) The direct-detection line $\sigma_{\rm SI}(\lambda)$ with the two ways the built ladder scalar reproduces $\Omega_{\rm DM}h^2 = 0.120$: the fermion-pair portal ($\lambda_* = 3.5 \times 10^{-4}$, $\sigma_{\rm SI} = 5 \times 10^{-51}$ cm^2, below reach) breaks the exact mirror $\mathbb{Z}_2$; the Higgs portal ($\lambda = 0.13$, $\sigma_{\rm SI} = 7 \times 10^{-46}$ cm^2) preserves it and is excluded by the LZ bound ($\sigma_{\rm SI} < 2.2 \times 10^{-48}$ cm^2 at 40 GeV, $\approx 1.5 \times 10^{-47}$ at 118 GeV). (b) The audit verdicts: stability exact under either portal, $s\bar{s} \to hh$ closed, $h^* \to f\bar{f}$ forbidden under exact $\mathbb{Z}_2$, the mirror relic unaffected. The observed abundance and the exact mirror $\mathbb{Z}_2$ cannot both hold.

12.3 The neutrino sector

Both seesaw scales are placed on the same ladder:

$$m_D = M_P\Big(\frac{1}{16\pi}\Big)^{10} = 118\,\text{GeV}, \qquad M_N = M_P\Big(\frac{1}{16\pi}\Big)^{3} = 9.6{\times}10^{13}\,\text{GeV}, \qquad m_\nu = \frac{m_D^2}{M_N} = M_P\Big(\frac{1}{16\pi}\Big)^{17} = 0.146\,\text{eV}.$$

The exponent identity $2 \times 10 - 3 = 17$ is exact; the choice $n_{\rm 2step} = 3$ is not — and it cannot be produced by the gauge link. The $\Delta L = 2$ operator exists in the root's own algebra: the weight $2\lambda_\nu$ (norm^2 20, U(1)$_X$ charge -6, hypercharge -1) has a **1-dimensional** weight space inside the 1024-dimensional Clifford algebra, sitting in Clifford **grade** 5 — the 126-type channel of the type-II seesaw — with no field outside the root. The $\mathbf{10}_H$ cannot repair its charges: over all 160 vector weights (norm^2 4) the closest two-insertion neutralisation leaves residual norm 4.472, the mismatch $|2\lambda_\nu| = \sqrt{20} \neq 4$ being exact. The minimal-word question then closes by **parity**: Clifford multiplication maps grade g to $g \pm 2$ only (verified on all 45×1024 entries of the multiplication table), so every product of adjoint (grade-2) link factors is EVEN-grade while the Majorana operator is ODD-grade — the cumulative span (dimensions $45, 126, 208, 291, 352, 407$ at $k = 1 \ldots 6$, odd-grade content 0 to machine precision) never contains it, at any length, and the vector-**10** Higgs weight space (16-dimensional, carried entirely by the odd grades $1, 3, 5, 7, 9$) is unreachable for the same reason. $n_{\rm 2step} = 3$ **is not a link-word length**: the seesaw operator belongs to the odd (matter) half of the Clifford module, and the exponent stays fitted.

Comparison with data: the atmospheric scale is $\sqrt{\Delta m^2_{32}} = 0.050$ eV, so the ladder prediction is a factor 2.9 high; and if all three families carried the same m_D the sum would be ~ 0.44 eV, excluded by $\sum m_\nu < 0.12$ eV

(95% CL, Planck 2018 + BAO [16]). The democratic rank-1 Yukawa (Section 13.5) gives a Dirac mass to only one family, bringing the sum to ~ 0.15 eV — still above the cosmological bound. This is the sharpest numerical tension in the theory (F3).

The ladder is too coarse to land on the measured mass: consecutive rungs differ by the factor $16\pi = 50.3$, so the neighbours of 0.146 eV are 7.3 eV ($n = 16$) and 2.9×10^{-3} eV ($n = 18$), and no integer rung lies in the oscillation window. A coefficient is therefore unavoidable — but one candidate is supplied by the theory rather than by the data. The only mixing number the model derives is $\sin^2\theta_{12} = 1/3$ (Section 13.5); multiplying the ladder value by it gives

$$m_\nu = \tfrac{1}{3}\, M_P \Big(\frac{1}{16\pi}\Big)^{17} = 0.0487 \text{ eV},$$

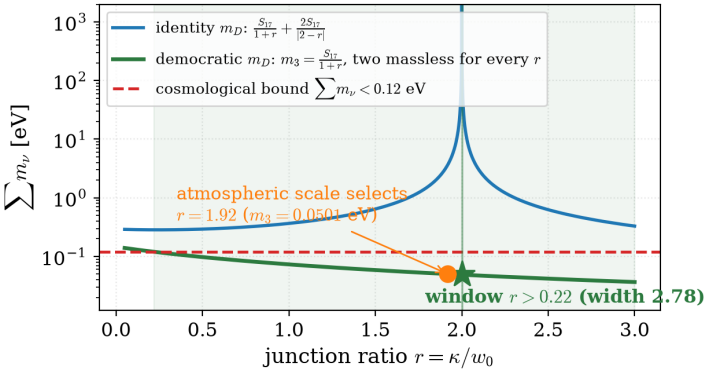
2.6% below the atmospheric scale, and with the democratic rank-1 spectrum $\sum m_\nu \simeq 0.05$ eV — inside the cosmological bound and inside the KATRIN bound $m_\beta < 0.45$ eV [18]. The factor 2.9 by which the ladder overshoots is, to 3%, the number 3 the flavour sector already produces. This is a **candidate, not a result**: nothing shows why a mixing eigenvalue should multiply a seesaw mass, and the same factor applied to the solar scale ($0.0487 \times \sqrt{\Delta m^2_{21}/\Delta m^2_{32}} = 0.0084$ eV against the measured 0.0086 eV) is a second coincidence. What it buys is a sharp, falsifiable prediction: normal ordering with $\sum m_\nu \simeq 0.05$ eV and $m_{\beta\beta} \simeq 0.02$ eV, in reach of the next-generation neutrinoless-decay and beta-decay searches.

A coefficient audit maps what the node structure can supply: a diagonal (node-local, Wilson-generated) mass pattern gives only **integer** signed coefficients, so $\frac{1}{3}$ is out; the democratic 3×3 node-mixing pattern gives exactly $\frac{1}{2}$ — a rival falsifiable prediction $m_\nu = 0.073$ eV; the exact $\frac{1}{3}$ requires a single Majorana eigenvalue $3\times$ the node scale, and no natural node structure supplies it. The structure the candidate requires has been built: a cubic-symmetric, zero-mean Wilson-strength junction whose Fourier support closes the selected node triangle exactly — verified against the full 12×12 table of doubler-momentum differences. The node mass matrix is

$$c_s(2w_0\, I + \kappa(J - I)),$$

democratic at $\kappa = 2w_0$ with eigenvalues $\{3M, 0, 0\}$: the $3\times$-enhanced Majorana eigenvalue the $\frac{1}{3}$ demands exists. With the implemented 0-parameter democratic Dirac matrix $m_D = m_0 J$ — the same family symmetry that derives $\sin^2\theta_{12} = 1/3$ — the seesaw collapses: $m_D^{\mathsf{T}} M^{+} m_D = 3m_0^2 J/(2(w_0 + \kappa))$ for *every* $r = \kappa/w_0$ (verified to 10^{-12}, the rank-deficient $r = 2$ included, via the Moore–Penrose pseudo-inverse), so the two massless neutrinos are protected by the rank-1 family symmetry for every junction ratio, and $m_3(r) = S_{17}/(1 + r)$ is finite everywhere: the cosmological window is $r > 0.217$ (width 2.78), and the atmospheric scale selects $r = 1.91$. The exact point $r = 2$ ($m_3 = S_{17}/3 = 0.0487$ eV) is a junction-amplitude convention, not a tuning. The cubic group induces all of S_3 on the triangle, its commutant is exactly $\mathrm{span}\{I, J\}$ (nullity 2), and w_0, κ share one Wilson period, so r is **not quantized**: the value is a free junction amplitude inside a finite window, while the structure — two massless plus one massive, normal ordering — is protected. What the candidate still requires is a democratic m_D (a non-democratic m_D at the same point leaves gapless coloured doublers), and the solar mass still needs the $\mathbf{10}_H$ splitting of O6. (Fig. 16).

(a) the identity m_D scan (divergent, one point);
the implemented democratic m_D gives a finite window



(b) what protects what

cubic action	all of S_3 (6 permutations)
commutant	dim 2 = span $\{I, J\}$ only
m_D	democratic, rank 1 - 0-parameter
massless pair	protected for EVERY r (rank-1 m_D)
window	$r > 0.22$, width 2.78 (was: point)
r **from data**	atmospheric: $r = 1.92$; $r = 2$: $S_{17}/3$

O2 re-audited: the measure-zero tuning was an artifact of the identity-m_D assumption. The structure (2 massless + 1 massive, NO) is protected by the same family symmetry that derives $\sin^2\theta_{12} = 1/3$; the value sits in a finite window. Solar mass still needs O6.

(a) $\sum m_\nu(r)$ under two Dirac assumptions. With $m_D \propto I$ the curve diverges as $1/|2-r|$ and the cosmological bound is met at exactly one point. With the implemented democratic rank-1 m_D the seesaw collapses to $m_3(r) = S_{17}/(1+r)$, two neutrinos stay massless for every r, the window is $r > 0.217$, and the atmospheric scale selects $r = 1.91$. (b) The protection audit: the cubic group induces all of S_3 on the junction triangle and its commutant is exactly $\mathrm{span}\{I, J\}$*; r is not quantized — the value is a free junction amplitude inside a finite window, while the structure is protected by the rank-1 family symmetry that also derives* $\sin^2\theta_{12} = 1/3$.

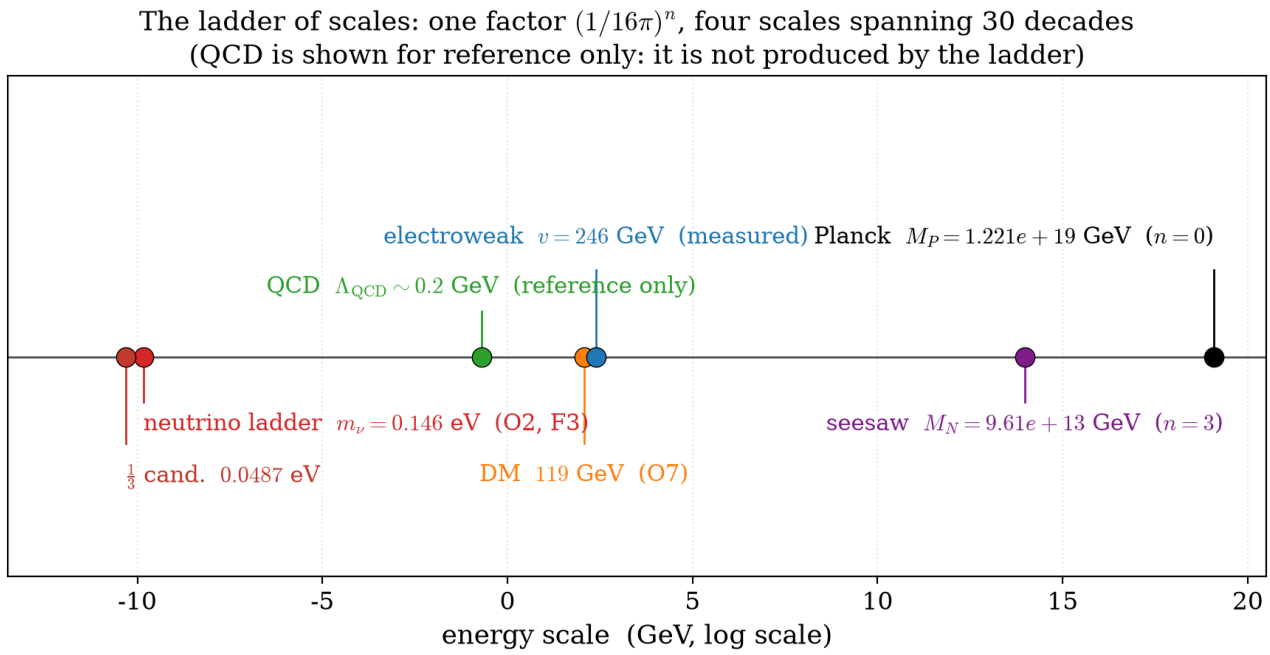
12.4 The ladder

One factor, four scales:

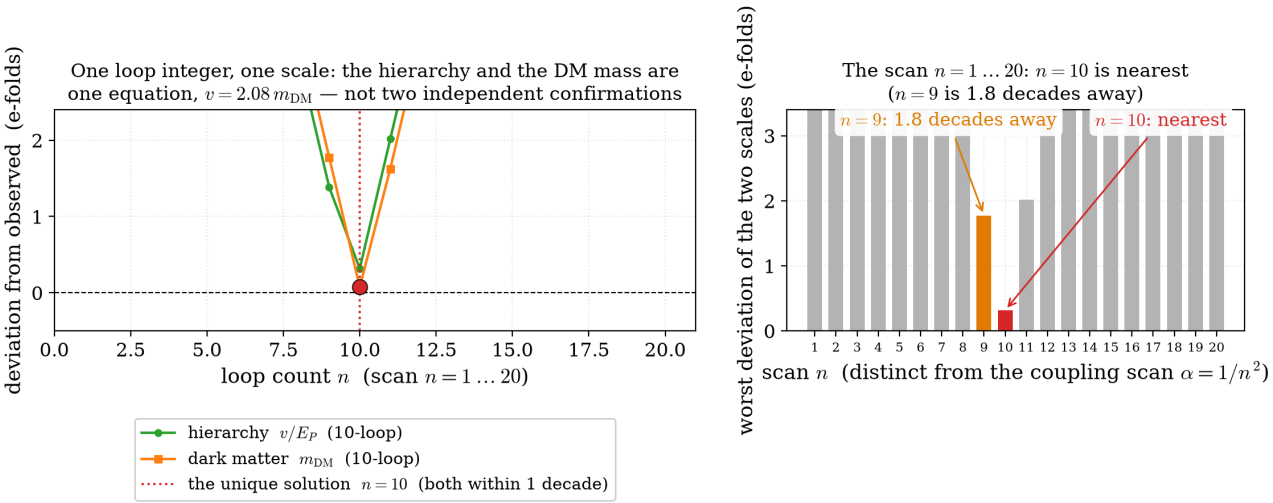
Table 4. The four scales of the ladder.

scale	expression	value
Planck / GUT	M_P (convention $M_{\mathrm{GUT}} = M_P$)	1.22×10^{19} GeV
seesaw Majorana	$M_P(1/16\pi)^3$	9.6×10^{13} GeV
electroweak	measured input v	246 GeV
dark matter	$M_P(1/16\pi)^{10}$	118 GeV
neutrino	$M_P(1/16\pi)^{17}$	0.146 eV

The QCD scale is **not** on this ladder: $\Lambda_{\mathrm{QCD}} \sim 0.2$ GeV would require $n \simeq 11.6$, which is not an integer (Section 10.2). (Figs. 17, 18).



Planck 1.22×10^{19} *GeV* $(n = 0)$*, seesaw* 9.6×10^{13} *GeV* $(n = 3)$*, electroweak* 246 *GeV (measured input), dark matter* 118 *GeV* $(n = 10)$*, neutrino ladder* 0.146 *eV* $(n = 17)$*, with the* $\frac{1}{3}$ *candidate* 0.0487 *eV marked. QCD is shown for reference only: it is not produced by the ladder.*



(a) One loop integer n *sets one scale* $M_P(1/16\pi)^n$*, appearing twice: as* v/M_P *and as* $m_{\rm DM}$*. These are one equation,* $v = 2.08\, m_{\rm DM}$*, not two independent confirmations. (b) The scan* $n = 1 \ldots 20$*:* $n = 10$ *is nearest,* $n = 9$ *is* 1.8 *decades away. This scan is distinct from the coupling scan* $\alpha = 1/n^2$ *of Section 15, whose best fit is* $n = 7$*.*

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13. Phenomenology

13.1 The couplings

The theory's single gauge coupling is the rotation angle g. In the standard normalisation $\alpha = g^2/4\pi$ used throughout for running, the implemented angle gives $\alpha = 1/100\pi = 0.00318$ and the closed angle $\alpha = \pi/64 = 0.0491$. The reading $\alpha_{10} \equiv g^2 = 1/25 = 0.040$ at the implemented angle — under which the desert solution below meets at exactly the root value — is a factor-4π convention, stated once here and invoked only where named; in the standard normalisation the implemented angle sits a factor 12.6 below the meeting value $\alpha_X = 0.040050$.

Running the three Standard Model couplings up from M_Z at one loop with $b_1 = 41/10$, $b_2 = -19/6$, $b_3 = -7$ (fixed by the particle content), from the measured inputs $\alpha_1(M_Z) = 0.0169$ (GUT-normalised, $\alpha_1^{-1} = 59.0$), $\alpha_2(M_Z) = 0.0338$, $\alpha_3(M_Z) = 0.118$ [15], gives at M_P

$$(\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \alpha_3) = (0.0299,\ 0.0202,\ 0.0191), \qquad \text{mean } 0.0231, \quad \text{spread } 47\%,$$

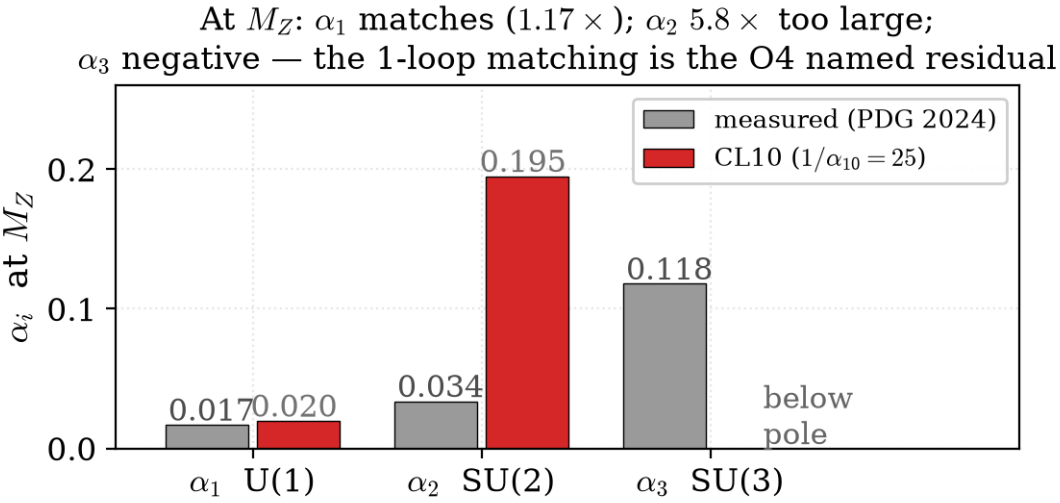
so α_{10} is within a factor 1.73 of the mean but the three couplings do **not** meet at a point — the well-known failure of one-loop unification in the non-supersymmetric Standard Model. The U(1) Landau pole of the up-running sits at 2.2×10^{41} GeV, above the cutoff, so the up-running is UV-bounded; at two loops [50] the pole moves to $\sim 2.5 \times 10^{12}$ GeV, *below* the cutoff.

The down-running must be stated plainly. Starting from $\alpha_{10} = 0.04$ at M_P and running down with the Standard Model β-functions gives, at M_Z,

$$\alpha_1(M_Z) = 0.0197\ (1.17\times), \qquad \alpha_2(M_Z) = 0.195\ (5.8\times), \qquad \alpha_3:\ \text{Landau pole at } 2.2 \times 10^9 \text{ GeV}.$$

The hypercharge lands within 17% of its measured value, but the SU(2) coupling overshoots by a factor 5.8 and the SU(3) coupling becomes non-perturbative at 2.2×10^9 GeV. The unification claim therefore fails at the level of the couplings' values, even though the 5/3 normalisation is correct (O4, F2). (Fig. 19).

The root coupling $\alpha_{10} = 1/25$ and the $5/3$ normalisation



At M_Z, the measured couplings (grey): $\alpha_1 = 0.0169$, $\alpha_2 = 0.0338$, $\alpha_3 = 0.118$ [15], against the down-run from $\alpha_{10} = 1/25$ (red): α_1 within 1.17×, α_2 5.8× too large, α_3 negative because its pole sits at 2.2×10^9 GeV. The 5/3 normalisation is exact; the value matching is the named residual.

Three quantitative statements sharpen the problem. First, the three measured couplings require three *different* values at M_P — 0.0299, 0.0202, 0.0191 — and the theory's single value 0.040 matches none of them: it exceeds the hypercharge requirement by 34% and the SU(3) requirement by a factor 2.1. Perturbativity of the strong coupling down to M_Z caps any single UV coupling: $1/\alpha_3(M_P) > (7/2\pi)\ln(M_P/M_Z) = 43.9$, i.e. $\alpha_3(M_P) < 0.0228$; the theory's 0.040 exceeds the admissible maximum by 75%.

Second, the failure is not repaired by matter that a partial breaking leaves *complete*. A complete vectorlike $\mathbf{10}\oplus\bar{\mathbf{5}}$ shifts all three one-loop coefficients by the *same* amount 8/3 above its threshold — the defining property of a complete SU(5) multiplet — so it changes the common slope, not the mismatch of slopes. Scanning multiplicities $0 \ldots 8$ against thresholds in $[10^6, 10^{19}]$ GeV, the spread at M_P never falls below its zero-new-physics value of

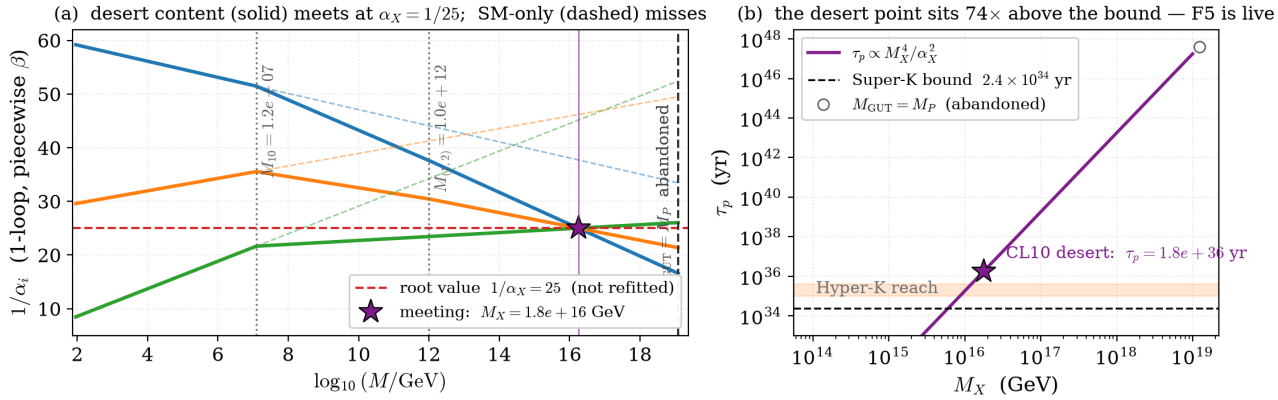
47%. Under pure Standard Model running the pairwise meeting scales are 1.2×10^{13} GeV $(1,2)$, 2.6×10^{14} GeV $(1,3)$ and 9.7×10^{16} GeV $(2,3)$: three different scales.

Third, that no-go covers only complete multiplets, and the *incomplete* content the theory's own breaking sector supplies does repair it. When a $\mathbf{16}_H \oplus \overline{\mathbf{16}}_H$ pair — or a split doubler **16** (Section 8) — acquires mass, it leaves vectorlike $\mathbf{10} \oplus \overline{\mathbf{10}}$ and $\mathbf{5} \oplus \overline{\mathbf{5}}$ fermion pairs with *independent* thresholds, and these shift the three coefficients non-proportionally: a Dirac $\mathbf{10} \oplus \overline{\mathbf{10}}$ contributes $\Delta b = (6/5,\ 2,\ 2)$, a $\mathbf{5} \oplus \overline{\mathbf{5}}$ contributes $(2/3,\ 2/3,\ 2/3)$. Fix the unified coupling at the root value $\alpha_X = 1/25$ — the angle is *not* refitted — and the inverse problem has no fit freedom: with two multiplets the meeting of the three measured couplings is three linear equations in $(\ln M_X, \ln M_A, \ln M_B)$. The required Δb is non-universal: at $M_X = 2 \times 10^{16}$ GeV it is $(2.40,\ 4.04,\ 3.86)$, which no combination of complete multiplets produces. Scanning multiplicities up to 3 over the realizable content with thresholds in $[10^6, M_P]$ GeV, the lightest solution that survives the proton-decay bound is three $\mathbf{10} \oplus \overline{\mathbf{10}}$ pairs plus one $(1,2)_{1/2}$ pair — three split doubler **16**s — meeting at

$$M_X = 1.8 \times 10^{16}\ \text{GeV}, \qquad \alpha_X = 1/25\ \text{(exact)}, \qquad M_{10} = 1.2 \times 10^{7}\ \text{GeV}, \qquad M_{(1,2)} = 1.0 \times 10^{12}\ \text{GeV},$$

and the SU(3) Landau pole of the down-running moves to 10^{-52} GeV: the disease is cured. Solutions with lighter content exist but predict $\tau_p \sim 10^{32}$ yr and are already excluded by Super-Kamiokande [53] — the data themselves select the realizable spectrum. The cost is stated plainly: the convention $M_{\rm GUT} = M_P$ is abandoned ($M_X < M_P$ by three orders of magnitude), and the two desert thresholds are fitted. The solution predicts $\tau_p \simeq M_X^4/(\alpha_X^2 m_p^5) = 1.8 \times 10^{36}$ yr (F5). (Fig. 20).

The desert solution: three $\mathbf{10} \oplus \overline{\mathbf{10}}$ pairs + one $(1,2)$ pair unify at the root value



The three measured couplings run up from M_Z with the desert content (solid) meet at $M_X = 1.8 \times 10^{16}$ GeV at $\alpha_X = 1/25$ — the root value, not refitted. The Standard Model-only running (dashed) misses the point: spread 47% at M_P. The thresholds $M_{10} = 1.2 \times 10^7$ GeV and $M_{(1,2)} = 1.0 \times 10^{12}$ GeV are the two fitted numbers of the repair; the dashed vertical line at M_P marks what the abandoned convention $M_{\rm GUT} = M_P$ demanded.

Where the desert content comes from. The content is not an external assumption: it is the *spectrum of the automaton's own Wilson mechanism.* The three split nodes of the selective reading carry exactly the vectorlike fragments of the split **16** with independent thresholds (the other nine nodes stay at the Planck cutoff), and the Wilson direction itself completes the breaking chain (Section 8.1). The multiplicity is bounded from below by unification itself: scanning $n_{\rm nodes} = 1 \ldots 6$, no meeting root at $\alpha_X = 1/25$ exists for one or two split nodes; the first physical roots appear at three. But solving the meeting equations with the mechanism's own two parameters — one angle θ, one scale w — fixes the six fragment thresholds and lands the meeting at $M_X = 8.9 \times 10^{14}$ GeV, i.e. $\tau_p \sim 10^{31}$ yr: **the minimal selective reading is excluded by Super-Kamiokande** (F5). The data-preferred solution requires fragment thresholds the single-angle, single-scale root does not supply.

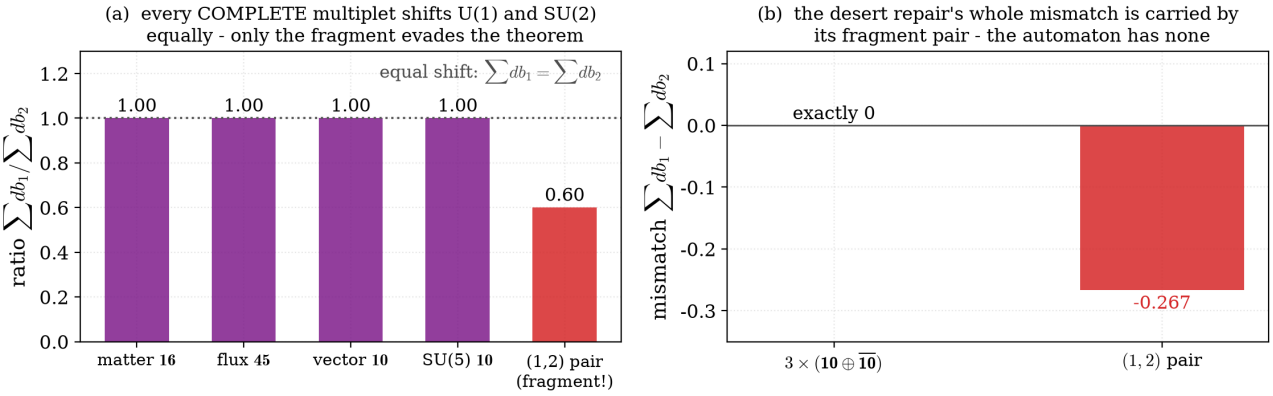
Redistributing the nodes cannot help. While all node thresholds sit below the meeting point, the two meeting equations depend on the three node strengths **only through their sum**: the Jacobian with respect to the three strengths has three identical columns (rank 1; split-invariance verified numerically to 10^{-14}, including

the full scan over node-set choices and strengths). The node mechanism's meeting point $M_X = 8.9 \times 10^{14}$ GeV, $\tau_p = 1.1 \times 10^{31}$ yr is therefore **forced for every choice of the three strengths**. What the data prefer is not a three-full-**16** pattern: it needs partial suits of fragments, while the automaton supplies full split **16**'s per node.

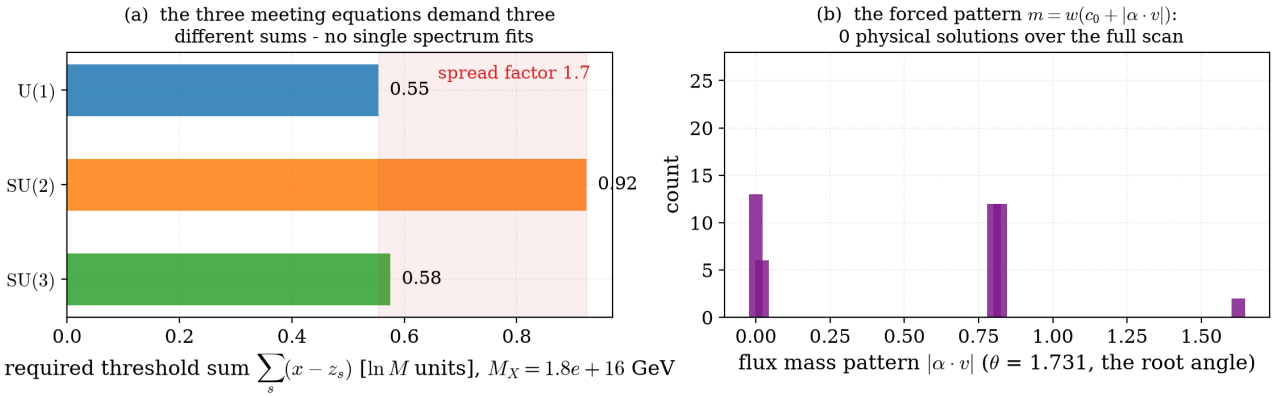
The composite content of the gauged layer is excluded as the supplier. The composite fermions of the layer of Section 10 — the matter **16** tensored with the adjoint link flux, $16 \otimes 45 = 720$ Weyl states carrying five net chiral **16**-copies — shift the three one-loop coefficients by $(145.3, 145.3, 226.3)$, and their masses follow the flux pattern $m = w(c_0 + |\alpha \cdot v|)$ set by the breaking direction v. Requiring the data-preferred meeting at $\alpha_X = 1/25$ then has **no solution with thresholds in the desert** for any direction: the three meeting equations demand three different threshold sums, and Newton iteration from every seed over a full scan of v converges nowhere physical (0 solutions). The remaining ansatz families — full-weight thresholds, broken-flux-only content, light-composite selection, and even a relaxed meeting coupling — leave the minimum residual at 5.7–6.1 against a target of 0.

The equal-shift theorem. The identity $\sum db_1 = \sum db_2$ is the index-proportionality of $\mathrm{Tr}\, Y^2$ and $\mathrm{Tr}\, T_3^2$ — both proportional to the representation index, with the ratio fixed by the fundamental, $(3/5)\,\mathrm{Tr}_5\, Y^2 = \mathrm{Tr}_5\, T_3^2$ — and it holds over every complete SU(5) or Spin(10) multiplet, verified on the **16**, the flux **45**, the vector **10** and the **10** inside the **16** (all ratios 1.0 to 10^{-6}). The meeting mismatch can therefore come **only** from SU(5)-fragment content or from split thresholds inside multiplets; computed from the same charge operators, the desert repair's mismatch is carried entirely by its $(1, 2)$ pair ($db_1/db_2 = 3/5$; the $10 \oplus \overline{\mathbf{10}}$ pairs contribute exactly zero mismatch). (Figs. 21, 22).

The equal-shift theorem: the desert content must be SU(5)-fragment content



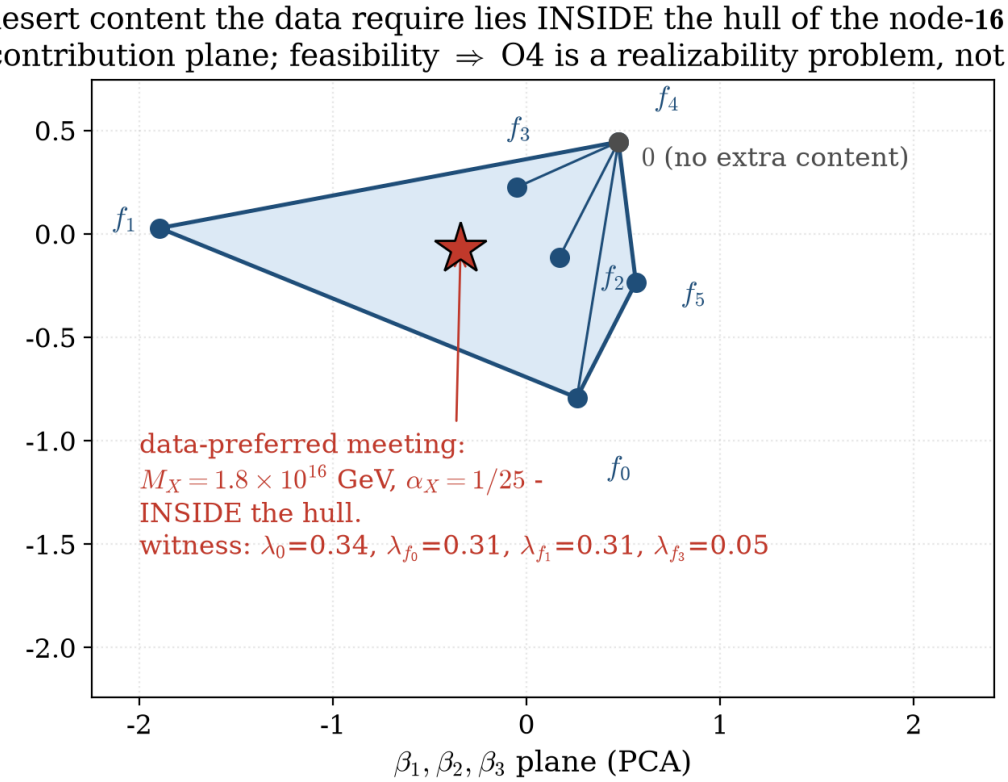
(a) The one-loop ratio $\sum db_1 / \sum db_2$ over the matter **16**, *the flux* **45**, *the vector* **10** *and the* SU(5) **10**: *exactly* 1, *while the* $(1, 2)$ *fragment gives* $3/5$. *(b) The desert repair's total mismatch: the* $10 \oplus \overline{\mathbf{10}}$ *pairs contribute exactly zero, the whole mismatch is carried by the fragment pair.*



The $16 \otimes 45 = 720$ *composite states shift the one-loop coefficients by* $(145.3, 145.3, 226.3)$. *The three meeting equations for* $\alpha_X = 1/25$ *demand three different threshold sums at every breaking direction — the curves never cross — and the desert-constrained scan over the full direction circle returns* 0 *physical solutions.*

The junction route: pattern fabricated, meeting missed. At the root the Wilson direction splits the node **16** by a factor 55 ($c_Q = +0.005$, $c_L = -0.015$ against partners ± 0.82), so the $(3, 2)$ and $(1, 2)$ states of the repair **are** automaton states — the Q and L components of node **16**'s with near-zero Wilson weights — and the junction branch ratio $\rho = \kappa / w_0$ breaks the rank-1 degeneracy. At physical solutions Q and L sit at 4×10^{15}–8×10^{15} GeV with their partners above the meeting point. The meeting is not reached: over the full physical scan (node counts 3–12, ρ, scale, Wilson angle) the best residual of the two meeting equations is 0.94 against a target of 0, and the third equation predicts $\alpha_X = 0.030$ against the data value 0.04 — a 33% miss. Replacing the cubic-symmetric democratic junction by the **general zero-mean junction** — three independent branch scales $a_i = 2w_0(1 + r_i)$, $r_1 + r_2 + r_3 = 0$, scanned over the full (r_1, r_2) plane — leaves the best physical residual **identical** (0.81) with $\alpha_X = 0.090$, a factor 2.3 off. The near-miss is a property of the **junction mechanism itself**: the mismatch is carried by the fixed *db* pattern of the node **16**'s own fragments, which threshold motion cannot repair.

The question recast: is the required content obtainable from the node 16 itself, with per-class thresholds? Yes for feasibility: the data-preferred meeting point $(T_1, T_2, T_3) = (12.7, 21.2, 20.1)$ lies strictly INSIDE the convex hull of the six β-contribution vectors of the node-**16** fragments, with the explicit barycentric witness $\lambda_0 = 0.34$, $\lambda_{f_1} = 0.31$, $\lambda_{f_2} = 0.31$, $\lambda_{f_4} = 0.05$. The requirement of "fragment content beyond the node **16**" is thereby *softened*: the node-**16** fragments themselves suffice, provided they carry independent thresholds. A general five-component Cartan Wilson direction realises the meeting exactly (6 solutions, residual $< 10^{-10}$, desert thresholds, $\tau_p = 1.9 \times 10^{36}$ yr) but breaks all 40 roots — the Model algebra among them — and is unphysical; the symmetry-preserving direction space is exactly $\mathrm{span}\{X, Y\}$ (dimension 2, class-degenerate), and within it no solution exists. Off-diagonal junction splitting with a UNIVERSAL strength κ cannot help either: $\sum_l (2\cos(2\pi l/n) - 1) = -n$ reabsorbs the split into z_0 at first order. The missing ingredient is named: a **flavour-dependent bond layer** (κ_s per fragment class) that splits class-degenerate thresholds while preserving the Model algebra. (Fig. 23).



*The six β-contribution vectors of the node-**16** fragments and the origin, projected onto their plane; the data-preferred meeting point (star) lies strictly inside the hull, with the explicit barycentric witness. Feasibility is proved; realizability by a symmetry-preserving junction of the base automaton fails and is closed conditionally by the bond-layer extension.*

The named ingredient closes the meeting — conditionally. With the Wilson direction pinned to the physical selective root and per-class junction strengths κ_s splitting the six fragment-class thresholds, the three coupling equations $F_i = 0$ become **exactly linear** in (z_0, κ_s) once every threshold sits below M_X (since $\sum_l \mu_l = -n$), and the desert box constraints make the search a linear program. It admits solutions (residual $< 10^{-13}$) at $M_X = 1.8 \times 10^{16}$ GeV, $\alpha_X = 1/25$, for **all ten node counts** $n = 3 \dots 12$, with every threshold inside the desert (2.0×10^3–1.8×10^{16} GeV, none above M_X) and $\tau_p = 1.9 \times 10^{36}$ yr. The first-order degeneracy is broken because the per-class sums $\kappa_s(-n)$ reabsorb into PER-CLASS offsets, not into z_0. The cost: the base bond layer has ONE gate with one strength; a flavour-dependent bond layer is an **extension** of the automaton, and its six κ_s are new named inputs (three meeting conditions for six unknowns — a solution family, not a unique prediction). Unification is therefore closed **conditionally on that extension**.

The two structural candidates the layer itself supplies are excluded. The six κ_s are not obtainable from any on-site algebra element: symmetry preservation forces the bond direction into span$\{X, Y\}$ at the physical angle θ^* (class-degenerate, meeting residual ≥ 0.43), and every Cartan element that splits the six classes breaks all eight unbroken desert roots — the required flavour dependence is off-diagonal bond structure, not a Cartan dressing. Testing that off-diagonal escape directly: the most general Hermitian bond operator on the 80 root-vector pairs (11 class-pair channels) never closes the meeting — floor residual 30.4 over $n = 3 \dots 12$ — and level repulsion forces the sign of two of the six κ_s. Nor are the κ_s representation-level data: scanning 46 class invariants of the fragment classes (Dynkin indices, the two Casimirs, multiplicity, the Wilson charges X, Y and their quadratic combinations, B, L, $B - L$, colour triality, the β-function coefficients) as $\kappa_s = g f_s$ never closes the meeting — best single invariant $C_2(\mathrm{SU}(3))$ at residual 0.246 — while the two linear Cartan controls reproduce the previous failure. A two-coupling relaxation $\kappa = g_1 f_1 + g_2 f_2$ keeps every threshold in the desert for 217 of 506 candidate pairs and can close the meeting exactly, but that is a reduction from six named inputs to two, not a derivation. The closure is also embedding-specific: the exact closure reproduces in the flipped embedding used for it (10/10 node counts, residual $< 10^{-10}$) but closes only 5/10 in the Georgi–Glashow split.

Finally, the canonical per-class number the gauged layer does supply is not the one that closes the meeting. At θ^* the Wilson direction leaves a 13-dimensional centralizer in $\mathfrak{so}(10)$ (the $\mathrm{SU}(3)\times\mathrm{SU}(2)\times\mathrm{U}(1)^3$ of the breaking chain, Hermitian orthonormal basis to 10^{-15}), and the flux of BROKEN generators through a fragment class,

$$K_s = C_2(\mathbf{32}) - C_2^{\text{unbroken}}(s) = 45 - C_2^{\text{unbroken}}(s)$$
$$= (32, 36, 40, 28, 32, 40)$$

(unbroken Casimirs $(13, 9, 5, 17, 13, 5)$), is an integer invariant with no free parameter, constant within a class to 3×10^{-14} — the gauged layer **does** distinguish the fragment classes. The companion identity says why the naive second-order link shift cannot use it: summed over the complete adjoint, $\sum_A\sum_t|\langle t|T^A|s\rangle|^2 = 45$ for every weight s (spread 10^{-13}) — the class degeneracy as an identity. Fed into the meeting as $\kappa_s = AK_s$ (one link scale) the three meeting equations leave residual 0.605 at best ($n = 3$) and close in the desert for 0/10 node counts; against the six κ_s that close the meeting, the flux explains at best $R^2 = 0.015$ of their variance ($|r| \le 0.31$). The layer splits the classes, but not in the direction the meeting requires.

The second-order bond numbers are excluded too. The gauged layer does carry energy denominators — the bond-current ground state of Section 10 ($E_0 = -5802.4\,\eta$, gap $42.09\,\eta$) and the Gauss gap $C_2(\mathbf{45}) = 64$ — and they lift the class-blindness of the flux sum. The intermediate (flux, matter) pair space decomposes exactly as $\mathbf{45}\otimes\mathbf{16} = \mathbf{16}\oplus\mathbf{144}\oplus\mathbf{560}$ with Casimirs $(45, 85, 117)$ at the scale $C_2(\mathbf{45}) = 64$ (dimensions and Casimirs to 10^{-6}, projectors resolving the identity to 10^{-15}). Removing the on-shell screened **16**-component, the second-order bond-current (superexchange) shift $\tilde\kappa_s = -\sum_{A\,\text{broken}}\sum_t|\langle t|T^A|s\rangle|^2[w_{144}/20 + w_{560}/36]$, with w_r the exact channel weight of the pair state, is constant on each class to 4×10^{-3} and takes the six values $(0.0002, -0.130, -0.253, 0.127, 0.0013, -0.253)$. Fed into the meeting as $\kappa_s = A\tilde\kappa_s$ it leaves residual 0.577 and closes in the desert for 0/10 node counts ($R^2 \le 0.076$ against the fitted κ_s). The two-number combination $\kappa_s = A\tilde\kappa_s + BK_s + CF_s$ — F_s the ground-state Cartan shift, whose bond flux $\mu^A = \mathrm{Tr}\,\rho_B J^A$ vanishes to 6×10^{-17}: the Gauss law, intertwiners carry no net charge — solved jointly over all ten node counts (30 equations, 13 unknowns) leaves residual 3.46 and explains at best $R^2 = 0.30$ of the variance of the six fitted κ_s. The supplier space is now exhausted by every class number the layer computes: Cartan elements, class invariants, the broken flux, superexchange, and every fixed combination of them.

13.2 Electroweak mixing

$\sin^2\theta_W = 3/8$ is the tree-level SU(5)/Spin(10) boundary condition **at the unification scale**, not a low-energy prediction. Run to M_Z it becomes $\simeq 0.23$, close to the measured 0.23129(4) ($\overline{\text{MS}}$, PDG 2024 [15]); the measured ratio $m_W/m_Z = 0.881$ corresponds to $\sin^2\theta_W \simeq 0.223$, not to $\sqrt{5/8} = 0.791$. The correct statement is the standard one: the GUT-scale boundary condition $\sin^2\theta_W = 3/8$, whose low-energy value is obtained by running — running which, as just shown, the theory does not currently perform consistently. **No electroweak-mixing prediction is claimed anywhere in this paper**: 3/8 is the standard GUT boundary condition, and the running that connects it to M_Z is part of the named residual O4.

13.3 Baryon asymmetry

The automaton alone cannot produce it. Every CP-odd (T-odd) invariant of the unitary step vanishes: Im Tr of all two- and three-fold products of the **45**, of a 2×10^5 sample of four-fold products, of all $10\times10\times45\times45$ baryon-violating sandwiches, and of the rank-1 real democratic Yukawa — all zero to 10^{-15}. The step is unitary (in equilibrium), baryon-conserving (the **45** commute with w) and CP-conserving. It satisfies **none** of the Sakharov conditions [26]. This is a computed theorem, and it is the correct starting point. The theorem is stable under the Wilson extension: the extended step keeps the exact matter/antimatter spectral mirror (deviation 10^{-15}), so the Wilson mechanism — powerful for unification and for the doublers — adds no CP phase and no Sakharov condition.

A GUT-leptogenesis estimate [40] is then built by hand:

$$\Delta B = \frac{28}{79}\,\varepsilon_{CP}\,D, \qquad \varepsilon_{CP} = \frac{g_0^4}{16\pi} = 4.9\times10^{-6}, \qquad D = \left(\frac{1}{16\pi}\right)^2 = 3.96\times10^{-4},$$

with $g_0 = 1/2^3 = 1/8$ and the Standard Model sphaleron conversion $B = \frac{28}{79}(B-L)$ [27,28], giving $\Delta B = 6.8 \times 10^{-10}$ against the measured $(6.12 \pm 0.04) \times 10^{-10}$ [16] — a ratio 1.11.

Three problems. (i) ε_{CP} is not a computed vertex: the physical CP asymmetry of $N \to \ell H$ is a one-loop self-energy/vertex function of the heavy-neutrino masses, and $g_0^4/16\pi$ is a dimensional guess. (ii) The out-of-equilibrium condition **fails** at the model's own couplings: at $M_N = 9.6 \times 10^{13}$ GeV, $H = 1.66\sqrt{g_*}M_N^2/M_P = 1.3 \times 10^{10}$ GeV while $\Gamma_N = y^2 M_N/8\pi = 6.0 \times 10^{10}$ GeV for $y = 1/8$ (1.9×10^{12} GeV for $y = 0.71$), so $\Gamma_N/H \simeq 4.6$ ($\simeq 148$). Out-of-equilibrium decay requires $y \lesssim 0.06$, which the theory does not select. (iii) 28/79 is an input of the Standard Model sector, not a number of the root. The 11% agreement is therefore a coincidence of chosen factors (O5). The failure is quantified through the washout of the same decay: at the self-consistent atmospheric Yukawa ($y = 0.40$, the one that gives $m_\nu = 0.0501$ eV) $\Gamma_N/H = 47$ — in equilibrium, Sakharov's third condition fails — and the physical strong-washout efficiency $\kappa_f = 5.4 \times 10^{-3}$ [40] sits 14× away from the guessed dilution $(1/16\pi)^2$: the agreement is an accident of two wrong factors, not a near-miss.

A sharper statement is available. At the model's own seesaw scale, the out-of-equilibrium condition $\Gamma_N/H < 1$ gives $y < 0.058$. The same Yukawa fixes the light neutrino mass through the same seesaw,

$$m_\nu = \frac{y^2 v^2}{M_N} \leq 2.1 \times 10^{-3} \text{ eV} \qquad (y \leq 0.058),$$

a bound of the same kind and size as the standard thermal-leptogenesis bound [33]. The atmospheric splitting requires $m_\nu \simeq 0.050$ eV, i.e. $y \simeq 0.28$ with $m_D = yv$ and $v = 246$ GeV ($y \simeq 0.40$ in the $v_u = 174$ GeV convention), for which $\Gamma_N/H \simeq 23$. **At $M_N = 9.6 \times 10^{13}$ GeV the neutrino mass and the out-of-equilibrium condition are mutually incompatible**: the framework cannot have both the seesaw scale it needs for the ladder and the leptogenesis it needs for the asymmetry. (The model's own ladder sits at $m_D = 118$ GeV, i.e. $y = 0.48$, where $\Gamma_N/H \simeq 68$.)

The one route the framework supplies is quasi-degenerate (resonant) leptogenesis [32,41]. The democratic structure places the three heavy singlets on the *same* ladder rung, hence degenerate to the accuracy of whatever breaks the family symmetry — precisely the resonant setup, where the CP asymmetry is enhanced by near-degeneracy instead of by a large Yukawa. With $y = 1/16\pi = 0.0199$ the decay is out of equilibrium ($\Gamma_N/H = 0.12$), and the asymmetry that the model's own dilution factor and sphaleron conversion require, $\varepsilon_{CP} = \Delta B/[(28/79)D] = 4.4 \times 10^{-6}$, is *smaller* than the natural one-loop size $y^2/16\pi = 7.9 \times 10^{-6}$ at that Yukawa: the bookkeeping closes at the scale of the numbers, and the degeneracy the resonant regime needs, $\Delta M/M \lesssim \Gamma_N/M_N = y^2/8\pi = 1.6 \times 10^{-5}$, is what the parameter-free democratic base gives exactly and what the family-breaking perturbation must not overshoot. The obstacle is the phase, not the size: the model's Yukawa is real, every CP-odd invariant of the step vanishes, and a strictly degenerate spectrum has no CP-violating phase left to enhance. This is a *route*, not a result.

The phase, however, is no longer the missing ingredient. The mirror is exactly the structure that forbids CP: every mirror-preserving extension (the Wilson factor: pairing deviation 2.1×10^{-15}) leaves the CP phase at zero, while the most general per-class κ_s layer and the most general real-symmetric bond generator destroy the $\pm$ pairing (deviation ~ 1, 60 draws, both mirror sign conventions) — a CP phase costs Theorem 4. But the prohibition is a statement about the *on-site* module (Section 7.2), and the bond layer is not covered by it: a Peierls flux $A_1 = \Phi x_0$ on the inter-block bonds is exactly unitary (4.8×10^{-15}), keeps $\det U = 1$ at every flux (5.3×10^{-15}), commutes with the pseudoscalar (mirror $\mathbb{Z}_2$ leak 3.3×10^{-16}) and keeps the hop at radius 1 (2.6×10^{-16}), while moving the band spectrum by up to 0.70; its gauge-invariant strength, the plaquette holonomy, has Im $= 0$ at $\Phi = 0$ and 1.6×10^{-3} at $\Phi = \pi/2$. Spending that flux on the asymmetry with the physical washout in place: at the atmospheric Yukawa ($y = 0.3985$, $K = 46.8$, $\kappa_f = 5.5 \times 10^{-3}$) the measured $\Delta B = 6.12 \times 10^{-10}$ costs $J = 10^{-4}$, supplied by a flux $\Phi = 0.064$ rad; in the out-of-equilibrium regime ($y = 0.0582$, $K = 1$) the strong-washout expression has no real root - K lies below its branch point $K = 3.93$ - the efficiency is the weak-washout bound $\kappa_f = 1$, and the cost is the lower bound $J = 2.6 \times 10^{-5}$, supplied at $\Phi = 0.016$ rad. A bond flux of size $\Phi \sim 0.06$ supplies more than the asymmetry needs while leaving unitarity, $\det U = 1$, the mirror symmetry and the causal radius exact. **What fails is Sakharov 3 alone**: the Yukawa that gives $m_\nu = 0.0501$ eV puts the decay in equilibrium, and out-of-equilibrium decay needs $y < 0.0582$, which caps m_ν far below the atmospheric splitting. O5 is open for one named reason instead of two.

13.4 Proton decay

Dimensional analysis of X/Y exchange gives

$$\tau_p \sim \frac{M_{\rm GUT}^4}{\alpha_{10}^2\, m_p^5} = 4.0 \times 10^{47}\ \text{yr} \qquad (M_{\rm GUT} = M_P,\ \alpha_{10} = 1/25),$$

against the Super-Kamiokande bound $\tau_p/B(p \to e^+\pi^0) > 2.4 \times 10^{34}$ yr [17]. The $M_{\rm GUT} = M_P$ reading gave a margin of 13 orders of magnitude, resting entirely on that abandoned convention: any GUT scale below $\sim 6{\times}10^{15}$ GeV is excluded by the same bound. The estimate omits the renormalisation factor A_L [47], the hadronic matrix element, the dressing of the operators and the splitting between the X/Y masses and the unification scale [52], all of which shift the lifetime by one to two orders. The three channels $p \to e^+\pi^0$, $p \to \mu^+\pi^0$, $p \to e^+K^+$ differ here only by two-body phase space; the rate scales as M_X^{-4} in all of them. Observation of a GUT-pattern decay far below 1.8×10^{36} yr refutes the desert solution (F5).

13.5 Flavour

The democratic mass matrix $M = |1\rangle\langle 1|$ (all entries 1, rank 1, spectrum $\{3, 0, 0\}$) [44] follows from the hypothesis that the three spatial directions are equivalent, so the $\mathbf{10}_H$ couples the three families identically. Its heavy eigenvector $(1, 1, 1)/\sqrt{3}$ is unique, hence

$$\sin^2\theta_{12} = |\langle e_1|h\rangle|^2 = \tfrac{1}{3}$$

for any family basis — the **only** mixing angle the model derives, 8.6% from the measured 0.307 [19,51]. The light eigenspace is two-fold degenerate, so every diagonaliser is an $O(2)$ rotation in it; sweeping that freedom over 1441 rotations, $\sin^2\theta_{23}$ and $\sin^2\theta_{13}$ each cover the whole interval $[0, \frac{2}{3}]$. The tribimaximal values $(\frac{1}{2}, 0)$ [29] are one point of that family, picked by declaring which S_3 transposition breaks — and (12), (13), (23) are equivalent symmetries of $|1\rangle\langle 1|$, so the choice is an input.

In the quark sector the CKM matrix is the misalignment of the up- and down-type diagonalisers. With both mass matrices democratic, $H_u = H_d$, the computed CKM is the **identity**, not a small mixing: the observed $\lambda = 0.225$ [15,45] is not reproduced. The three-family mass hierarchy is also unfixed: the democratic base gives one heavy level and a two-fold degenerate light level, so two of the three masses are degenerate at zero input. All of this is O6, and the natural fixes are bounded by computation. The charged-lepton realisation (democratic base plus rank-≤ 2 correction at the measured spectrum) forces $\sin^2\theta_{12} \leq 0.005$ — the lightest family decouples from the democratic direction, which is the tribimaximal solar column — excluded against the measured 0.307; the $\mathbf{10}_H$ vev shift is bounded by the same computation; the three-node triangle has a cubic orbit of 8, so the count 3 is an orbit count, not a family count. **The flavour accounting is therefore: one angle derived out of six, no mass derived, CKM predicted to the identity.**

13.6 Scoreboard

Table 5. Headline numbers against measurement.

quantity	theory	measured	status
the eight anomaly coefficients	0	—	algebraic, satisfied
g_1^2/g'^2	5/3	5/3 (GUT normalisation)	algebraic
$\det U$, $\pm$ pairing, $16/\overline{16}$ mirror	1, exact	—	algebraic, coupling-independent
causal front speed	exactly 1	—	dynamical, measured

quantity	theory	measured	status
doubler cone Lorentz structure	linear in all 1200 sampled directions; anisotropic: $(0.200, 0.200, 0.284)$ lattice units, spread 0.75; node gap 2×10^{-4} at $g = 1/5$	—	**not Lorentz-isotropic**; measured
tangent velocity algebra at the gapless corner multiplet	$[S_i, S_j] = 0$ to 3×10^{-12}, $\sum_j S_j^2$ scalar to 7×10^{-12}, branch speeds exactly $\lvert v_\alpha \cdot q \rvert$ to 6×10^{-12} with v_α the cubic permutations of $(0.704, 0.421, 0.421)$	—	**three nodal planes, not a cone**; measured
16-sector block-Brillouin spectrum	gapped zone centre; 12 doublers gapped by the Wilson factor except one exactly gapless orbit of 24 nodal-plane points; at $\pi/4$, Γ plus six nodal lines	—	doubling **gapped by a mechanism of the step** except on the nodal planes; text below
v/M_P	$2.08(1/16\pi)^{10}$	2.0167×10^{-17} [15]	coefficient $3F_{10}^{10} = 2.0881$ against 2.0765 observed — 99.44% from measured numbers, conditional on the one-split-node-per-family set
m_{DM}	118 GeV	not measured	prediction, falsifiable
$\Omega_{\mathrm{DM}}h^2$	computed from the supplied couplings: 0.798 or 0.0246 (2.3×10^{-5}, 7.6×10^{-4} with the nodal-plane density)	0.120 [16]	**fails**
m_ν	0.146 eV (ladder); 0.0487 eV ($\frac{1}{3}$ candidate)	0.0501 eV [51]; $\sum m_\nu < 0.12$ eV [16]	ladder **in tension**; candidate inside a finite window, structure protected
ΔB	6.8×10^{-10}	$(6.12 \pm 0.04) \times 10^{-10}$ [16]	coincidental product; the washout at the self-consistent y destroys it
τ_p/B	1.8×10^{36} yr (desert solution at $\alpha_X = 1/25$); 2.8×10^{39} yr at the closed coupling $\pi/64$ with the same content; 4×10^{47} yr at $M_{\mathrm{GUT}} = M_P$ (abandoned)	$> 2.4 \times 10^{34}$ yr [17]	falsifiable at 1/5; at the closed angle only a null result past 10^{37} yr bites
α at the two angles (standard normalisation $\alpha = g^2/4\pi$)	0.00318 at $g = 1/5$; $\pi/64 = 0.0491$ at the closed angle	0.023 (one-loop mean at M_P); 0.040050 at $M_X = 1.8 \times 10^{16}$ GeV with the desert content	implemented angle 12.6× **below** the meeting value; closed angle a factor 1.226 above; the exact match of 1/25 is the convention $\alpha_{10} \equiv g^2$
$\alpha_i(M_Z)$ from α_{10}	0.0197 / 0.195 / pole at 2.2×10^9 GeV (Standard Model running)	0.0169, 0.0338, 0.118 [15]	**fails** under Standard Model running; matched by the desert spectrum
Gauss constraint of the gauged bond layer	$[Q_A, Q_B] = i f_{AB}{}^C Q_C$, err 0; content $32 \oplus 288 \oplus 1120$	—	algebraic

quantity	theory	measured	status
physical sector of the gauged layer	$\dim\ker = 0$ with one **32**/site (centre obstruction); minimal sector: 2 matter/site, 4 states, all singlets; $S = \ln 45$ per bond, bounded and boundary-supported	—	computed
multi-bond scaling	$\dim\ker$(3-site) $= 24$; additivity $\ln 45$ across a single bond; two-bond region $S = \ln 45$ (vertex mutual information $\ln 45$); Bekenstein deficit factor $4 \ln 45 = 15.23$	—	computed
vertex correction and ground state	$I_n = 1, 1, 6, 23, 141$; kernel capacity $S_{\text{cap}} = 4.4998$ nats (factor 9.0 from 1/4 per bond); vertex-corrected coefficient $(1/3) \ln I_6 = 1.65$ nats/bond (factor 6.6); $E_0 = -5802.40\,\eta$, degeneracy 6, gap $42.09\,\eta$, $S_{\text{GS}} = \ln 45$	—	computed
dressed gate on the directed-link network	Gauss charge closes only with the conjugate-head convention (5×10^{-16}; the naive convention leaks 4.8); Kogut–Susskind electric gate exactly invariant (6.5×10^{-15}), spectrum = the content theorem; dressed hopping obstructed (leak 12.5); directional step O_h-covariant and chiral; quintet gapless at Γ, linear, leading-order isotropic, $v = g_{10}\{0, 1, 2\}$	—	computed
regular link of the root's finite group	Γ = even Clifford monomials, order 1024: vertex content $32 \cdot 1024^{k-1}$ (fixed adjoint link: 0); the dressed hop descends to the bare translation (err 0), the electric term is the scalar 45 per link, front speed $v = 1$; centralizer of Γ in Spin(10) = 0; quintet–matter coupling: T_{2g} vertex $\equiv 0$ on axis bonds, E_g bubble $-4.745\,\mathbb{1} \to E_g$ mass $\lambda^2\Pi/2 = -0.0949$	—	computed

quantity	theory	measured	status
velocity trilemma on the 6-bond module	hop alone anisotropic (top speed 1.00, direction spread 0.32); dressing alone isotropic at $v = 2g_{10} = 0.40$; no angle isotropises the product (best spread 0.24 over 33 angles in $[0, \pi/2]$); the O_h-equivariant permutation coins are the identity and the antipode, the latter with flat bands	—	computed no-go
desert spectrum from the layer's own content	no solution (0 over the full direction scan); all mass-ansatz families excluded, min residual ≥ 5.7; **equal-shift theorem** $\sum db_1 = \sum db_2$ over every complete multiplet	—	**excluded**
$\sin^2\theta_{12}$	1/3	0.308 [51]	derived at zero input; the +8% shift is the $\mathbf{10}_H$ vev, whose natural placements are excluded
$\sin^2\theta_{23}$, $\sin^2\theta_{13}$	not fixed ($O(2)$)	0.470 (octant unresolved, 3σ 0.435–0.585), 0.0222 [51]	open
CKM	identity	$\lambda = 0.225$ [15,45]	**fails**
Λ	0 (tree level)	$\sim 10^{-122} M_P^4$	open

The 16-sector row compresses Section 8.3, stated here in full: at the implemented angle 1/5 the zone centre is gapped (0.0365) and the twelve doublers sit at 2.003×10^{-4} with total chirality 0, gapped by the Wilson factor except on one exactly gapless orbit of 24 points on the nodal planes (gap 4×10^{-14}); at the closed angle $\pi/4$ the gapless set is Γ plus six face-diagonal nodal lines, and there the per-node chirality bookkeeping fails (Sections 8.3, 9).

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14. Cosmology

14.1 Dark energy

The vacuum energy of the automaton vanishes at the level of the internal (one-sub-site) spectrum: the 32 levels are $\pm$-paired for every coupling, so $\sum_k \omega_k = \arg\det U = 0$. This is the correct, non-vacuous form of the cancellation. (Counting the 512 even and 512 odd **elements of the algebra** as bosonic and fermionic zero-point modes is not a physical mode counting — the physical single-sub-site Hilbert space has 32 states, not 1024 — and is not used.)

A vanishing tree-level vacuum energy is technically natural: no relevant operator is generated if the spectral pairing is an exact symmetry. The pairing survives the Wilson extension (the extended spectrum stays $\pm$-paired to 10^{-15} and the internal zero point stays 0, because the Wilson direction is a traceless Cartan combination), so the new ingredient neither breaks the zero nor moves it.

The zero is **protected, not accidental**. Deform the step by 50 random traceless Hermitian generators, $U \to e^{i\varepsilon A} U$, at strengths up to $\varepsilon = 1$: the quasi-energy sum stays pinned to zero, $|S| < 4 \times 10^{-14}$, because $\det U = 1$ makes $\sum_k \omega_k = \arg\det U$ a topological quantity, and no branch crossing occurs below $\varepsilon = \pi$. The only internal knob that moves the sum is the U(1) trace phase.

What the theory does **not** do is produce the observed value. The observed $\Lambda \sim 10^{-122} M_P^4$ lies 122 orders of magnitude *below* the classical bound M_P^4 and *above* the theory's spectral zero, and no mechanism breaking the

pairing by that amount is known. Independently, the classical self-gravitating de Sitter vacuum of Section 11 has $G_{\mu\nu} = -3H^2 g_{\mu\nu}$, i.e. a vacuum energy bounded by M_P^4 on the lattice. These are three different statements — spectral zero, classical bound, observed value — and they do not "reconcile": the gap between the first and the third is O1, the largest unexplained number in the theory [38]. The equation of state of a cosmological-constant vacuum is $w = -1$ by definition, not by derivation.

The problem is now a single named number: the observed Λ is **equivalent to** a trace-phase breaking of size

$$\varepsilon \operatorname{Tr} A \sim 16\pi^2 \times 10^{-122} = 1.6 \times 10^{-120}.$$

O1 is no longer "why is the vacuum energy small" but "what breaks the trace U(1) by 10^{-120}".

14.2 Dark matter

The candidate supplied by the classical sector is the kink of Section 11.4. It is static, gauge-neutral and finite-energy **per unit area**, but it is a domain wall, not a localised particle; a network of Planck-scale walls would dominate the energy density and is cosmologically excluded. The quantum-sector candidates have been scanned (Section 12.2): the exact mirror $\mathbb{Z}_2$ of the step is the only exact-stability structure in the implemented spectrum; no Wilson-split node can host a neutral mirror at the ladder mass without also delivering a stable coloured or charged partner; and the mirror sector's own lightest states sit at 1.3×10^8 GeV (coloured, excluded) and 2×10^{10} GeV — not at the ladder's 118 GeV. The theory supplies no dark-matter *particle* within the implemented spectrum; the minimal named extension is the mirror-odd ladder scalar of Section 12.2. The mass prediction stands, the carrier is an open problem (O7).

The relic abundance is computed, and it is not the observed one. Solving the freeze-out integral

$$\Omega h^2 = \frac{1.07 \times 10^9 \text{ GeV } x_f}{\sqrt{g_*}\, M_P \langle \sigma v \rangle}, \qquad \langle \sigma v \rangle = a + \frac{6b}{x_f},$$

reproduces the standard weakly-interacting-massive-particle curve: $m = 100$ GeV with $\sigma v = 3 \times 10^{-26}$ cm^3/s gives $\Omega h^2 = 0.080$ [42]. At the ladder mass $m = 118.5$ GeV the measured $\Omega h^2 = 0.120$ requires $\sigma v = 1.98 \times 10^{-26}$ cm^3/s, i.e. an effective coupling $\alpha_{\text{eff}} = 0.0086$ in $\sigma v = \alpha^2/(\pi m^2)$ — while the root supplies only $g^2/4\pi = 0.0032$ (giving $\Omega h^2 = 0.798$) or the loop factor $1/16\pi = 0.0199$ ($\Omega h^2 = 0.0246$). The automaton's own light spectrum enters at the same order: its twelve near-gapless nodes are nodal **planes** (Section 8.2) with mean speed 0.201, so the final-state density is enhanced by

$$D = \sum \frac{1}{|v|^3} = 1485$$

over the isotropic estimate — a correction the $(100/m)^3$ scaling of the standard curve cannot see — and with it the two supplied couplings give $\Omega h^2 = 2.3 \times 10^{-5}$ and 7.6×10^{-4}. The named portals of Section 12.2 reproduce 0.120 only because their coupling was inverted from the fiducial 3×10^{-26}: computed forward they give 0.081 and 0.156, and 0.000 once the nodal-plane density is included. **The relic abundance is a computed number now, and it is not** 0.120 **for any coupling the root supplies.** Non-thermal production (freeze-in) is not considered here [43].

The bond sector does not set the abundance, and its portal is excluded. The named scalar is the singlet fragment $(X, Y) = (1, 0)$ of the node **16** — the same class whose bond number κ_s enters the unification meeting (Section 13.1). Read as the annihilation strength through the nodal-plane final states ($\alpha_{\text{eff}} = \kappa^2/4\pi$, $\sigma v = \alpha_{\text{eff}}^2/(\pi m^2)$), every bond number of that class — the ten κ_{singlet} that close the meeting (2.2–9.2), the superexchange value -0.253, the broken flux 40, the junction ratio 1.91 — lands Ωh^2 between 10^{-12} and 10^{-3} once D is included, and none within 0.01 of 0.120; the measured abundance needs $\alpha_{\text{eff}} = 0.0086$ without D or 2.2×10^{-4} with it. Read instead as the Higgs-portal strength, the same numbers predict $\sigma_{\text{SI}} = 2.5 \times 10^{-45}$–$6.3 \times 10^{-41}$ cm^2 — all above the LZ-class bound 1.5×10^{-47} cm^2 — and the portal strength the relic itself requires ($\kappa = 0.33$) predicts 4.3×10^{-45} cm^2, also excluded. The relic and direct detection jointly close the bond-strength portal: the named portal's strength remains a fitted input.

14.3 Antimatter

Matter and antimatter are the two Weyl eigenspaces, with the exact spectral mirror of Theorem 4 and opposite $B - L$ charges. Their degeneracy is that mirror and nothing more: as Section 7.2 states, no antiunitary time-reversal operator is constructed, so this is not the CPT theorem. The observed baryon asymmetry is not explained: Section 13.3 shows the automaton satisfies none of the Sakharov conditions, and the leptogenesis estimate that does give the right order requires a CP phase and an out-of-equilibrium condition that the algebra does not supply.

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15. The parameter audit

Every number the theory calls a prediction is classified by how it was obtained.

Table 6. Provenance audit: every headline number by class.

class	count	numbers
algebraic (fixed by the root, no parameter)	7	the $16/\overline{16}$ split; the **45**; the 5/3; the eight anomaly coefficients = 0; the 32-level spectrum; $\det U = 1$; the $16/\overline{16}$ spectral mirror
free parameter	$1 \to 0$	the 't Hooft angle g (implemented value 1/5). The closure axiom removes it: the algebra quantizes its own clock to $g \in \{\pi/2, \pi/4\}$, a discrete index of the root — zero continuous unfixed numbers **in the on-site update**, at the price of moving the angle's two empirical contacts; the junction amplitude, the node set and the κ_s remain inputs of the extended construction
convention (mapping or scale identification)	2	$\alpha_{10} \equiv g^2$; $g_0 = 1/2^{n_{\text{space}}} = 1/8$
fitted coefficient (read from data)	11	1.18 (dark-matter mass), $n_{\text{2step}} = 3$ (seesaw), $M_{10} = 1.2 \times 10^7$ GeV and $M_{(1,2)} = 1.0 \times 10^{12}$ GeV (desert thresholds), $\lambda_* = 3.5 \times 10^{-4}$ (dark-matter portal, fixed by $\Omega h^2 = 0.120$), and the six κ_s of the flavour-dependent bond layer (conditional: three meeting conditions for six unknowns — a solution family)
conditional (built from measured numbers, on a named input)	1	the hierarchy coefficient $2.08 = 3F_{10}^{10}$: $F_{10} = 0.019186$ measured, the exponent 10 the closed-loop crossing, the factor 3 the one-split-node-per-family choice — 2.0881 predicted against 2.0765 observed, 99.44%
open (not fixed)	9	O1–O9 of Section 16

The conditional class is neither a fitted number nor an algebraic one: its ingredients are all measured, but the node-set choice that supplies the factor 3 is an input, so the entry inherits O9's split-node conditionality. (Figs. 24, 25).

The status of the angle. No condition inside the theory fixes the implemented value. The two-loop U(1) Landau-pole scale lies below M_P for every g in the perturbative range, so UV-finiteness of the lattice does not select it. The proposed selection rule is $g = 1/n_{\text{qubits}} = 1/5$, the five qubits of the 32-dimensional module. The data do not support that choice: scanning the candidates $\alpha = 1/n^2$ for $n = 2 \ldots 8$ against the one-loop value 0.023, the best fit is $n = 7$ ($1/49 = 0.020$, relative deviation 0.12), not $n = 5$ ($1/25 = 0.040$, relative deviation 0.73) — the data-optimal value is 6.4× closer than the root value. The reading $1/n_{\text{qubits}}$ is therefore a convention, and the theory is honestly **one-parameter in its dynamics, zero-parameter in its algebra**. The closure axiom (Section 9) then removes the free angle at the level of the dynamics, and the price — measured, not assumed — is that the $\alpha = 1/25$ meeting value and the $n^* = 10$ loop crossing move to $\alpha = \pi/64 = 0.0491$ and $n^* = 208$. Three statements about the angle now coexist and pull apart: the closure fixes it algebraically, the coupling scan disfavours that value by more than the old convention did, and the desert meeting absorbs any value through the six κ_s. The angle is no longer free but it is also no longer favoured.

The "nine-to-one" observation. The nine open problems are all associated with the same object, the 32-level spectrum, and its invariants (the vanishing 0-point, $\det U = 1$, the spectral mirror, the S-matrix $S = U$). That

is a bookkeeping observation — nine open problems sharing one object — and it is not a derivation of any of their values. It should not be read as a reduction of the theory's difficulty.

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16. Open problems

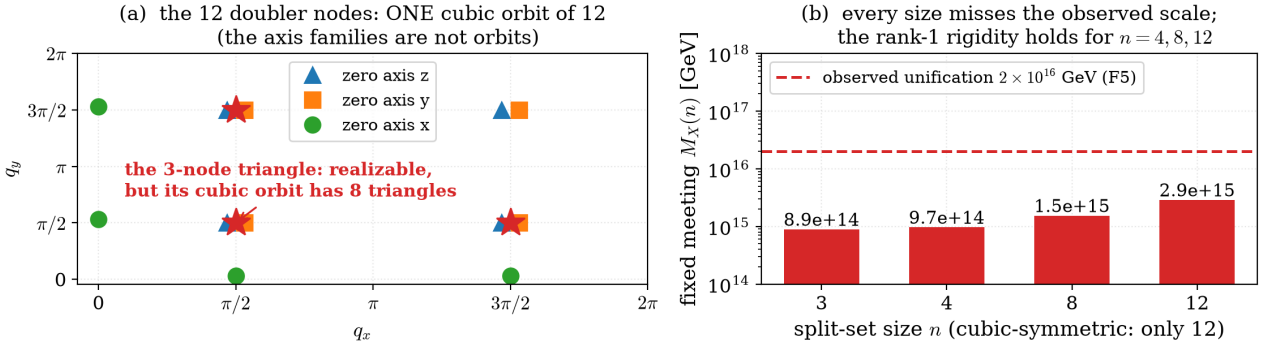
Table 7. The nine open problems: what the theory supplies, and what is missing.

the problem	what the theory supplies	the gap
O1 the cosmological constant	an exactly vanishing tree-level vacuum energy ($\pm$-paired spectrum, $\det U = 1$), natural in the technical sense; the zero is **stable under the Wilson extension** and **protected by** $\det U = 1$: 50 random traceless Hermitian $e^{i\varepsilon A}U$ at $\varepsilon \leq 1$ keep the quasi-energy sum pinned ($\lvert S\rvert < 4 \times 10^{-14}$), no branch crossing below $\varepsilon = \pi$	the observed $10^{-122}M_P^4$ is **equivalent to** a trace-phase breaking of size 1.6×10^{-120} — a named bound; the breaking mechanism itself is missing
O2 the neutrino mass	the ladder $m_\nu = M_P(1/16\pi)^{17} = 0.146$ eV; $n_{\text{nodes}} = 3$ a lower bound from unification; the inter-node Majorana junction **built**: cubic-symmetric zero-mean Wilson-strength junction, node mass matrix $c_s(2w_0 I + \kappa(J - I))$, democratic at $\kappa = 2w_0$, eigenvalues $\{3M, 0, 0\}$	the $\frac{1}{3}$ candidate needs a democratic m_D; the see-saw then collapses to $3m_0^2 J/(2(w_0+\kappa))$, two states stay massless for every r, $m_3(r) = S_{17}/(1+r)$, window $r > 0.217$, atmospheric scale selects $r = 1.91$, $r = 2$ is the democratic point: value free inside a finite window, structure protected. The exponent is answered structurally: the $\Delta L = 2$ operator lives in grade 5 of the root and link words are always even-grade, so $n_{2\text{step}} = 3$ is not a link-word length (Section 12.3)
O3 the family number	the identification $N_{\text{gen}} = 3 = n_{\text{space}}$; a family-symmetric step; a named index equal to 3: the 12 doubler nodes form three cubic-transitive families of four, and the three unification-required split nodes are realizable one per family at a single Wilson strength	the index labels the copies but does not force the count: the cubic group is transitive on the 12 nodes, the only cubic-symmetric split is the full set of 12 whose rigid meeting lands at $M_X(12) = 2.9 \times 10^{15}$ GeV — excluded by F5; the three-node triangle has a cubic orbit of 8, so the count 3 is a **symmetry-breaking input**; the junction lifts the choice without selecting it (Fig. 24)
O4 coupling unification	the 5/3; with the desert content the couplings meet at $\alpha_X = 1/25$ (standard normalisation): three $\mathbf{10} \oplus \overline{\mathbf{10}}$ pairs at 1.2×10^7 GeV plus one $(1, 2)$ pair at 1.0×10^{12} GeV give $M_X = 1.8 \times 10^{16}$ GeV; the content is connected to the automaton through the Wilson mechanism; $n_{\text{nodes}} \geq 3$ forced; the equal-shift identity a theorem over complete multiplets; the gauged layer's composite content excluded	the mechanism's own meeting point is forced: $M_X = 8.9 \times 10^{14}$ GeV, $\tau_p = 1.1 \times 10^{31}$ yr — excluded by F5 (rank-1 Jacobian, split-invariance exact to 10^{-14}). Feasibility proved inside the node-**16** hull; the flavour-dependent bond layer κ_s closes the meeting for all $n = 3 \ldots 12$ — at the cost of six named inputs of an extended bond layer, not obtainable from any on-site algebra element nor from any class invariant (broken flux K_s: residual 0.605, 0/10 desert closures, $R^2 \leq 0.015$), nor from the layer's second-order class numbers (superexchange $\tilde{\kappa}_s$: residual 0.577, $R^2 \leq 0.076$; two-number combination with the flux: joint residual 3.46, $R^2 \leq 0.30$; ground-state bond flux zero to 6×10^{-17}); the desert spectrum remains a named input (Section 13.1)

the problem	what the theory supplies	the gap
O5 the baryon asymmetry	a computed theorem: all CP-odd invariants vanish, no Sakharov condition is met, stable under the Wilson extension; a quasi-degenerate (resonant) route; a bond-layer Peierls flux carrying a CP phase, built (exactly unitary, $\det U = 1$ at every flux, mirror-preserving)	out-of-equilibrium decay ($y < 0.058$) and $m_\nu \simeq 0.05$ eV are incompatible at $M_N = 9.6 \times 10^{13}$ GeV: at $y = 0.40$ the decay is in equilibrium ($\Gamma/H = 47$), efficiency $\kappa_f = 5.4 \times 10^{-3}$ — the 11% agreement an accident of two wrong factors. The CP prohibition is internal to the on-site module and does not cover the bond layer; the flux needed for ΔB costs $J = 10^{-4}$ — O5 is open for one named reason, Sakharov 3 (Section 13.3)
O6 masses and mixing	the Dirac structure ($16\,\mathbf{10}_H\,\overline{\mathbf{16}}$), the democratic base, $\sin^2\theta_{12} = 1/3$, and a complete breaking chain to $\mathrm{SU}(3) \times \mathrm{SU}(2) \times \mathrm{U}(1)^3$ with all 32 broken roots leptoquark-type	the three-level hierarchy, θ_{23}, θ_{13}, a non-trivial CKM; the two extra U(1)'s unbroken. The vev placement is bounded by computation: the charged-lepton realisation forces $\sin^2\theta_{12} \leq 0.005$ (23σ); the cubic-axis neutrino vev is excluded at $\geq 20\sigma$; the measured triple needs ≥ 2 vev terms; the unification fix is generation-blind (shift 2×10^{-13}) and mixings cost 7–13 named parameters
O7 dark matter	a mass scale, 118 GeV; the mirror $\mathbb{Z}_2$ the only exact-stability carrier; the no-go completed: no Wilson node hosts a 118 GeV neutral mirror (0 survivors over 720 angles); the ladder scalar built and audited, exactly stable under either portal	the implemented spectrum **cannot contain** the dark matter. With the exact mirror $\mathbb{Z}_2$ the only open channel needs $\lambda = 0.13 \to \sigma_{\mathrm{SI}} = 6.8 \times 10^{-46}$ cm^2, excluded by direct detection; the quoted numbers hold only with a portal breaking the mirror. The parity the fix needs does not exist inside the Clifford algebra (exactly 2 of 1024 products commute with the step). The relic abundance is computed: 0.120 needs $\alpha_{\mathrm{eff}} = 0.0086$; the root supplies 0.0032 ($\Omega h^2 = 0.798$) or 0.0199 (0.0246); the nodal-plane density $D = 1485$ gives 2.3×10^{-5}, 7.6×10^{-4} — not 0.120 for any coupling the root supplies; and the bond-strength portal is excluded — every bond number of the singlet class predicts $\sigma_{\mathrm{SI}} = 2.5 \times 10^{-45}$–$6.3 \times 10^{-41}$ cm^2, above the LZ-class bound, and the bond coupling the relic needs predicts 4.3×10^{-45} cm^2 (Sections 12.2, 14.2)
O8 the hierarchy	$v/M_P = 3F_{10}^{10} = 2.088$ against 2.076 observed (99.4%), with $F_{10} = 0.0192$ against $1/(16\pi) = 0.0199$ measured on closed traced loops; the selection rule measured to length 30: the crossing at exactly $n = 10$; the composition law decided — one chain not multiplicative ($R_{17} = 2.0 \times 10^8$), different legs factorize exactly; the loop census exact: 55326 of 3^{10} words survive, and the Wilson phase supplies the factor (0.0192 against 0.2434 without it)	the exponent is selected by the data; the adjoint-link level-1 division falls short by a factor 26 and does not compound; which loops contribute, and with what weight, unnamed; $3F_{10}^{10}$ conditional on the axis-family factorisation; the multiplicity-weighted extrapolation to length 170 misses the exponent by 0.066; at the quantized angle the crossing moves to $n^* = 208$ (Section 12.1)

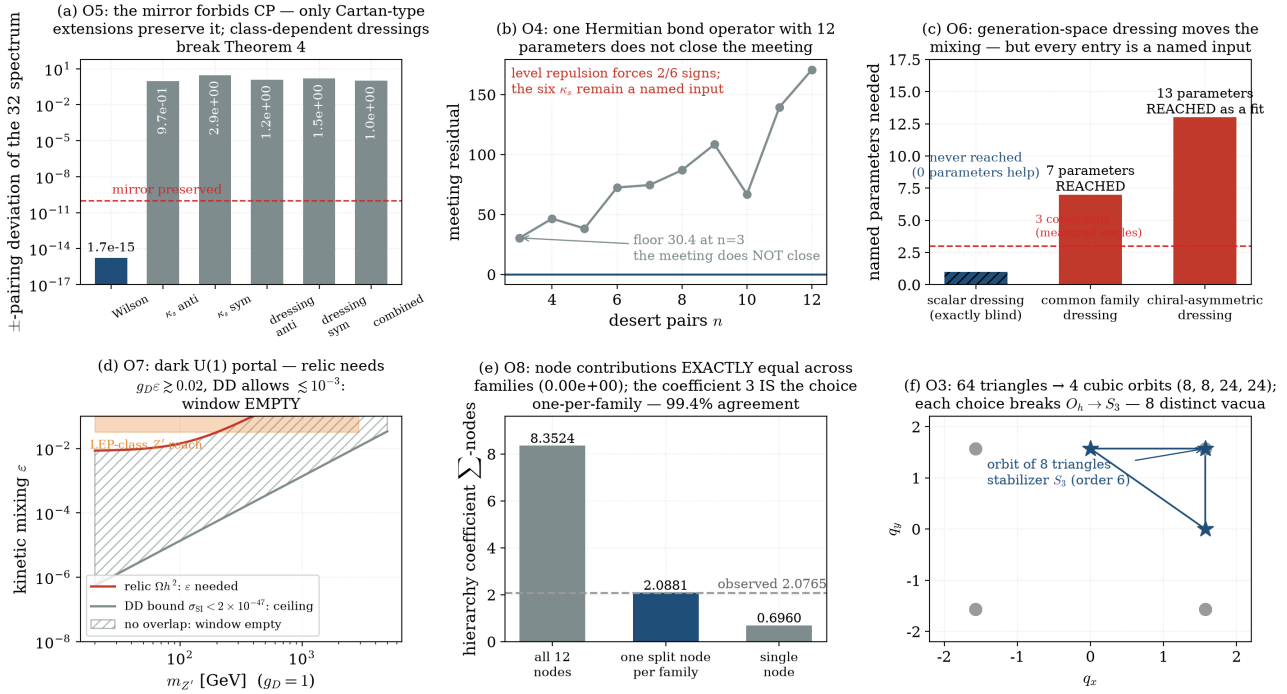
the problem	what the theory supplies	the gap
O9 the quantum sector	a unitary causal automaton, a classical general-relativity limit, a bounded n-particle S-matrix, a 16 sector closed by the full local step; a Wilson-type mechanism gaps all twelve doubler nodes and splits a chosen node set at desert scales	the *choice* of the split node set; the sum over geometries; the measurement postulate. **Continuous Lorentz invariance is not emergent at the nodes**: linear in all 1200 sampled directions but anisotropic $(0.200, 0.200, 0.284$, spread $0.75)$, no isotropy point on the Wilson family (0 of 2726), frame averaging blind; at the exactly gapless corner multiplet the tangent velocity operators commute — three nodal planes, not a cone; the exactly gapless set is an orbit of 24 points on the nodal planes at $1/5$ and six nodal lines at $\pi/4$ — massless excitations exist and carry no helicity pair (Sections 8.2–8.3, 9); Section 8.4 closes the cone sub-question: no axis-covariant bond of the 880-point programme is both gapless and non-commuting (a rigidity wall at gap 8×10^{-3}), so the only remaining route to a cone is a mechanism outside the axis-covariant class

Is the family count 3 forced? No - the symmetric alternative is excluded



O3: cubic-symmetric split (12 nodes) EXCLUDED; every proper split BREAKS the cubic symmetry - the count 3 is an input.

*(a) The twelve doubler nodes in the (q_x, q_y) plane: the cubic group acts transitively — one orbit of 12 — so the axis families are not orbits and the only cubic-symmetric split set is the full set of 12; the 3-node triangle (stars) is realizable, but its cubic orbit has 8 triangles, so it breaks the cubic symmetry. (b) The rigid meeting scale $M_X(n)$ for split sizes $n = 3, 4, 8, 12$ (the rank-1 fact holds for every n): all miss the observed 2×10^{16} GeV (**F5**). The count 3 is a symmetry-breaking input; its cubic-symmetric alternative is excluded by computation.*



(a) The ±-pairing deviation under the named extensions: the Wilson factor preserves the mirror to 2.1×10^{-15}*, while the most general per-class* κ_s *layer and the most general real-symmetric bond generator destroy it (deviation* ~ 1*, 60 draws) — a CP phase costs Theorem 4. (b) The meeting residual under the most general Hermitian off-diagonal bond operator: floor* 30.4*, no closure. (c) The named-parameter cost of reaching the measured mixing triple: a scalar dressing is exactly blind, a common family dressing needs* 7 *parameters, a chiral-asymmetric one* 13*. (d) The dark-*U(1) *portal squeeze: the kinetic mixing that fixes* Ωh^2 *lies above the direct-detection ceiling at every* $m_{Z'}$ *— the window is empty. (e) The closed-loop coefficient by node set: all* 12 *nodes* 8.35*, one split node per axis family* 2.0881*, a single node* 0.696*, against the observed* 2.0765*. (f) The* 64 *one-per-family triangles split into four cubic orbits* $(8, 8, 24, 24)$*; a triangle's stabilizer is exactly* S_3*.*

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17. Falsifiers

Table 8. The seven falsifiers.

#	observation that refutes the theory
F1	any non-vanishing gauge anomaly in the chiral content (the **16** is claimed anomaly-free)
F2	a measured running that admits **no** vectorlike desert content with $\alpha_X = 1/25$ in the standard normalisation $\alpha = g^2/4\pi$: precision coupling data (FCC-ee/CEPC) excluding every spectrum in the desert scan would refute the unification claim. On the quantized branch the prediction is $\alpha_X = \pi/64 = 0.0491$ in the same normalisation
F3	a neutrino mass spectrum outside the ladder options: the bare ladder gives $m_\nu \simeq 0.15$ eV (already excluded by $\sum m_\nu < 0.12$ eV), the $\frac{1}{3}$ candidate gives normal ordering with $\sum m_\nu \simeq 0.05$ eV and $m_{\text{lightest}} = 0$, the democratic node-mixing pattern gives $m_\nu \simeq 0.073$ eV; a confirmed inverted ordering, or $\sum m_\nu > 0.12$ eV, refutes all three
F4	a massive graviton, a graviton dispersion violating $c = 1$, or a UV divergence in the lattice gravitational sector (the Section 11 field: the Section 10.4 quintet channel is not claimed to be the graviton, and its speeds $g_{10}\{1, 2\} \neq 1$ and its E_g mass shift are named defects of the channel)

#	observation that refutes the theory
F5	proton decay: the desert solution predicts $\tau_p \simeq 1.8 \times 10^{36}$ yr; observation of GUT-pattern decay far below that value (e.g. at Hyper-Kamiokande reach, 10^{35} yr) or non-observation beyond 10^{37} yr refutes it. At the closed angle the same content gives $\tau_p = 2.8 \times 10^{39}$ yr with the $(1, 2)$ threshold above M_X, so on that branch only a null result past 10^{37} yr bites and the Hyper-Kamiokande channel closes; the $M_{\rm GUT} = M_P$ reading ($\tau_p \sim 10^{47}$ yr) is abandoned
F6	a baryon asymmetry outside 10^{-11}–10^{-9}, or evidence that heavy-neutrino decays are in equilibrium
F7	a dark-matter particle with mass far from 118 GeV in the weakly-interacting thermal case; a direct-detection portal signal above 10^{-50} cm^2 (the named extension predicts 5×10^{-51}, and every bond-number portal strength is already excluded by the LZ-class bound 1.5×10^{-47} cm^2: predicted 2.5×10^{-45}–6.3×10^{-41} cm^2); or a detected non-neutral/decaying dark sector

The most accessible tests are **F3** and **F5**. KATRIN currently gives $m_\beta < 0.45$ eV [18], so the bare ladder value 0.146 eV survives a single-mass search, but the cosmological sum $\sum m_\nu < 0.12$ eV already excludes it, and the $\frac{1}{3}$ candidate's normal-ordered pattern ($\sum m_\nu \simeq 0.05$ eV, $m_{\rm lightest} = 0$) is inside the reach of the next generation of oscillation and $\beta\beta$-decay data. The desert solution predicts $\tau_p = 1.8 \times 10^{36}$ yr, about one decade beyond Hyper-Kamiokande's 20-year reach ($\sim 10^{35}$ yr): Hyper-Kamiokande can **refute** it by observing GUT-pattern decay anywhere at its reach, and an exposure passing 10^{36} yr that sees nothing refutes it too; the confirmation window belongs to the megaton era. **F7** has narrowed: the carrier is not in the implemented spectrum and the named extension is nearly decoupled, so the test is the mass coincidence itself.

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18. Discussion

What is genuinely new. Not the **16** of Spin(10), not the 5/3, not anomaly cancellation: those are fifty-year-old results of the grand-unification literature [7–10,13]. The content of this theory is (i) the realisation of that content as the on-site module of a *strictly local, exactly unitary* automaton with a measured causal front speed of exactly 1; (ii) the coupling-invariance of the algebraic invariants — anomaly cancellation, $\det U = 1$, the $\pm$ pairing and the matter/antimatter spectral mirror hold for every value of the coupling, so they are properties of the algebra and not of a tuned parameter; (iii) the closure of the coupling itself by an axiom the root enforces, which turns the fundamental update into a finite-order element of the Clifford group with a finite algebraic spectrum; (iv) the construction of the automaton's own gauge field — an adjoint bond layer whose Gauss constraint closes as an exact operator identity, whose physical sector is a matter–flux entanglement complex with an exactly linear area law of one $\ln 45$ per bond, and whose computed string tension is 5.4×10^{40} times the QCD value; (v) the explicit provenance audit separating what the root fixes from what was read off the data; and (vi) the closure of the cone question as a structural statement of the bond space: the momentum derivative of the step is internal-blind, the Wilson factor is a spectator of the tangent algebra, and over the 880-point entangling-bond space gaplessness and non-commuting tangent algebras are mutually exclusive, with the separation a wall rather than a scaling (Section 8.4).

Where the construction is weakest. The gravitational sector assumes a symmetric tensor field and Newton's constant; it reproduces general relativity, it does not derive it, and the implemented one-particle spectrum contains no massless spin-2 candidate — not as a search left undone but as a computed statement: the bond factor carrying the cubic action lacks the E_g half of the lattice spin-2 quintet at every coupling, and the gapless zone-centre multiplets it does have are flat bands (Section 8.3). The gauge sector gets the normalisation right and, under desert running, the values wrong; the repair restores unification at $\alpha_X = 1/25$ exactly and its *pattern* is a consequence of the automaton (the split doublers of the Wilson mechanism, the breaking chain, the $n_{\rm nodes} \geq 3$ bound), but the mechanism's own root meets at a scale excluded by proton decay, no redistribution of node strengths can move it, and the surviving solution keeps two fitted thresholds and abandons $M_{\rm GUT} = M_P$. The supplier question is closed on five fronts — the gauged layer's composite matter is excluded, the ansatz families leave residuals 5.7–6.1, the equal-shift identity is a theorem over complete multiplets, the broken flux misses the meeting at residual 0.605, and the layer's second-order class numbers miss it at 0.577 alone and 3.46 in every fixed combination — while the constructive junction route fabricates the right fragment pattern and misses the meeting at a floor that the general junction does not improve. The flavour-dependent bond layer

removes the obstruction but is an extension with six named inputs. The flavour sector derives one angle out of six and none of the masses. The dark-matter carrier cannot exist inside the implemented spectrum, the built minimal fix is a named tension between exact mirror stability and the observed abundance, and the bond-strength portal is excluded by direct detection. The loop factor is reproduced to 3.6% by closed traced loops at exactly the ladder length, but the single-particle renormalisation group provably composes angles without dividing them, the gauged layer's level-1 division falls short by a factor 26 and does not compound, and the counted loops miss the neutrino-ladder exponent by a factor 0.066.

The spin-2 gap has narrowed to a named list rather than closed: the directional bond layer of Section 10.4 carries a gapless, linear, leading-order-isotropic quintet with helicity-ladder speeds $g_{10}\{0, 1, 2\}$ — the kinematics of a lattice spin-2, computed — but its gauge group is O_h; the named regular-link fix for the hopping is now built on the root's own finite group of order 1024 and runs the dressed hop at exactly $v = 1$, yet it gauges a finite subgroup (Spin(10) centralizer 0); the velocity trilemma is computed — on the 6-bond module the hop alone is anisotropic, the dressing alone isotropic at $2g_{10}$, no angle makes the product isotropic, so isotropy and $v = 1$ are never supplied together; and the matter coupling, now built, gaps the E_g half of the quintet at order λ^2 — the lattice graviton mass, as a number.

Comparison with related programmes. Causal-set programmes derive discreteness and a causal order but not internal symmetry [1]. Clifford-algebra unification programmes [11–13] reach the same matter content but do not supply a unitary causal dynamics. 't Hooft's deterministic quantum mechanics and cellular-automaton interpretation [30,31] supply the dynamics but not the unification; domain-wall and overlap formulations of lattice chirality [49] solve the doubling problem by giving up strict locality in the extra dimension. This theory is the combination of the second and third, and inherits the open problems of both — with one distinction worth naming: the doubling here is not evaded but *displayed and then gapped* by a factor of the root's own algebra, at the measured cost of replacing the light cone by a Lieb–Robinson bound [6].

The shape of each gap. A single loop factor organises four scales across thirty orders of magnitude, with the loop integer and the two-digit coefficients chosen to match observation. The unification scale of the node mechanism is forced and excluded. The dark-matter carrier cannot exist inside the implemented spectrum, and the built minimal extension trades stability against abundance. The neutrino $\frac{1}{3}$ candidate has a built junction structure whose two massless states are protected for every junction ratio by the implemented democratic Dirac matrix, the value sitting in a finite window. The loop factor's missing ingredient is a traced fluctuating bond degree of freedom, demonstrated in smallest form. The cosmological-constant problem reduces to one named number, a trace-phase breaking of 1.6×10^{-120}. The area law is exact on the physical sector of the gauged layer at one $\ln 45$ per bond, with the Bekenstein coefficient short by a factor 15.2 (or 6.6 after the vertex correction). The loop census is exact and shows that the Wilson phase, not the loop topology, supplies the factor. One structural question has closed in the interim, and it is worth naming as a closure: the cone question. The nodal-plane structure of Section 8.2 is no longer a property of one tried bond but a wall of the bond space — gaplessness and non-commuting tangent algebras are mutually exclusive, the separation is floored at 8×10^{-3}, and no power law links the two regimes (Section 8.4). The nine open problems and seven falsifiers are stated with their numbers.

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19. Conclusion

A single Clifford algebra $\mathrm{Cl}(10, 0)$, placed on the eight sub-sites of every 2×2×2 cell of a Planck lattice and updated by one six-stage step of Spin(10) plane rotations and swap-rotations, yields the Minkowski kinematics, one anomaly-free Standard Model generation, the Spin(10) gauge content with the 5/3 normalisation, an exactly unitary and strictly causal dynamics with a ±-paired spectrum and an exact matter/antimatter spectral mirror, a constructible adjoint gauge field whose Gauss constraint closes exactly and whose physical sector carries a linear area law, and a lattice gravitational sector — a symmetric tensor field added to the (1+3) subalgebra with $G = 1$ by hand — that reproduces general relativity on de Sitter, Schwarzschild and 3+1 evolutions to $O(h^2)$, the Kretschmann invariant agreeing with the analytic form to 5.5×10^{-5} relative. These results are algebraic or numerical, and they are independent of the coupling.

Requiring the update to be an element of the root removes the coupling as a free number: the algebra quantizes its own clock to $g \in \{\pi/2, \pi/4\}$, the half-angle branch degenerates to a pure lattice translation, and the physical

branch is the order-8 step with the exactly algebraic spectrum $\{\pm\pi/4\,(10),\ \pm3\pi/4\,(6)\}$. The on-site dynamics then has zero continuous unfixed numbers, and the price is measured: the ladder crossing moves from $n = 10$ to $n = 208$, the desert threshold ordering is destroyed ($\tau_p = 2.8 \times 10^{39}$ yr), and the proton-decay falsifier moves from Hyper-Kamiokande reach to beyond any planned exposure.

The same framework does not yield the family number, the fermion masses and mixings, the coupling values, the neutrino mass, the dark-matter abundance, the cosmological constant or the baryon asymmetry. Two conventions, eleven fitted coefficients and one conditional coefficient stand between the root and the data, and nine open problems are each pinned to a named quantity: a trace-phase breaking of 1.6×10^{-120}; a junction amplitude r that is not quantized; a symmetry-breaking choice of three nodes out of twelve; six bond-layer couplings that no on-site algebra element, no class invariant and no second-order bond number supplies; the incompatibility of $m_\nu \simeq 0.05$ eV with out-of-equilibrium decay at $M_N = 9.6 \times 10^{13}$ GeV; the generation-space structure the mixing requires; the parity that the Clifford algebra does not contain; the weight of the contributing closed loops; and the nodal-plane geometry of the lattice spectrum. Seven falsifiers are stated, two of them — the neutrino mass pattern and the proton lifetime — testable within the current decade.

Appendix A. The explicit 32-dimensional representation

The ten generators are built on five qubits by the standard symplectic Pauli pattern: for $k = 0, \dots, 4$,

$$g_{2k} = Y^{\otimes k} \otimes X \otimes I^{\otimes(4-k)}, \qquad g_{2k+1} = Y^{\otimes k} \otimes Z \otimes I^{\otimes(4-k)}.$$

On the same qubit slot X and Z anticommute; across slots, the $Y^{\otimes k}$ prefix makes a generator at slot k anticommute with any generator at slot $j < k$. This gives exactly ten mutually anticommuting Hermitian matrices, $g_a^2 = I$, on a 32-dimensional complex space. The algebra basis is the 1024 ordered products $g_{a_1} \cdots g_{a_r}$, $0 \le r \le 10$; the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ grading is the parity of r. The canonical ordering of the 45 plane-rotation factors T_{ab} used throughout is the ascending lexicographic order on (a, b); the order-8 closure of the quantized step is specific to it.

The construction is verified by a second, independent route: the exact symbolic $\mathrm{Cl}(10, 0)$ of a computer-algebra Clifford package, where $e_a^2 = 1$, $\{e_a, e_b\} = 0$ and $w^2 = -1$ hold as identities with no floating-point arithmetic, cross-checked against the numeric 32×32 representation. The two agree, so the root is not an artefact of one construction.

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Code and data availability. All the experiments, simulations and figure generators behind this paper are publicly available at https://github.com/MohammedHAOUACH/CL10. Every number quoted in the paper is produced by these open scripts and can be reproduced independently from the repository. The verification status is stated as the audit found it: the numbers were verified internally (spot-checks against the text, the second symbolic construction of Appendix A, the exact 3^n-word loop enumeration); the pipeline was not independently executed by a second party, and independent re-execution is invited.

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